

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Video Editing

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

© 2026 Cyber Elias Academy · cea.ng

Table of Contents

Course Roadmap

Session 01 — Video Editing Foundations and Workflow

Session 02 — Editing Software and Interface

Session 03 — Cuts Pacing and Story

Session 04 — Audio Editing and Mixing

Session 05 — Colour Text and Graphics

Session 06 — Effects Transitions and Motion

Session 07 — Export Settings Formats and Delivery

Session 08 — Client Work Revisions and File Management

Session 09 — Capstone Edit a Complete Video Project

OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

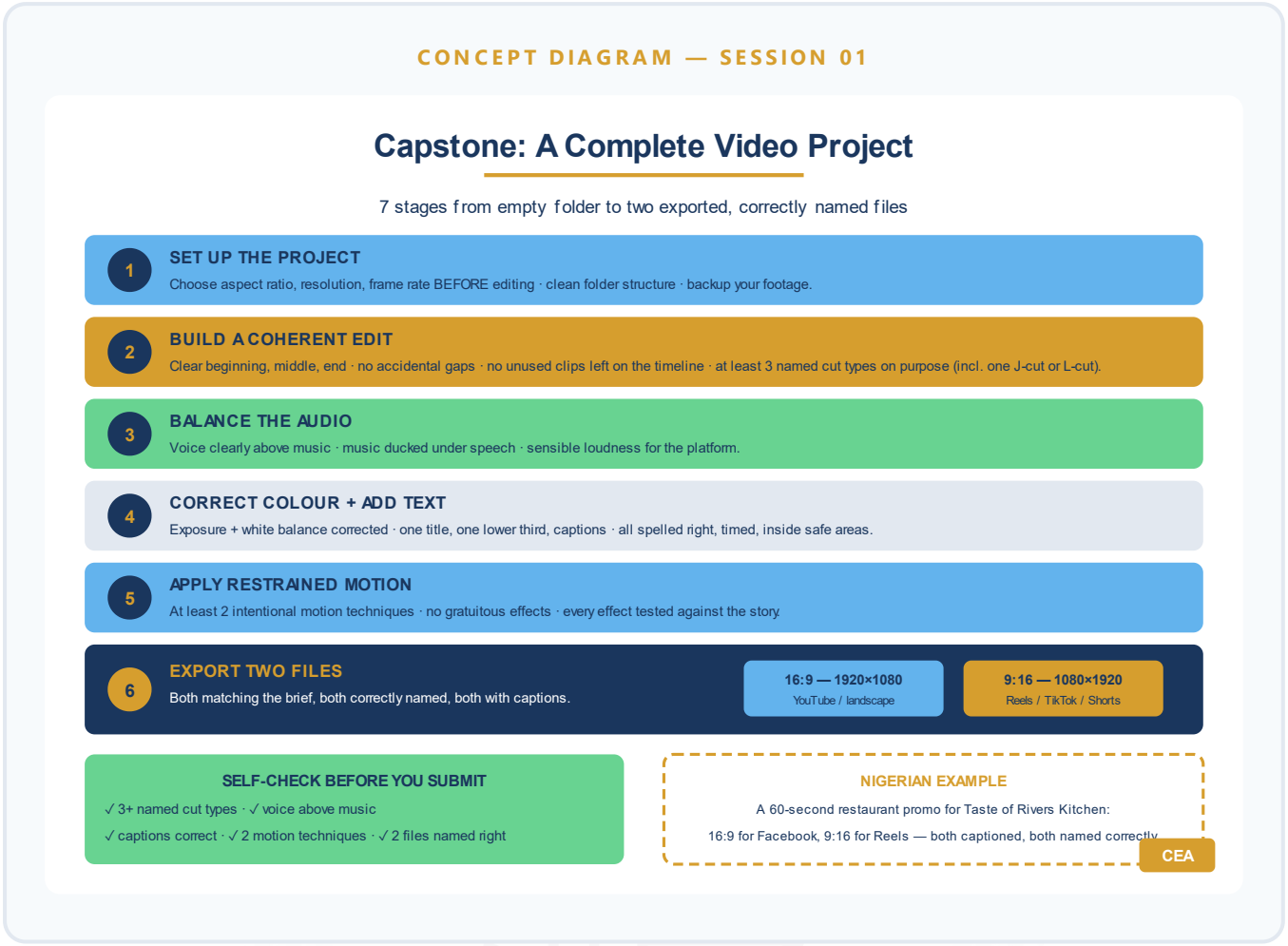
What we cover in every session

#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	Video Editing Foundations and Workflow	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations and Story	105 minutes
02	Editing Software and Interface	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations and Story	105 minutes
03	Cuts Pacing and Story	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations and Story	105 minutes
04	Audio Editing and Mixing	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Craft	105 minutes
05	Colour Text and Graphics	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Craft	105 minutes
06	Effects Transitions and Motion	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Craft	105 minutes
07	Export Settings Formats and Delivery	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Polish and Deliver	105 minutes
08	Client Work Revisions and File Management	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Polish and Deliver	105 minutes
09	Capstone Edit a Complete Video Project	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Polish and Deliver	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 9

Video Editing Foundations and Workflow



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 1 â€" VIDEO EDITING FOUNDATIONS AND WORKFLOW

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 9
Session title	Video Editing Foundations and Workflow
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations and Story
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first contact with editing)
Prerequisite knowledge	Basic computer or phone confidence â€" opening an application, creating and saving a file, using a browser, copying files. No editing knowledge and no camera are assumed. If a learner

Item	Detail
	struggles with mouse and keyboard, pair them with a confident learner for the first practical.
Connection to previous work	This is the first session of the course. There is no previous editing session. It connects to everyday life: nearly every learner has phone footage â€" a birthday, a church event, a shop product â€" that was shot and never finished. Today we explain why that footage is stuck, and we start freeing it.
Preparation before class	Academy computers on and logged in; a projector connected; **Footage Pack A (Talking Head)** copied to a shared class folder and verified (plays correctly, manifest matches contents, consent note present); printed **shot-log sheets** and **folder-structure handouts** (one per learner); the four aspect-ratio diagrams (16:9, 9:16, 1:1, 4:5) drawn or printed for the board; a spare 16 GB USB drive ready for any learner without one; the Course Design Document Section 15 ethics rules read aloud at the start.

Instructor note on tone: This session must feel *empowering and practical*, not theoretical. Learners should leave feeling "I now know why my videos were stuck, and I know the first real step." Keep the mood confident, warm and hands-on. Say the academy philosophy early: *"From Zero to Expert, Together."*

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** in their own words what an editor actually does â€" deciding what the audience sees, in what order, and for how long â€" and why editing is a *decision-making* job, not a button-pushing job.
2. **Describe** the full post-production workflow in order, from ingest (receiving footage) to archive (storing the finished project), using all ten stage names correctly.
3. **Organise** a footage pack into a clean folder structure with consistent file names, so every clip can be found in under ten seconds.
4. **Back up** footage so that every clip exists in **two separate places** before editing begins, and explain why "one copy is no copy."
5. **Choose** the correct aspect ratio (16:9, 9:16, 1:1 or 4:5) for a given platform â€" YouTube, TikTok/Reels, Instagram feed, WhatsApp Status â€" and explain the choice in one sentence.
6. **Set up** a project correctly: aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate decided **before** the first cut, and state why setup mistakes are expensive to fix later.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops). A shared computer between two learners is fine; pair them so one reads the shot log and one writes, then swap.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector or large screen.
- USB flash drives (16 GB minimum) for footage and exports â€" one per learner, labelled with their name.

Software

- File Explorer (Windows) â€" built in. No editing software is installed today; Session 2 introduces CapCut.
- A web browser â€" for the academy shared folder, if used.
- Optional: CapCut already installed on academy computers (install happens properly in Session 2).

Sample files

- **Footage Pack A â€" Talking Head** (supplied by the academy): roughly 8â€"12 interview/talking-head clips of one speaker with light room noise, plus one cutaway set (a phone, a notebook, a quiet exterior). Total size kept under 1 GB so it copies quickly.
- **Footage manifest** â€" a one-page list of every clip: file name, length, what it shows, sound quality. Printed and digital.

- **Consent note** â€” confirms everyone appearing agreed to be filmed and that the footage may be used for training. Read aloud in class.
- **Folder-structure handout** (below, Section F.4) printed per learner.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 1.1 â€” "Shot Log" â€” a blank table: clip number / file name / what it shows / sound quality (Goodâ€“Okayâ€“Poor) / keep or park / notes.
- Worksheet 1.2 â€” "Backup Plan" â€” a simple checklist (original location / backup location 1 / backup location 2 / date verified).

Accounts

- None required today. (A free CapCut account is needed from Session 2 â€” remind learners to bring an email address they can access.)

Internet

- Not required. The lesson works fully offline with the supplied pack. If internet is available, the instructor may briefly show a platform's help page, but the session does not depend on it.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with File Explorer works. A learner with only a phone can sort and rename files in a file manager; the skill is the *organising*, not the machine.

Ethics note for the instructor (read aloud at the start): Every clip in Pack A is academy-supplied and everyone appearing consented. We never publish identifiable private details, we never cut words to change meaning, and we use only licensed or owned material. These rules apply in class and in paid work after the course.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two photographs side by side.

- **Photo 1:** A phone gallery with 247 unsorted videos â€” random file names like `VID_20260314_1832.mp4`, `VID_20260314_1835.mp4`, `VID_20260320_0912.mp4` â€” all mixed together: a birthday, a shop product, a church choir, a phone screen recording.
- **Photo 2:** A neat filing cabinet, one labelled drawer per event, folders inside, every clip named.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Look at these two pictures. Photo 1 is where most people's video lives â€” a phone gallery with 200, 300, 500 clips, all with names a machine invented, all mixed together. Photo 2 is where a professional editor's footage lives â€” sorted, named, backed up, ready to cut.*
>
> *Now the honest question: hands up if your phone looks like Photo 1. â€¦ Almost everybody. Good â€” you are normal, and you are exactly who this course is for.*
>
> *Here is the secret I want you to write down today: **an unfinished video is not a footage problem â€” it is a decision problem.** You already have the clips. What you do not yet have is a reason for each clip and a place for it. Today we build both."*

Expected learner response: Learners will laugh, nod, and say things like "my gallery is worse than that," "I have 1,000 videos," "I deleted some by mistake once." Accept all answers warmly. Do not let anyone share footage that shows private details.

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"This course is practical. In three weeks you will edit a complete, professional video for a real-style client brief, using free software. But professionals do not start by cutting. They start by **organising**. Today you do the work most beginners skip â€” and it is the work that separates a professional from a frustrated phone user."*

Why this opener works: It uses a problem every learner recognises instantly (the messy gallery), it removes shame ("you are normal"), and it frames the editor's real job as decision-making before any software is opened.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "Where do video files normally live on a Windows computer, and how do you open the program that shows them?"

- Expected answer: In folders â€" usually Documents, Downloads, Pictures or the Desktop â€" and you open **File Explorer** to find them.
- Common gap: some learners only know the Desktop icon. Show File Explorer briefly on the projector, point out the address bar and the search box.

Question 2: "What is the difference between a file *name* and a file *type*? Give one example of each."

- Expected answer: The name is what you call the file (`MamaT_interview_01`); the type is the format â€" the part after the dot (`.mp4` , `.mov` , `.jpg`). The type tells the computer how to open it.
- Common gap: learners confuse "file type" with "folder." Clarify: the folder is the room; the file type is the shape of the object inside.

Question 3: "Why is it dangerous to have only one copy of an important file?"

- Expected answer: If the phone is lost, the drive fails, or a file is deleted by mistake, the copy is gone forever. One copy is no copy.
- Common gap: many learners have never lost a file yet, so the risk feels theoretical. Use a quick story: "A student lost a whole project folder to one spilled soft drink. Two copies would have saved it."

Question 4: "Have you ever tried to edit a video on your phone? What was the hardest part?"

- Expected answer: "Finding the clip I wanted," "It took too long," "I did not know where the buttons were," "The music was louder than the talking."
- Common gap: learners assume their difficulty means they are "bad at technology." Normalise it: "Every single one of those is a *workflow* problem, and workflow is what professionals learn first."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You already know the ingredients â€" files, folders, names, copies. Today we put them in the order a professional uses. An editor's job has ten stages, and if you learn the order now, every later session will make sense. Think of it like building a house: nobody starts with the paint."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes on a quick File Explorer tour before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What an editor actually does

The idea. An **editor** is the person who decides what the audience sees, in what order, and for how long.

Plain-English definition. A camera records *everything*. An editor chooses the *best of it* and shapes it into something a stranger can watch and feel. Editing is decision-making: which shot, which second, which word, which silence, which music.

Why it exists. Raw footage is not a story â€" it is a pile of possibilities. A two-hour wedding recording contains maybe three minutes worth showing. A one-minute testimonial interview contains maybe fifteen seconds worth keeping. The editor's job is to find those moments and cut away everything that works against them.

What an editor contributes to a story:

- **Selection** â€" choosing the takes where the speaker is clear, warm and honest.
- **Order** â€" arranging clips so the story makes sense: beginning, middle, end.
- **Pace** â€" deciding how long each shot stays. Too long, the audience leaves. Too short, they feel rushed.
- **Sound** â€" making sure the voice is clear and the music supports instead of fights.

- **Look** â€" making the picture bright, steady and believable.
- **Feel** â€" the invisible part: the moment you cut *here* instead of *there* changes how the viewer feels.

Real-life comparison. Think of a **suya stand in Port Harcourt at night**. The cook has a big tray of meat, onions, spice, yams. He does not serve the whole tray. He picks the best pieces, arranges them, adds the right pepper, wraps it, and hands you something you actually want to eat. An editor is the cook. The footage is the raw tray. The finished video is the wrap.

Important limitation / misconception. Editing cannot fix bad footage completely. If the original video is dark, shaky and noisy, an editor can improve it â€" but the result will always be limited by what was captured. This is why professionals say: **fix it in the edit if you can, fix it on set if you can, but know the difference.**

How a learner recognises a good editor at work. Watch any video and ask three questions: Did I always know what was happening? Did the sound feel comfortable? Did it end when it should? If yes to all three, an editor made decisions â€" and made them well.

F.2 The ten-stage post-production workflow

The idea. Every professional edit â€" from a 15-second TikTok to a two-hour film â€" follows the same backbone. Learn the order once and you can apply it to any job.

Plain-English definition. The **post-production workflow** is the ordered list of steps from receiving raw footage to delivering the finished file and storing the project safely.

The ten stages (say them slowly, write them on the board):

#	Stage	What happens	Plain-English question it answers
1	**Ingest**	Footage moves from the camera/phone into the computer.	"Where is all my raw material now?"
2	**Organise**	Folders are built, files are renamed, the pack is sorted.	"Can I find any clip in ten seconds?"
3	**Log**	Every clip is watched and noted: what it shows, sound quality, best moments.	"What do I actually have?"
4	**Backup**	Everything is copied to a second location before any editing.	"What happens if this drive fails?"
5	**Assembly**	Clips are placed on the timeline in story order â€" no music, no effects yet.	"Does the story roughly work?"
6	**Rough cut**	The assembly is tightened: bad takes out, order improved, pace shaped.	"Is the shape right now?"
7	**Fine cut**	Every cut point is refined; J-cuts and L-cuts; the edit is exact.	"Is every frame earning its place?"
8	**Sound**	Dialogue, music and effects are mixed; noise reduced; voiceover added.	"Does it sound right?"
9	**Colour**	Exposure, contrast and white balance corrected; a light grade applied.	"Does it look right?"
10	**Titles, export, delivery, archive**	Titles added, files exported to spec, delivered to the client, project stored safely.	"Is the client happy â€" and can I find this again?"

Why the order matters. Stages 1â€"4 are cheap and slow. Stages 5â€"10 are fast but expensive to redo. If you cut before you organise, you will rename files mid-project and break everything. If you export before you check, you will deliver a file with a spelling error in the title. Professionals protect themselves by doing the boring stages first.

Real-life comparison. The workflow is like **cooking a pot of jollof rice**. You buy the ingredients (ingest), wash and sort them (organise), check you have everything (log), keep a spare tin of tomatoes in the cupboard (backup), put the pot on fire (assembly), taste and adjust (rough cut), get the seasoning exact (fine cut), balance the salt and spice (sound), check the colour of the rice (colour), plate it and serve it (export/delivery), and write the recipe down so you can cook it again (archive). Nobody serves the pot before the rice is done.

Nigerian context â€" what this is worth. Small businesses in Port Harcourt regularly pay **â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦50,000** for a clean 30â€"60 second promo. Churches and event planners pay similar for highlight edits. The people who get paid are not the ones who know the most buttons â€" they are the ones whose footage never gets lost, whose edits never have gaps, and whose delivered files always play. That is workflow.

Common misconception. "The workflow is for big productions; for my phone videos I can skip it." No. A skipped workflow is why a learner's 200-clip gallery stays messy for three years. The habit is the skill.

F.3 Ingest and organisation â€" the habit that prevents disaster

The idea. Ingest means moving footage from where it was captured (phone, camera, SD card) into the computer where you will edit. **Organise** means giving that footage a clean, predictable home.

Why it exists. Phones lose data. SD cards fail. Files get overwritten. A single careless copy-paste can wipe a whole event. Ingest done carefully is the moment you take ownership of the material.

The ingest rules (teach these exactly):

1. **Copy, never move.** During ingest, always *copy* the files from the phone/card to the computer. Keep the original on the phone until you have verified the copy. Only then delete the phone's version â€" and only if the client or owner agrees.
2. **Verify before you trust.** After copying, open the folder and check: the number of files matches, the total size matches, and a few clips actually play. A corrupted copy looks identical to a good one until you try to play it.
3. **One project, one folder.** Every editing job lives in its own folder. Inside it, keep separate sub-folders for `01_Footage`, `02_Audio`, `03_Exports`, `04_ProjectFiles`, `05_Archive`. (The full structure is in F.4.)
4. **Rename with meaning.** Replace `VID_20260314_1832.mp4` with `MamaT_interview_01.mp4`. A good name tells you what the clip is without opening it.

The renaming convention used in this course:

```
ClientOrProject_ShotType_Number
```

Examples: `MamaT_interview_01`, `MamaT_kitchen_prep_02`, `MamaT_exterior_01`. Underscores separate words; the number counts up. This convention works on every operating system and sorts correctly.

Real-life comparison. Think of **sorting a basket of groundnuts**. You do not eat from the basket as it comes â€" you spread it, remove the stones, group the good ones, and put them in labelled bowls. Ingest is spreading the basket. Organisation is the labelled bowls.

Common misconception. "I will sort it later." Later never comes, because the edit is urgent and the mess is hidden. The two minutes spent naming files at the start saves two hours of hunting later.

F.4 The folder structure and the backup rule

The idea. A clean folder structure is a map. A backup is a spare key. Both are cheap; both are skipped by beginners and regretted by professionals.

The CEA project folder structure (draw this on the board):

```
CEA-Edit-FirstnameLastname/
â”œâ”€â”€ 01_Footage/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ PackA_TalkingHead/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ PackB_ProductBroll/      (added in later sessions)
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ PackC_EventMusic/        (added in later sessions)
â”œâ”€â”€ 02_Audio/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Music/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ SFX/
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Voiceover/
â”œâ”€â”€ 03_Exports/
â”œâ”€â”€ 04_ProjectFiles/
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ CapCut_Projects/
â”œâ”€â”€ 05_Archive/
â””â”€â”€ Docs/
    â””â”€â”€ ShotLogs/
```

```
â”œâ”€â”€ Briefs/
â””â”€â”€ HandoverNotes/
```

Why this works. Numbered folders sort in the right order on every computer. Underscores keep names clean. Every type of material has exactly one home, so you never wonder where to save something.

The backup rule â€” "one copy is no copy":

- **Rule:** every clip exists in **two separate places** before editing starts. Best practice is three (computer + USB drive + cloud), but two is the course minimum.
- **Why:** drives fail, phones get stolen, laptops get spilled on. The *only* thing that protects you is a second copy that the first copy's disaster cannot touch.
- **The 3-2-1 habit (professionals' version):** 3 copies, on 2 different types of storage, 1 off-site. For this course, we practise the simpler 2-copy rule and explain the 3-2-1 idea as the goal.

Real-life comparison. A backup is like **giving your spare house key to your sister who lives in a different street**. If your bag is stolen, you are not locked out. If your USB drive dies, you are not finished.

Nigerian context â€” a story to tell: "A learner once edited a whole wedding highlights video for two weeks. The night before delivery, the laptop's hard drive failed. She had no backup. The footage was on the couple's phone, but the couple had already wiped it for space. She could not deliver. Two copies of the raw footage would have saved the job â€” and her reputation."

F.5 Aspect ratio â€” the shape of the screen

The idea. The **aspect ratio** is the shape of the video frame â€” the relationship between its width and its height.

Plain-English definition. Aspect ratio is written as two numbers separated by a colon, like **16:9** or **9:16**. The first number is the width, the second is the height. The numbers are a ratio, not a measurement â€” 16:9 could be 1920Ã—1080 or 1280Ã—720; the shape is the same.

The four ratios beginners must know (draw each on the board):

Ratio	Shape	Looks like	Used for
16:9	Wide, horizontal	A television screen	YouTube, websites, TV, presentations, church projection
9:16	Tall, vertical	A phone held upright	TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, WhatsApp Status
1:1	Square	A framed picture	Instagram feed posts, Facebook feed
4:5	Slightly tall rectangle	A portrait photo	Instagram feed (higher reach than 1:1 because it fills more of the phone screen)

How to choose (the decision rule):

1. **Ask where the video will be watched.** On a laptop or TV â†’ 16:9. On a phone feed â†’ 9:16.
2. **Ask what the platform prefers.** TikTok, Reels and Shorts are 9:16 by design. Instagram feed can be 4:5 or 1:1. YouTube is 16:9.
3. **If you are not sure, choose 9:16 for social-first work** â€” because most phone video is watched vertically.
4. **Decide before the first cut.** Changing aspect ratio late means re-positioning every title and every keyframed animation.

What happens if you get it wrong. A 16:9 video posted to TikTok gets black bars top and bottom, and looks small and unloved. A 9:16 video on YouTube gets black bars left and right, and looks amateur. The viewer does not know the word "aspect ratio" â€” they just know the video looks wrong.

Real-life comparison. Think of **buying a frame for a picture**. A wide landscape photo needs a wide frame. A portrait needs a tall frame. You would not force a tall portrait into a wide frame and leave two empty strips â€” and you would not shoot a video in the wrong shape and hope the platform fixes it.

Nigerian context. Most Nigerian phone video is watched on phones â€” on buses, in shops, in church. This is why 9:16 is the default for business promos on Instagram and TikTok. But a church service recording for YouTube is 16:9. The professional asks first.

F.6 Resolution and frame rate â€” choosing before you cut

The idea. Resolution is how many pixels make up the picture. **Frame rate** is how many still pictures play per second. Both are *setup* decisions â€” they are expensive to change after editing.

Plain-English definitions:

- **Resolution** â€” the width Ã— height of the frame in pixels. **1920Ã—1080** (called "1080p" or "Full HD") is the standard for professional work. **1280Ã—720** ("720p") is acceptable for quick social posts but not for client work.
- **Frame rate** â€” how many frames (still images) play each second. **30 fps** (frames per second) is the standard for online video worldwide. **25 fps** is common in some broadcast traditions. **60 fps** is for smooth slow motion.

The rule for this course:

Decision	Course standard	When to change it
Resolution	**1920Ã—1080** for 16:9; **1080Ã—1920** for 9:16	Only if a platform or client specifically asks for something else
Frame rate	**30 fps**	Match the footage; never mix 30 fps and 60 fps in one project without a reason

Why you must decide before cutting. If you edit at 720p and the client asks for 1080p, you cannot create detail that was never captured â€” you can only stretch it, and it looks soft. If you mix frame rates, some clips stutter. Setup is a promise to the whole project.

Common misconception. "Higher is always better." No. A 4K video on a phone screen is wasted weight, and a 60 fps video of a talking head looks like a cheap soap opera (the "soap opera effect"). Choose what the *story* and the *platform* need.

Real-life comparison. Resolution is like **the size of your yam flour** â€” a small bag is fine for one meal, a big bag feeds a family. Frame rate is like **the rhythm of a drummer** â€” 30 is the steady groove of fuji; 60 is the fast roll of a solo. Pick the rhythm of the song you are playing.

F.7 What the editor contributes beyond the technical

The idea. An editor is not only a technician. An editor is a **guardian of the audience's time and trust**.

What that means in practice:

- **You protect attention.** Every second you keep is a second the viewer gave you. Waste it and they leave.
- **You protect truth.** You never cut words to change what someone meant. You shorten honestly; you do not deceive.
- **You protect privacy.** If a phone number, plate number or child's face appears, you blur or cut it.
- **You protect the client's files.** You return what is theirs, you keep your copies safe, and you do not reuse their footage without permission.

The three-line ethics rule (say it with the class):

> *"Only what we own or licence. Only with consent. Only the truth in the cut."*

Why this matters for a career. A client who trusts you with footage, deadlines and honesty comes back. A client whose video mutates a popular song into a copyright claim, or whose interviewee's words were twisted, tells five other people. In a city like Port Harcourt, where business runs on relationships, your editing ethics are your brand.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- An **editor** decides what the audience sees, in what order, and for how long â€” editing is decision-making.
- The workflow has **ten stages**: ingest â†’ organise â†’ log â†’ backup â†’ assembly â†’ rough cut â†’ fine cut â†’ sound â†’ colour â†’ titles/export/delivery/archive.
- **Ingest** copies footage safely; **organise** gives it a clean, named home; **log** notes what you have; **backup** puts two copies in two places.
- The folder structure is numbered and consistent: `01_Footage`, `02_Audio`, `03_Exports`, `04_ProjectFiles`, `05_Archive`, `Docs`.

- **Aspect ratio** is the frame's shape: 16:9 (wide), 9:16 (tall), 1:1 (square), 4:5 (portrait). Choose before cutting.
- **Resolution** is 1920Ã—1080 (1080p) for this course; **frame rate** is 30 fps.
- The editor is a guardian of attention, truth, privacy and the client's property.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Raw footage] --> B[Organise] --> C[Rough cut] --> D[Fine cut] --> E[Audio] --> F[Color] --> G[Export]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Walk the class through organising Pack A from a messy state to a professional, backed-up state â€” thinking aloud so learners see *how* a trained mind works. No editing software today; the tools are File Explorer, a USB drive and a printed shot log.

Setup: On the projector, show a folder named `PackA_messy` containing the raw Pack A files with their original names (`VID_20260314_1832.mp4`, etc.). Have a blank shot log open. Have a USB drive plugged in and visible.

Step 1 â€” Ingest and verify (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "First rule: copy, never move. The clips stay on the 'phone' â€” here the source folder â€— until I prove the copy is good."
- Copy all files into `01_Footage/PackA_TalkingHead/`.
- **Verify:** check the file count matches the manifest; check the total size; double-click two clips to confirm they play.
- **Ask:** "If the count matches but one file is corrupt, how would I know?" â†’ Answer: by playing a sample and checking the file sizes look similar.

Step 2 â€” Build the folder structure (3 minutes)

- Create the full CEA structure from F.4 on the projector, narrating each folder's job.
- **Say:** "Numbered folders sort correctly everywhere. One home per material type. I never have to wonder where to save something."

Step 3 â€” Rename with meaning (4 minutes)

- Rename the files from `VID_20260314_1832.mp4` to `MamaT_interview_01.mp4` etc., using the convention `ClientOrProject_ShotType_Number`.
- **Say:** "A good name tells me what the clip is without opening it. In three months, I will still know which file is the owner's interview."

Step 4 â€” Log the clips (3 minutes)

- Watch each clip's first few seconds (or skim with the playhead) and fill the shot log: what it shows, sound quality (Good/Okay/Poor), keep or park.
- **Say:** "Logging is watching with a pen. It feels slow now; it saves hours in the rough cut, because I already know where the good moments are."

Step 5 â€” Backup and verify the backup (3 minutes)

- Copy the entire `01_Footage` folder to the USB drive.
- **Verify the backup:** count files on the drive; open one clip from the drive itself.
- **Say:** "The backup is not done when the copy finishes. It is done when I have *proven* the copy works."

Expected result: A fully organised, renamed, logged and backed-up Pack A, with a completed shot log and a verified USB backup. The class has seen every habit that prevents the disasters in F.4.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why did I copy instead of move?" (To keep the original safe until verified.)
- "What would I do if the file count did not match?" (Find the missing file before editing.)
- "Why name the folders with numbers?" (So they sort in order on any computer.)
- "When is the backup really finished?" (When I open a file from the backup and it plays.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner organises **their own copy** of Pack A: ingest, build the folder structure, rename, log and back up to their USB drive.

Starting materials: Pack A from the shared class folder; a USB drive (16 GB); the printed shot log (Worksheet 1.1); the folder-structure handout; a pen.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Create your project folder `CEA-Edit-YourFirstnameLastname` on the computer.
2. Build the full folder structure inside it (01_Footage â†' PackA_TalkingHead, 02_Audio, 03_Exports, 04_ProjectFiles, 05_Archive, Docs â†' ShotLogs).
3. **Copy** (do not move) the Pack A files from the shared folder into `01_Footage/PackA_TalkingHead/`.
4. **Verify:** count the files â€" they must match the manifest. Open two clips to confirm they play.
5. **Rename** every file using the convention `MamaT_shotType_number`.
6. **Log** every clip on the shot log: what it shows, sound quality (Good/Okay/Poor), keep or park, and one note (e.g., "best moment at 0:12 â€" she smiles").
7. **Backup:** copy the entire `CEA-Edit-YourFirstnameLastname` folder to your USB drive.
8. **Verify the backup:** open one clip from the USB drive and confirm it plays.
9. Write your name on the USB drive with a marker (or a label file) so it cannot be lost.

Expected result: Every learner has an organised, renamed, logged and backed-up Pack A, with a completed shot log â€" the exact deliverable of Assignment 1.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "What does it mean if the count matches but the sizes are wildly different?" (One file may be corrupt or truncated.)
- After step 6: "Why write the 'best moment' note while logging?" (So in Session 3 you know where to cut without re-watching everything.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Learner moved instead of copied â†' Show them the source folder still exists; re-copy properly.
- File names refuse to change â†' Check they are not open in a player; close it and retry.
- USB drive not recognised â†' Try another USB port; check the drive is formatted (FAT32 or exFAT works everywhere).
- Shot log left blank â†' Prompt: "Watch ten seconds of the clip. What do you see? Write that down."
- Backup not verified â†' Ask: "If this drive fails tomorrow, how do you know the copy is good?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Project folder created with the correct name
- ☐ Full folder structure built (all six folders)
- ☐ Pack A copied (not moved) and verified
- ☐ Every file renamed with the convention
- ☐ Shot log completed for every clip
- ☐ Backup made to USB drive
- ☐ Backup verified by opening a file from it
- ☐ Name written on the USB drive

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Using the knowledge from today, design a complete **folder and backup plan** for a new client job â€" and write it down so another editor could follow it.

Scenario. You have been hired by *Adaeze Fashion*, a small dress shop in Port Harcourt, to edit a 30-second promo. The client hands you a phone with 40 clips: dress close-ups, a tailor working, a customer smiling, the shop exterior, and a short voice note

of the owner explaining the prices. You have one USB drive and the academy computer.

Requirements (write your answers in your workbook):

1. Draw the folder structure you will create (name every folder and subfolder).
2. Write the exact name you will give to each of these clips: the first dress close-up, the tailor working, the customer smiling, the shop exterior, the owner's voice note.
3. Write your backup plan: how many copies, where each copy lives, and how you will verify the backup.
4. Choose the aspect ratio for the finished promo if it will be posted to Instagram Reels â€" and explain your choice in one sentence.
5. State the resolution and frame rate you will edit at â€" and why.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Folder structure is complete, numbered and consistent with the class convention.
- Clip names follow the `ClientOrProject_ShotType_Number` convention.
- Backup plan has two copies in two places with a verification step.
- Aspect ratio is correct for the platform with a one-sentence reason.
- Resolution and frame rate match the course standard with a reason.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Look at the folder handout from Section F.4 â€" your structure should match it.
- Hint 2: For the names, replace "MamaT" with "Adaeze" and think about what each clip *shows*.
- Hint 3: Reels are watched on phones held upright â€" what shape is that?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

1. Folder structure:

```
CEA-Edit-AdaezeFashion/
â”œâ”€â”€ 01_Footage/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Adaeze_Promo/
â”œâ”€â”€ 02_Audio/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Music/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ SFX/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Voiceover/
â”œâ”€â”€ 03_Exports/
â”œâ”€â”€ 04_ProjectFiles/
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ CapCut_Projects/
â”œâ”€â”€ 05_Archive/
â”œâ”€â”€ Docs/
    â”œâ”€â”€ ShotLogs/
    â”œâ”€â”€ Briefs/
    â”œâ”€â”€ HandoverNotes/
```

2. Clip names:

- First dress close-up â†' `Adaeze_dress_closeup_01.mp4`
- Tailor working â†' `Adaeze_tailor_working_01.mp4`
- Customer smiling â†' `Adaeze_customer_smiling_01.mp4`
- Shop exterior â†' `Adaeze_shop_exterior_01.mp4`
- Owner's voice note â†' `Adaeze_owner_voicenote_01.m4a` (or `.mp4` if it is a video recording)

3. Backup plan:

- Copy 1: the academy computer's `CEA-Edit-AdaezeFolder` folder (working copy).
- Copy 2: the same folder on my labelled USB drive (backup copy).
- Verification: after copying, I count the files on both sides, compare sizes, and open one clip from the USB drive to confirm it plays.
- Rule: I never delete the client's phone clips until the job is delivered AND the client has confirmed receipt.

4. Aspect ratio: **9:16** â€" because Instagram Reels are watched full-screen on phones held upright, and 9:16 fills that screen.

5. Resolution and frame rate: **1920Ã—1080 for 16:9 or 1080Ã—1920 for 9:16 at 30 fps** â€" because 1080p is the professional standard, and 30 fps is the standard frame rate for online video; the footage is shot at 30 fps, so the project matches it.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Folder structure complete and numbered (2)
- Clip names follow the convention (2)
- Two-copy backup with verification (2)
- Aspect ratio correct for Reels with reason (2)
- Resolution and frame rate correct with reason (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chinedu* runs a small phone-accessory shop in Port Harcourt. Over six months he shot 60 videos of products â€" power banks, earphones, chargers â€" all on his phone. He wants to post a promo on Instagram but every time he opens his gallery he feels overwhelmed and puts it down. A competitor down the street posts clean 30-second videos every week and gets orders. Chinedu's clips are actually good â€" clear, well-lit â€" but they live in a gallery with 2,000 other photos and videos, and he cannot find the good ones.

Relevant facts.

- Chinedu's clips are well-lit and in focus â€" the shooting is fine.
- His gallery has 2,000+ items; product clips are mixed with family photos and screenshots.
- He has never made a backup. His phone is two years old and has been repaired once.
- He tried editing once, gave up after an hour, and never went back.

Decision point. What is actually stopping Chinedu â€" his clips, his software, or his workflow?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone and reshoot everything.
2. Learn to edit fast first, and organise later.
3. Organise, log and back up the existing clips â€" then edit from a clean set.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Chinedu's problem is not the quality of his clips â€" it is that 60 good clips are lost in 2,000 unsorted files with no backup. Reshooting costs money and still leaves the same mess. Learning to edit before organising means editing in chaos. The professional sequence â€" organise, log, backup, then edit â€" costs nothing but two focused hours and unlocks clips he already has.

Reasoning / what Chinedu would do:

- Create a project folder for the promo.
- Copy the 60 product clips into `01_Footage`.
- Rename them `Chinedu_product_type_number`.
- Log them: which show the power bank best, which have the clearest close-up.
- Back up to a USB drive and verify.
- Now edit â€" from a clean, findable set.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: costs â‚¦150,000+ and still leaves the workflow problem â€" next month there will be another 60 unsorted clips.
- Approach 2: makes the editing harder, because every edit session starts with a treasure hunt through 2,000 files.
- Approach 3: costs nothing but time, fixes the root cause, and builds the habit that will serve every future job.

Professional connection. Clients do not pay for footage â€" they pay for a **finished video they can use**. A client like Chinedu will pay **â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦30,000** for a clean 30-second promo that makes their products look professional. The editor who can receive 60 messy clips and return a finished video in two days â€" because their workflow is disciplined â€" is the editor who gets hired again. This is the skill Chinedu needs, and it is the skill this course teaches first.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Moving instead of copying during ingest

Symptoms: The source folder is empty after ingest; if the copy was interrupted, files are lost. **Likely cause:** Learners drag files (which moves) instead of copy-pasting (which copies). **How to investigate:** Ask: "Is the file still in the source folder?" **Corrective steps:** Always right-click â†' Copy, then right-click in the destination â†' Paste. Keep the original until the copy is verified. **How to confirm resolved:** Source folder still has the files after ingest. **Prevention:** Say the rule out loud at every ingest: "Copy, then verify, then delete â€" in that order."

K.2 Skipping the verification step

Symptoms: Files appear copied but some are corrupt or truncated; the edit breaks mid-session. **Likely cause:** Copying without checking file counts, sizes and playback. **How to investigate:** Compare file counts and total sizes between source and destination; open a sample. **Corrective steps:** Count files, compare sizes, open at least two clips from the copy. **How to confirm resolved:** Count matches, sizes match, clips play. **Prevention:** Make verification part of the definition of "done" â€" a copy is not done until it plays.

K.3 Random file names kept ("I will remember what they are")

Symptoms: In three days, `VID_20260314_1832.mp4` is meaningless; the learner cannot find the owner's interview. **Likely cause:** The original camera names mean nothing to a human. **How to investigate:** Show a file with its original name and ask: "What does this clip show?" **Corrective steps:** Rename with the convention `ClientOrProject_ShotType_Number`. **How to confirm resolved:** Every file name describes its contents. **Prevention:** Rename during organisation, not during the edit.

K.4 No backup â€" "one copy is no copy"

Symptoms: A drive fails or a phone is lost and the footage is gone forever. **Likely cause:** The learner edited from a single copy on one device. **How to investigate:** Ask: "If your USB drive died right now, how many copies of this footage exist?" **Corrective steps:** Copy the entire project folder to a second location; verify it. **How to confirm resolved:** Two copies exist in two places, both verified. **Prevention:** Make the backup rule part of every project's setup checklist.

K.5 Choosing the aspect ratio late

Symptoms: Titles and animations are misplaced after a late change; black bars appear on the platform. **Likely cause:** Aspect ratio was not decided before editing started. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Where will this video be watched, and what shape is that screen?" **Corrective steps:** Decide the platform first, then the ratio, then set up the project. **How to confirm resolved:** The project's aspect ratio matches the delivery platform. **Prevention:** Make the delivery platform the first question of every job.

K.6 Editing at the wrong resolution

Symptoms: The exported video looks soft or blurry on a big screen. **Likely cause:** The project was set to 720p when 1080p was needed, or the footage was lower resolution than the project. **How to investigate:** Check the project settings against the delivery spec. **Corrective steps:** Set the project to 1080p before cutting; never upscale low-resolution footage. **How to confirm resolved:** Project settings match the delivery spec and the footage. **Prevention:** Resolution and frame rate are setup decisions â€" decide them before the first cut.

K.7 Skipping the shot log

Symptoms: The rough cut takes three times longer because the learner re-watches every clip to find the good moments. **Likely cause:** No log was made during organisation. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Do you know which clip has the owner's best line?" **Corrective steps:** Log every clip: what it shows, sound quality, best moment. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can point to the best clip without re-watching the pack. **Prevention:** Make the shot log part of organisation â€" it is the map for the edit.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the second copy, or point to the file with the correct name). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Organised Pack â€" Folder, Shot Log and Backup Plan"

Purpose: To practise the professional setup habits â€" organising, naming, logging and backing up footage â€" that prevent the disasters learners know from experience, and to build the project folder the capstone will use.

Realistic scenario. You are preparing to edit a 60-second video for a Port Harcourt client. You have been given a footage pack (a set of talking-head clips and cutaways) and a blank USB drive. Your job is to turn the raw pack into a professional, ready-to-edit project.

Detailed instructions:

1. Create your project folder `CEA-Edit-YourFirstnameLastname` with the full folder structure from Section F.4.
2. Copy the supplied footage pack into `01_Footage` and verify the copy (count, size, playback).
3. Rename every file using the `ClientOrProject_ShotType_Number` convention.
4. Complete a shot log (Worksheet 1.1) for every clip: what it shows, sound quality, keep or park, and a note on the best moment.
5. Back up the entire project folder to your USB drive and verify the backup by opening one file from it.
6. Write a one-paragraph backup plan (Worksheet 1.2): how many copies, where they live, and how you verify them.
7. Write one sentence: "I choose to organise before editing because _____."

Required deliverables:

- The completed folder structure on the academy computer (checked in class).
- The completed shot log (handwritten or typed).
- The completed backup plan.
- The USB drive with the verified backup.

Submission format: Shot log and backup plan as a typed document (`Session1_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week1/Setup/` , plus the USB drive checked in class.

Deadline: Before Session 2.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Folder structure complete and numbered	4	All folders present, correctly named, in order
Files renamed with the convention	3	Every file name describes its contents
Shot log completed	4	Every clip logged with content, sound, keep/park and best moment
Backup completed and verified	4	Two copies in two places; verification steps described
Written reflection	2	Clear one-sentence reason for organising first
Neatness and completeness	3	Everything findable, legible and professional

Common mistakes to avoid: moving instead of copying; skipping verification; keeping camera file names; no backup; a blank shot log; doing it "later."

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: the full numbered folder structure; every clip renamed (e.g., `Client_interview_01` , `Client_exterior_01`); a shot log where each row names the clip content, rates sound, marks keep/park and notes a best moment; a backup plan stating two copies (computer + USB), verification by count/size/playback; and a reflection sentence such as: *"I choose to organise before editing because a clean folder saves hours and protects the footage from loss."*

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. In your own words, what does an editor actually do?

Q2. List. Name the first four stages of the ten-stage post-production workflow, in order.

Q3. Multiple choice. Which aspect ratio is correct for a video that will be posted to TikTok? a) 16:9 b) 1:1 c) 9:16 d) 4:5

Q4. True or false. It is safe to delete the original footage from your phone as soon as you have copied it to the computer.

Q5. Explain. Why do we say "one copy is no copy"?

Q6. Scenario. You are about to edit a 1080p YouTube video. You set your project to 720p. What will happen, and why is it a problem?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1. An editor decides what the audience sees, in what order, and for how long â€” selecting the best of the footage and shaping it into a coherent, finished video. (Accept any answer covering selection, order and shaping.)

A2. Ingest â†’ Organise â†’ Log â†’ Backup (then assembly, rough cut, fine cut, sound, colour, titles/export/delivery/archive).

A3. (c) 9:16 â€” TikTok is a vertical, phone-first platform.

A4. False. You should keep the original until the copy is verified (count, size, playback) AND you are sure you will not need the original again.

A5. Because a single copy can be lost â€” a phone can be stolen, a drive can fail, a file can be deleted by mistake. A second copy in a second place is the only protection. One copy is no copy.

A6. The exported video will be 720p, which looks soft and unprofessional on YouTube â€” especially when watched on a larger screen. The problem is that detail cannot be recovered after editing; 1080p must be chosen at setup, before the first cut.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned what an editor really does â€” not pushing buttons, but **deciding** what the audience sees, in what order, and for how long. You learned the **ten-stage workflow** from ingest to archive, and why the boring first four stages (organise, log, backup) are what make the fast stages possible. You built a professional folder structure, renamed files with meaning, logged every clip and made a verified backup. You learned the four aspect ratios and how to choose before cutting. And you met the editor's deeper duty: to protect the audience's time, the truth, and the client's property.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Editing is decision-making** â€” selection, order, pace and feel.
2. **The workflow has ten stages** â€” learn the order once; it applies to every job.
3. **Organise, log and back up before the first cut** â€" "one copy is no copy."
4. **Name files so a stranger would know what they show.**
5. **Choose aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate before editing** â€” setup mistakes are expensive to undo.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain the ten workflow stages in order?
- Can I organise a messy footage pack into a clean, named structure?
- Can I back up footage and prove the backup works?
- Can I choose the right aspect ratio for a platform and say why?
- Can I explain what an editor contributes to a story?

Connection to the next session. Your footage is now organised, named, logged and backed up â€” a professional foundation. Next session you meet the tool itself: **CapCut**, on both mobile and desktop. You will import your pack, learn the timeline, the tracks, the playhead and the basic tools â€" and you will build your **first assembly**: your clips placed in story order, with no music, text or effects. The discipline you built today is what makes that assembly clean.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner explains the editor's job as decision-making, not button-pushing.
- Learner recites the ten workflow stages in order without looking.
- Learner's folder structure matches the class convention without prompting.
- Learner renames files using the `ClientOrProject_ShotType_Number` convention.
- Learner verifies a backup by opening a file from the backup drive.
- Learner chooses 9:16 for a TikTok/Reels job and gives a reason.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I will sort it later." â†' Later never comes; the habit is the skill.
- "Moving is the same as copying." â†' Moving removes the original; copy keeps it safe.
- "The backup is done when the copy finishes." â†' It is done when the copy plays.
- "Any aspect ratio works anywhere." â†' Wrong shape means black bars and an amateur look.
- "The workflow is for big productions." â†' Skipped workflow is why a 200-clip gallery stays messy for years.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Folder drill:** give a messy folder of 10 files and ask the learner to build the structure and rename everything in 10 minutes.
2. **Workflow ordering:** print the ten stage names on cards; the learner arranges them in order and says each one's job.
3. **Ratio matching:** show five platform logos (YouTube, TikTok, Reels, Instagram feed, WhatsApp) and ask the learner to match each to its aspect ratio.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a pre-built folder skeleton; the learner renames files and completes the shot log with prompts.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full structure, rename, log, backup.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to design a folder structure for a *two-camera* event job (two audio sources, two camera angles) and explain how they would keep the angles and audio organised so the edit never confuses them.

Timing guidance. The priority is **learners building their own organised, backed-up project** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the backup verification demo. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without an organised, backed-up pack has no foundation for Session 2.

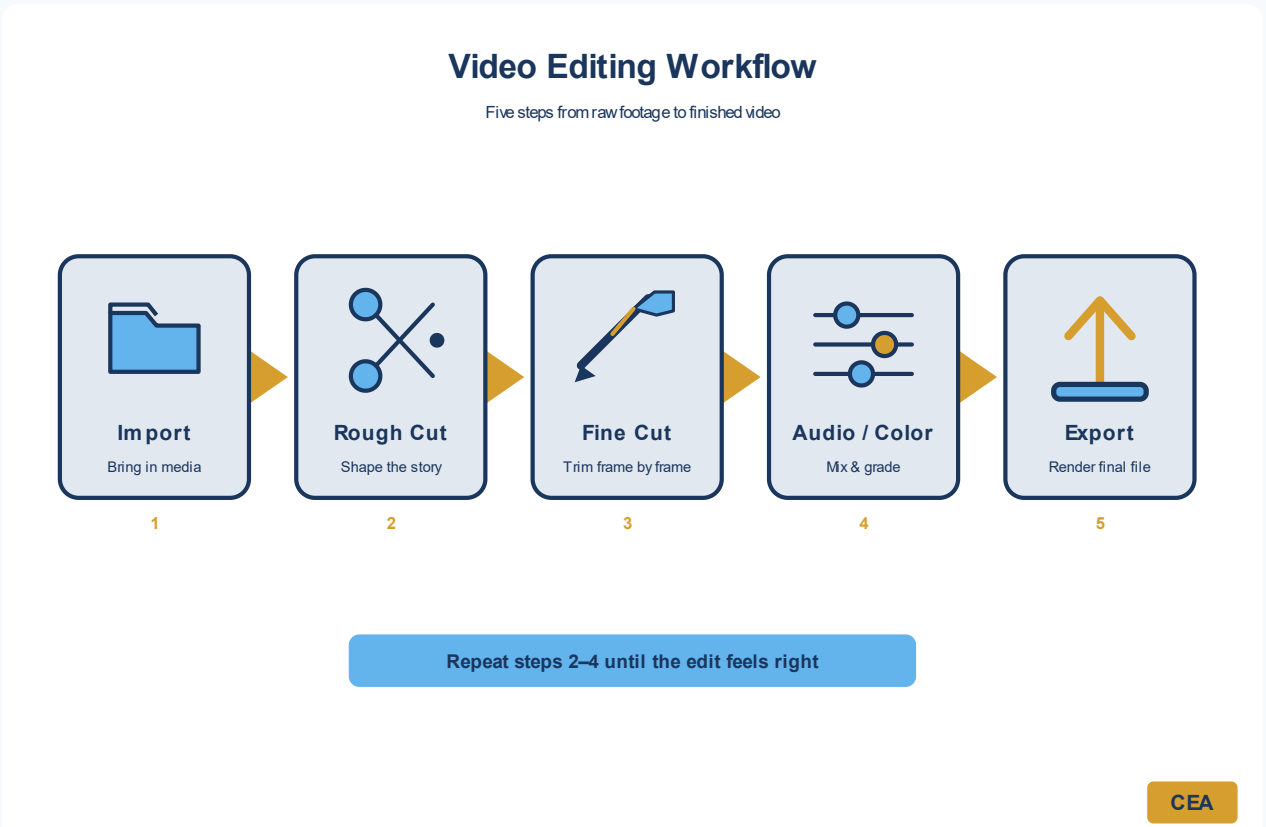
END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Editing Software and Interface.

SESSION 02 OF 9

Editing Software and Interface

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 2 â€" EDITING SOFTWARE AND INTERFACE

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 9
Session title	Editing Software and Interface
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations and Story
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first hands-on editing)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 â€" learners must have their organised, backed-up Pack A with a completed shot log. Basic computer confidence (mouse, keyboard, opening apps). No prior editing experience

Item	Detail
	assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 you organised, named, logged and backed up your footage. Today that discipline pays off: you open CapCut for the first time, learn the interface, and build your **first assembly** â€” your clips placed in story order on the timeline, with no music, text or effects. The clean folder from Session 1 is what makes this assembly fast.
Preparation before class	CapCut desktop installed and tested on every academy computer (free version); CapCut mobile installed on the instructor's phone (to show the mobile interface); Pack A already organised in each learner's project folder from Session 1; a projector showing the instructor's screen; a sample "first assembly" pre-built by the instructor to show the finished result; headphones available for the next session (remind learners).

Instructor note on tone: This is the session where learners touch the tool for the first time. Some will be excited; some will be nervous. Move slowly, repeat the core actions, and celebrate the first assembly loudly. The goal is not to learn every button â€” it is to learn the *five core actions* (import, place, split, trim, reorder) that every edit in the world is built from.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Open** CapCut on desktop and mobile, create a new project, and set the aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate correctly before importing.
2. **Import** footage from an organised folder into the media library, and explain why we import from a clean, named folder.
3. **Identify** the four main areas of the CapCut interface â€” media library, preview window, timeline and tools panel â€” and state what each does.
4. **Place** clips on the timeline in story order to build a **first assembly**, with no music, text or effects.
5. **Split, trim and reorder** clips using the basic tools, and explain what the playhead is and how it controls where an edit happens.
6. **Save and name** the project file correctly, and explain why the project file is not the video.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut desktop installed.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- The instructor's phone with CapCut mobile installed (to show the mobile interface side by side).
- USB flash drives with each learner's organised Pack A (from Session 1).

Software

- **CapCut desktop** (free) â€” the main tool for this session. Installed and tested before class.
- **CapCut mobile** (free) â€” shown by the instructor; learners who prefer phone editing can follow along on their own phones.
- File Explorer â€” to locate the organised footage folder.

Sample files

- Each learner's organised **Pack A** (from Session 1): talking-head clips and cutaways, renamed and logged.
- A **pre-built sample assembly** (made by the instructor) to show the finished result on the projector.
- The **footage manifest** from Session 1 (for reference).

Worksheets

- Worksheet 2.1 â€” "Interface Tour" â€” a labelled diagram of the CapCut desktop interface with blank boxes for learners to fill in: media library, preview window, timeline, tools panel, playhead.
- Worksheet 2.2 â€” "First Assembly Checklist" â€” a tick-list for the practical.

Accounts

- A free **CapCut account** (email sign-up). Learners who do not have one create it now â€" this takes 2 minutes and is needed for cloud features and syncing. No payment is ever required.

Internet

- Needed only for the CapCut account sign-up and to download the app if not pre-installed. The editing itself works offline once the app is installed.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut installed works. A learner with only a phone can do the entire session in CapCut mobile â€" the concepts (import, timeline, split, trim, reorder) are identical; only the button positions differ.

Instructor note on app updates: CapCut updates often and buttons move. Teach the *principles* (import, place, split, trim, reorder) and the *names* of the interface areas â€" not the exact pixel position of every button. If a button has moved, the principle is still what is assessed.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, play a **30-second before-and-after**. First, show 10 seconds of raw, unedited footage: a talking-head clip with a long pause, a shaky start, a "um" in the middle, and a clip that runs too long. Then show the same moment after editing: the pause removed, the "um" cut out, the clip tightened, the best moment kept.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Look at these two clips. Same person, same camera, same room. The first one is what the camera recorded. The second one is what an **editor** made from it.*
>
> *The difference is not magic. It is five actions: **import, place, split, trim, reorder.** That is it. Every edit you have ever watched â€" a Nollywood film, a church highlight, a TikTok â€" is built from those five actions, repeated a thousand times with taste and patience.*
>
> *Today you learn those five actions. By the end of this session, you will have built your **first assembly**: your clips, in story order, on a timeline. It will have no music, no text, no effects â€" and it will be the most important video you have made so far, because it is the first one you shaped."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "so that is all editing is?", "I thought it was harder", "can I really do this today?" Accept all answers. Say: "Editing is simple to start and deep to master. Today we start â€" properly."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"A professional does not open the software and start clicking. A professional sets up the project first â€" the same way you organised your folder in Session 1. Setup is a habit. We do it the same way every time."*

Why this opener works: It shows the transformation (raw â†' edited) in seconds, it demystifies editing (five actions, not magic), and it sets the expectation that every learner will produce something real today.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the first four stages of the post-production workflow, and what does each one do?"

- Expected answer: Ingest (move footage to the computer), Organise (folders and names), Log (note what each clip shows), Backup (two copies in two places).
- Common gap: learners remember the words but not the order. Clarify: "Ingest before organise, organise before log, log before backup â€" each stage prepares the next."

Question 2: "Why did we rename our files in Session 1 instead of keeping the camera names?"

- Expected answer: So we can find any clip in ten seconds; so a good name tells us what the clip shows without opening it.
- Common gap: learners think renaming is optional polish. Clarify: "Renaming is not polish â€" it is the difference between a ten-second find and a ten-minute hunt."

Question 3: "What is the playhead?" (Show a picture of a timeline with a vertical line.)

- Expected answer: The vertical line that shows where you are in the video; it is where edits happen.
- Common gap: many learners have never heard the word. Clarify: "The playhead is like your finger on a page â€" it marks the exact spot where you are working."

Question 4: "What aspect ratio will you use for a YouTube video, and what resolution?"

- Expected answer: 16:9 for YouTube; 1920Ã—1080 (1080p) resolution.
- Common gap: learners confuse aspect ratio with resolution. Clarify: "Ratio is the shape; resolution is the detail. Both are setup decisions."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have your organised pack, your shot log and your backup. Now you open the tool. The interface looks busy â€" but it has only four areas that matter today, and five actions that matter forever. Learn those, and you can edit anything."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing the workflow stages on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why CapCut â€" and why free is enough

The idea. CapCut is a free video-editing application made by ByteDance (the company behind TikTok). It runs on Windows, Mac, Android and iOS. It is the tool this course uses because it is free, powerful enough for professional work, and available to every learner.

Plain-English definition. CapCut is a program that lets you import video clips, arrange them on a timeline, cut and trim them, add music and text, and export a finished video file.

Why this course uses it:

- **It is free.** No subscription, no trial that expires, no watermark on exports (unlike some free editors).
- **It is everywhere.** A learner can start on a phone and continue on a desktop â€" the workflow is the same.
- **It is powerful enough.** CapCut handles multi-track editing, keyframes, speed changes, colour tools and captions â€" everything this course teaches and more.
- **It is what the market uses.** Many small businesses, churches and creators in Nigeria already use CapCut; knowing it is a real employable skill.

The honest limitation. CapCut is not the only tool, and it is not the most powerful tool in the world. DaVinci Resolve (free) is stronger for colour; Adobe Premiere Pro (paid) is the industry standard in big studios. But CapCut covers everything a beginner and a freelancer need â€" and the *principles* you learn in CapCut transfer to any other editor. Learn the principle, and the button is just a button.

Real-life comparison. Think of CapCut like a **small, sharp kitchen knife**. A chef's knife set has twenty blades, but a sharp small knife can prepare 90% of meals. CapCut is that knife â€" and a learner who masters it can cook real food.

Common misconception. "Free software is for amateurs." No. Free software is a *choice* â€" and for a beginner in Nigeria, it is the smart choice. A â‚¦40,000 course that requires a â‚¦200,000 software subscription would be a bad course. This one requires nothing but free tools.

F.2 The four areas of the interface

The idea. Every video editor â€" CapCut, Premiere, Resolve, iMovie â€" has the same four areas. Learn them once and you can find your way in any software.

The four areas (draw this on the board):

Area	What it is	What you do there
1. Media Library	The box where your imported clips, music and images live	Import, preview and select material
2. Preview Window	The screen that plays your video	Watch the current frame; check your work
3. Timeline	The horizontal strip where clips are arranged in order	Place, split, trim and reorder clips
4. Tools Panel	The buttons for actions (split, delete, text, audio, etc.)	Perform edits on the selected clip

The playhead (the fifth thing to know): The **playhead** is the vertical line on the timeline that shows the exact moment you are working on. It is where splits happen, where you place clips, and where you check your edits. Everything in editing happens *at the playhead*.

How the four areas work together (the loop):

1. You **import** clips into the media library.
2. You **drag** a clip from the library to the timeline.
3. You **move** the playhead to where you want to cut.
4. You **use** a tool (split, trim) to make the edit.
5. You **watch** the result in the preview window.
6. Repeat.

Real-life comparison. The interface is like a **kitchen**: the media library is your fridge (ingredients), the timeline is your counter (where you assemble), the preview window is your plate (what you check before serving), and the tools panel is your knives and spoons. A cook who knows the kitchen can cook in any restaurant.

Common misconception. "I need to learn every button." No. Today you learn the four areas and five actions. The other buttons are for later sessions â€" and you will learn them the same way: one at a time, with a reason.

F.3 Project setup â€" the promise you make before the first cut

The idea. Before importing a single clip, you **set up the project**: aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate. This is the digital version of Session 1's folder structure â€" a promise you make to the whole project.

The setup steps (in order):

1. **Open CapCut and click "New Project".**
2. **Set the aspect ratio** â€" for this session's assembly, use **16:9** (the standard for learning; we will change it for specific platforms in later sessions).
3. **Set the resolution** â€" **1920Ã—1080** (1080p).
4. **Set the frame rate** â€" **30 fps** (matching the footage).
5. **Name the project** â€" `CEA-YourName_Assembly1` (using the naming convention from Session 1).

Why this order matters. If you import clips first and set up later, CapCut may guess the settings from the first clip â€" and if that clip is the wrong shape or frame rate, the whole project is wrong. Setup first, import second.

What the project file is â€" and is not. The **project file** (in CapCut, it is saved in the app's project list) is a *set of instructions*: which clips, in which order, with which edits. It is **not** the video. The video is created only when you **export**. This is why you can save a project, close the computer, and come back tomorrow â€" the project remembers everything.

Real-life comparison. Setting up a project is like **laying out your ingredients and tools before you cook**. A cook who starts cooking and then realises the pot is the wrong size has wasted time and food. Setup first, cook second.

Common misconception. "The project file is the video, so I can share it with the client." No. The client needs the **exported video file** (the MP4). The project file is your working document â€" it is for you, not the client.

F.4 Import â€" bringing your organised footage into the tool

The idea. Import means bringing your video clips from the folder on your computer into CapCut's media library, so the software can use them.

The import steps:

1. In CapCut, click **"Import"** (or the media library's add button).
2. Navigate to your organised folder: `01_Footage/PackA_TalkingHead/`.
3. Select the clips you need (use your shot log to choose).
4. Click **Open** â€" the clips appear in the media library.

Why we import from an organised folder. In Session 1 you renamed and logged your clips. Now that work pays off: you can find `Client_interview_01` in seconds, instead of hunting through `VID_20260314_1832.mp4`. The import is fast because the organisation was done first.

What import does NOT do. Importing does not move, rename or delete your original files. The originals stay safe in your folder; CapCut makes a reference to them. This is why the backup from Session 1 matters â€" if a clip is missing, the project shows it as "offline."

Real-life comparison. Import is like **taking ingredients out of the fridge and putting them on the counter**. The fridge (your folder) stays full; the counter (the media library) is where you work.

Common misconception. "Importing copies the clips into the project, so I can delete the originals." No. Importing creates a reference. If you delete the original, the project loses the clip. Keep your organised folder intact.

F.5 The five core actions â€" the alphabet of editing

The idea. Every edit ever made is built from five actions. Master these and you can edit anything.

The five actions (teach them in this order):

1. Place (drag to timeline). Click a clip in the media library and drag it onto the timeline. It becomes a block on the track. The order of blocks is the order of your video.

2. Split (cut at the playhead). Move the playhead to the exact frame where you want to cut, then click **Split**. The clip becomes two separate clips. This is how you remove a pause, an "um", or a bad take.

3. Trim (shorten the ends). Click the edge of a clip on the timeline and drag it inward to shorten the clip, or outward to lengthen it. This is how you tighten a clip without cutting it in the middle.

4. Reorder (move clips around). Click a clip on the timeline and drag it to a new position. This is how you fix the story order â€" move a clip earlier or later.

5. Delete (remove a clip). Select a clip and press Delete (or click the delete tool). This is how you remove a clip you do not need. Use it carefully â€" and remember that deleting from the timeline does not delete the original file.

The loop that is editing: Place â†' Split â†' Trim â†' Reorder â†' Delete â†' watch â†' repeat. That loop, done with taste, is the whole craft.

Real-life comparison. The five actions are like **cutting and arranging a plate of food**: place the items on the plate (place), cut a piece in half (split), trim the edges (trim), move the rice to the centre (reorder), and remove the bone (delete). The plate is your timeline; the meal is your video.

Worked example â€" the first assembly:

- You have 6 talking-head clips and 2 cutaways.
- You place them on the timeline in story order: intro clip â†' point 1 â†' point 2 â†' point 3 â†' closing clip.
- You split out the long pause in clip 2.
- You trim the shaky start of clip 4.
- You reorder: move the closing clip earlier because it works better there.
- You delete a clip that repeats what another clip says.
- Result: a 60-second assembly with no music, text or effects â€" just story order.

Common misconception. "I need to learn more tools before I can edit." No. These five actions are enough to build a complete assembly. The fancy tools come later â€" and you will appreciate them more because you understand what they add to these five.

F.6 The timeline and tracks â€” where the video is built

The idea. The **timeline** is the horizontal strip at the bottom of the screen where your clips are arranged. It is the heart of the editor.

Plain-English definition. The timeline is a visual representation of your video from start to finish. Time runs left to right. Each block is a clip. The playhead moves across as the video plays.

Tracks â€” the layers of the timeline. The timeline has **tracks** â€ horizontal layers stacked vertically. The main video clips live on the **video track** (usually the lowest one). Above it, you can add more video tracks for overlays, and below or beside it, **audio tracks** for music and sound. For this session, you use one video track and its attached audio.

Why tracks matter. Tracks let you layer material: a talking-head clip on the main track, a cutaway on a track above it (to cover a jump), music on an audio track below. Learning to think in tracks is learning to think like an editor.

The zoom control. The timeline has a zoom slider. Zoom out to see the whole video; zoom in to make precise cuts. Beginners often cut at the wrong zoom level â€ too far out to be precise, or too far in to see the story. Learn to zoom for the task.

Real-life comparison. The timeline is like a **seamstress's table**: the fabric (clips) is laid out in order, cut to size (split/trim), and arranged (reorder) before it is sewn. The tracks are the layers of fabric â€ the main piece, the lining, the decoration.

Common misconception. "More tracks = more professional." No. A clean edit on one track is better than a messy edit on five. Tracks are tools, not trophies.

F.7 Saving, naming and the project file habit

The idea. Saving is not optional. Saving with a good name is a professional habit.

The save habit:

- **Save early, save often.** CapCut auto-saves, but get in the habit of saving after every significant edit.
- **Name the project clearly.** `CEA-YourName_Assembly1` â€ not "Untitled" or "Project 1".
- **Know where it lives.** CapCut saves projects in its own project list; the exported video goes to your `03_Exports` folder.

The project file vs. the export (repeat this until it sticks):

- The **project file** is your working document â€ the instructions. It is small and fast.
- The **exported video** is the finished file â€ the MP4 you deliver. It is large and final.
- You can have many project files; you export when the edit is done.

Real-life comparison. The project file is like a **recipe**; the export is the **cooked meal**. You can reuse the recipe; you cannot uncook the meal. A client wants the meal â€ but you keep the recipe.

Common misconception. "If I save the project, I have the video." No. The project is the recipe. Without exporting, there is no video to share.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- **CapCut** is free, powerful enough, and the right tool for this course â€ and the principles transfer to any editor.
- The interface has **four areas**: media library, preview window, timeline, tools panel â€ plus the **playhead**.
- **Setup before import**: aspect ratio, resolution, frame rate, project name.
- **Import** brings clips from your organised folder into the media library â€ without moving or deleting the originals.
- The **five core actions** are: place, split, trim, reorder, delete. Every edit is built from these.
- The **timeline** is where the video is built; **tracks** are its layers.
- The **project file** is the recipe; the **export** is the meal. Save often, name clearly.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Open CapCut] --> B[Import media] --> B --> C[Timeline] --> C --> D[Drag clips] --> D --> E[First assembly]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Build a complete first assembly live on the projector, narrating every decision, so learners see the five actions produce a real result.

Setup: CapCut desktop open on the projector. Pack A organised in the instructor's project folder. A blank timeline ready.

Step 1 â€" Set up the project (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "Setup first, always. I choose 16:9, 1080p, 30 fps â€" the course standard. I name the project `CEA-Instructor_Assembly1`."
- Click through the setup on screen. Point out where the settings are.
- **Ask:** "Why before import?" â†' So CapCut does not guess from the first clip.

Step 2 â€" Import the pack (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "I import from my organised folder â€" the one I built in Session 1. I can find every clip in seconds because I renamed and logged them."
- Import 4â€"5 clips from the media library. Point out that the originals stay in the folder.
- **Ask:** "Did import move my files?" â†' No, it references them.

Step 3 â€" Place clips in story order (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "The assembly is just story order. No music, no text, no effects. I place the intro first, then the points, then the close."
- Drag clips from the library to the timeline in order. Point out the blocks forming on the track.
- **Ask:** "What is the timeline showing me?" â†' The order of my video, left to right.

Step 4 â€" Split and trim (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "Now the craft. Clip 2 has a long pause â€" I move the playhead to the pause, split, and delete the pause. Clip 4 has a shaky start â€" I trim the edge."
- Perform the splits and trims on screen. Show the playhead moving, the split happening, the clip shortening.
- **Ask:** "What did the split do?" â†' It cut the clip into two at the playhead.

Step 5 â€" Reorder and delete (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "Watching it back, the closing works better earlier. I drag it. And clip 3 repeats clip 1 â€" I delete it from the timeline."
- Drag the clip to its new position; delete the repeated clip.
- **Ask:** "Did delete remove the original file?" â†' No, only from the timeline.

Step 6 â€" Watch the result (2 minutes)

- Play the full assembly on the projector. It is rough â€" no music, no text â€" but it tells the story in order.
- **Say:** "That is a first assembly. It is not finished â€" but it is *shaped*. Every professional edit starts exactly like this."

Expected result: A 45â€"60 second assembly on the timeline, built from five clips, with splits, trims, a reorder and a delete â€" the exact model learners will follow.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What are the four areas of the interface?" (Library, preview, timeline, tools.)
- "Where does a split happen?" (At the playhead.)
- "What is the difference between the project file and the export?" (Recipe vs. meal.)
- "Why no music or text in the assembly?" (Story first; craft comes later.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner builds their **first assembly** in CapCut desktop (or mobile) from their organised Pack A.

Starting materials: CapCut open on the academy computer; the learner's organised Pack A in their project folder; the shot log from Session 1; Worksheet 2.2 (checklist).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open CapCut and click **New Project**.

2. Set **aspect ratio 16:9**, **resolution 1920Ã—1080**, **frame rate 30 fps**.
3. Name the project `CEA-YourName_Assembly1`.
4. **Import** 5â€“6 clips from your organised `01_Footage/PackA_TalkingHead` folder.
5. **Place** the clips on the timeline in story order: intro â†' points â†' close.
6. **Watch** the assembly once in the preview window.
7. **Split** out one long pause or "um" (move playhead â†' split â†' delete the unwanted part).
8. **Trim** the shaky or slow start of one clip.
9. **Reorder** one clip to a better position.
10. **Delete** one clip that repeats another.
11. **Watch** the full assembly again. Does the story make sense?
12. **Save** the project.

Expected result: A 45â€“75 second first assembly on the timeline, built from 5â€–6 clips, with at least one split, one trim, one reorder and one delete â€" no music, text or effects.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 6: "Does the story make sense in this order? If not, what would you move?"
- After step 10: "What did you remove, and why?" (This is the editor's decision â€" the start of cut craft.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Clips will not import â†' Check the file format (MP4 and MOV work; some phone formats need conversion).
- Split button greyed out â†' The playhead is not on the clip; move it onto the clip first.
- Timeline looks empty â†' The clip was placed on a hidden track; check the track headers.
- Project will not save â†' Check the name has no special characters; try again.
- Preview is choppy â†' This is normal on academy computers; the export will be smooth.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Project created with correct settings (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps)
- ☐ Project named with the convention
- ☐ 5â€–6 clips imported from the organised folder
- ☐ Clips placed in story order
- ☐ At least one split performed
- ☐ At least one trim performed
- ☐ At least one reorder performed
- ☐ At least one delete performed
- ☐ Full assembly watched and makes sense
- ☐ Project saved

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Build a **second, different assembly** from the same pack â€" this time making your own decisions, without the instructor's step-by-step guidance.

Scenario. You are editing a short video for a community organisation. You have the same Pack A footage, but this time the story is: "Why our community needs a new youth centre." You must build a 30â€–45 second assembly that tells this story using only the footage you have.

Requirements:

1. Create a new project with the correct settings.
2. Import and place 4â€–5 clips in an order that tells the story.
3. Use **all five core actions** at least once: place, split, trim, reorder, delete.
4. Watch the full assembly and check: does the story make sense? Is there a beginning, middle and end?
5. Save the project as `CEA-YourName_Assembly2`.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Project set up correctly before import.
- 4â€“5 clips placed in a deliberate story order.
- All five actions used at least once.
- Assembly tells a clear beginning-middle-end story.
- Project saved with the correct name.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Start with the clip that best introduces the topic â€” that is your beginning.
- Hint 2: The clip with the strongest emotion or action is your middle.
- Hint 3: The clip that feels like a conclusion is your end.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€” do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a project set to 16:9/1080p/30fps; 4â€“5 clips placed in an order that opens with context, builds with a point or two, and closes with a call or conclusion; at least one split (removing a pause or mistake), one trim (tightening a start or end), one reorder (moving a clip to a better position), and one delete (removing a redundant clip); and a saved project named correctly. The story should be understandable to someone who has never seen the footage â€” that is the test of an assembly.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Correct setup before import (2)
- 4â€“5 clips placed in a deliberate order (2)
- All five actions used (3)
- Story has a clear beginning, middle and end (2)
- Project saved with the correct name (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Amina* is a NYSC member in Port Harcourt who wants to earn extra income editing videos for small businesses. She has a laptop and CapCut installed, but she has never taken a paid job. A local restaurant owner asks her to edit a 30-second promo from 20 clips he shot on his phone. Amina opens CapCut, starts clicking, and two hours later she has a messy timeline, no clear story, and no idea how to finish. She almost gives up.

Relevant facts.

- Amina knows the CapCut interface â€” she has used it for fun.
- The restaurant owner's clips are well-lit but unsorted: 20 clips with camera names, mixed with family photos.
- Amina has no shot log, no folder structure and no backup.
- She tried to add music and text before the story was in order â€” and now the timeline is chaotic.

Decision point. What went wrong â€” and what should Amina do differently?

Possible approaches.

1. Keep clicking until it looks right â€” she is close, she thinks.
2. Start over, but this time add music and effects first to make it interesting.
3. Start over with the professional sequence: organise, log, assemble, then craft.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Amina's problem is not her software skill â€” it is her sequence. She tried to decorate (music, text) before she had a structure (story order). The professional sequence is: organise the clips, log them, build the assembly in story order, and only then add music, text and effects. Starting over with this sequence takes less time than fixing a chaotic timeline.

Reasoning / what Amina would do:

- Create a project folder and copy the 20 clips in.
- Rename and log them.

- Back up to a USB drive.
- Build the assembly: 5â€“6 clips in story order, no music or text.
- Only then add a music bed, a title and a caption.
- Export and deliver.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: the timeline gets more chaotic with every attempt; the job takes longer and the result is worse.
- Approach 2: music and text without structure is decoration on a broken frame â€” it looks worse, not better.
- Approach 3: starting over feels like lost time, but it is actually faster â€” because the assembly is the foundation everything else sits on.

Professional connection. Amina can charge **â‚¦15,000â€“â‚¦25,000** for a 30-second restaurant promo. The restaurant owner does not care how many buttons she knows â€” he cares that the video makes people hungry and shows the order number. An editor who can take 20 messy clips and return a clean, story-shaped video in one day is an editor who gets paid. The assembly is the skill that makes the sale.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Importing before setting up the project

Symptoms: The project has the wrong aspect ratio or frame rate; clips look stretched or cropped. **Likely cause:** Clips were imported first, and CapCut guessed the settings from the first clip. **How to investigate:** Check the project settings against the course standard (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps). **Corrective steps:** Create a new project, set up first, then import. **How to confirm resolved:** Project settings match the standard before any clip is imported. **Prevention:** Setup is step one â€” every time, without exception.

K.2 Splitting at the wrong place

Symptoms: The cut lands in the middle of a word or a breath; the edit feels jagged. **Likely cause:** The playhead was not on the exact frame; the timeline was zoomed out too far. **How to investigate:** Zoom in on the timeline and check the playhead position frame by frame. **Corrective steps:** Zoom in, move the playhead to the exact frame, split again. **How to confirm resolved:** The cut lands on a clean frame â€” not mid-word. **Prevention:** Zoom in for precision cuts; the playhead is the scalpel.

K.3 Deleting the original file instead of the timeline clip

Symptoms: The clip is gone from the folder; the project shows it as "offline." **Likely cause:** The learner deleted the source file instead of removing the clip from the timeline. **How to investigate:** Check the organised folder â€” is the file still there? **Corrective steps:** Restore the file from the backup (this is why Session 1's backup matters). **How to confirm resolved:** The file exists in the folder and the project. **Prevention:** Delete from the timeline only; the folder is sacred.

K.4 Adding music and text before the assembly

Symptoms: The timeline is cluttered; the story is unclear; the edit feels chaotic. **Likely cause:** Decoration was added before structure. **How to investigate:** Watch the timeline â€” is there a clear story order under the music and text? **Corrective steps:** Remove the music and text, fix the assembly, then add them back. **How to confirm resolved:** The assembly tells the story on its own, without music or text. **Prevention:** Assembly first, craft second â€” always.

K.5 Not saving the project

Symptoms: After closing CapCut, the work is gone. **Likely cause:** The project was not saved; or the learner closed without confirming the save. **How to investigate:** Open CapCut's project list â€” is the project there? **Corrective steps:** Rebuild (if unsaved) â€” and save immediately after every significant edit. **How to confirm resolved:** The project appears in the project list after closing and reopening. **Prevention:** Save early, save often; name the project so you can find it.

K.6 Confusing the project file with the export

Symptoms: The learner tries to send the project file to the client; the client cannot open it. **Likely cause:** The project file (the recipe) was sent instead of the exported video (the meal). **How to investigate:** Ask: "What file did you send? Is it an MP4?" **Corrective steps:** Export the video and send the MP4. **How to confirm resolved:** The client receives an MP4 that plays. **Prevention:** The project is for you; the export is for the client.

K.7 Working from an unsorted folder

Symptoms: The learner cannot find the clip they need; the import takes forever; clips are missing. **Likely cause:** The footage was not organised and named in Session 1. **How to investigate:** Open the footage folder â€" are the files named meaningfully? **Corrective steps:** Stop, organise and rename (return to Session 1's method), then import. **How to confirm resolved:** Every clip is findable in seconds. **Prevention:** Organisation is the foundation â€" never skip it.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the project settings, or the missing file in the folder). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My First Assembly â€" Two Versions and a Reflection"

Purpose: To practise the five core actions until they are automatic, and to build the assembly skill that the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You are editing a 60-second video for a Port Harcourt community group. You have a footage pack of talking-head clips and cutaways. Your job is to build two different assemblies from the same pack â€" and explain your decisions.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open CapCut and create a new project with the correct settings (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps).
2. Import 6â€"8 clips from your organised Pack A.
3. Build **Assembly A**: a 45â€"60 second version that tells the story in a straightforward order.
4. Build **Assembly B**: a 30â€"45 second version that tells the same story with a different structure (e.g., start with the strongest moment, or end with a question).
5. For each assembly, write 3â€"4 sentences explaining: which clips you chose, why that order, and what you removed and why.
6. Save both projects with clear names (`CEA-YourName_AssemblyA` , `CEA-YourName_AssemblyB`).

Required deliverables:

- Two saved CapCut projects (checked in class or via screenshot of the timeline).
- A short written reflection (3â€"4 sentences per assembly) explaining the decisions.

Submission format: Reflection as a typed document (`Session2_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week1/Assembly/` , plus the two project files checked in class.

Deadline: Before Session 3.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Correct project setup	3	16:9, 1080p, 30 fps, named correctly
Assembly A â€" story order	4	Clear beginning, middle, end; clips in a deliberate order
Assembly B â€" different structure	4	A genuinely different structure, not just a shorter cut
Five actions used	4	Place, split, trim, reorder, delete all used in both
Written reflection	3	Clear reasons for clip choice, order and removals
Saving and naming	2	Both projects saved with correct names

Common mistakes to avoid: importing before setup; adding music or text before the assembly; deleting original files; not saving; two assemblies that are identical; no reflection.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: two projects with correct settings; Assembly A as a straightforward chronological story (intro â†' points â†' close) using 6â€"8 clips with splits, trims, a reorder and a delete; Assembly B as a different structure â€" for example, opening with the strongest emotional moment, then flashing back to the context, then closing with a call â€" using fewer clips and tighter cuts; and a reflection that names specific decisions: "I put the owner's welcome first because it is the beginning of the story; I removed the third clip because it repeated the second; I moved the closing clip earlier because it works as a summary."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the four main areas of the CapCut interface?

Q2. List. Name the five core editing actions, in the order you would use them to build an assembly.

Q3. Multiple choice. When should you set the aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate? a) After importing the clips b) Before importing the clips c) After exporting d) It does not matter

Q4. True or false. Importing a clip into CapCut moves the file from your folder into the project, so you can delete the original.

Q5. Explain. What is the difference between the project file and the exported video?

Q6. Scenario. You are building an assembly and the story does not make sense in the order you placed the clips. What should you do â€" and which of the five actions will you use?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Media library, preview window, timeline, tools panel (plus the playhead).

A2. Place, split, trim, reorder, delete (then watch and repeat).

A3. (b) Before importing the clips â€" so CapCut does not guess the settings from the first clip.

A4. False. Importing creates a reference to the file; the original stays in the folder. Deleting the original breaks the project.

A5. The project file is the working document â€" the set of instructions (which clips, which order, which edits). The exported video is the finished MP4 file you deliver to the client. The project is the recipe; the export is the meal.

A6. Reorder the clips â€" drag them to a better position on the timeline until the story makes sense. The action is **reorder**. (Accept any answer that identifies reorder and explains checking the story.)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you met the tool. You learned that CapCut is free, powerful enough, and the right choice for this course â€" and that the principles you learn in it transfer to any editor. You learned the four areas of the interface (media library, preview window, timeline, tools panel) and the playhead. You set up a project correctly before importing, imported from your organised folder, and built your first assembly using the five core actions: place, split, trim, reorder, delete. You learned that the project file is the recipe and the export is the meal. And you saw that an assembly â€" rough, with no music or text â€" is the foundation every professional edit is built on.

Five important takeaways:

1. **CapCut is free and enough** â€" and the principles transfer to any editor.
2. **The interface has four areas** â€" library, preview, timeline, tools â€" plus the playhead.
3. **Setup before import** â€" aspect ratio, resolution, frame rate, name.
4. **Five actions build every edit** â€" place, split, trim, reorder, delete.
5. **The project is the recipe; the export is the meal** â€" save often, name clearly.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the four areas of the interface?
- Can I set up a project correctly before importing?

- Can I build an assembly using the five core actions?
- Can I explain the difference between the project file and the export?
- Can I explain why the assembly comes before music and text?

Connection to the next session. You have your first assembly â€" your clips in story order. Next session we turn that assembly into a **rough cut** with real cut craft. You will learn the named cut types â€" straight cut, jump cut, cut on action, match cut â€" and the two invisible workhorses, the **J-cut** and **L-cut**. You will learn pacing, rhythm and story shape, and how B-roll covers a jump. The assembly you built today is the raw material for that craft.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner sets up the project correctly before importing, without being reminded.
- Learner names the four interface areas and the playhead.
- Learner builds an assembly using all five core actions.
- Learner explains the difference between the project file and the export.
- Learner's assembly tells a clear story in order â€" beginning, middle, end.
- Learner saves the project with a correct name.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I need to learn every button first." â†' Five actions are enough to start; the rest come with reasons.
- "Music and text make the video." â†' Structure first; decoration second.
- "The project file is the video." â†' The project is the recipe; the export is the meal.
- "Importing moves the files." â†' It references them; the originals stay.
- "Setup can wait." â†' Setup mistakes are expensive to undo.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Five-action drill:** give the learner three clips and ask them to place, split, trim, reorder and delete â€" narrating each action as they do it.
2. **Interface labelling:** give a screenshot of the CapCut interface with blank boxes; the learner labels the four areas and the playhead.
3. **Setup race:** ask the learner to create a new project with the correct settings in under one minute â€" repeated until it is automatic.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a step-by-step checklist with screenshots; the learner follows it to build the assembly.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" guided practical plus independent second assembly.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to build an assembly that tells the story *without* the obvious chronological order â€" for example, starting at the end and flashing back â€" and explain why that structure works.

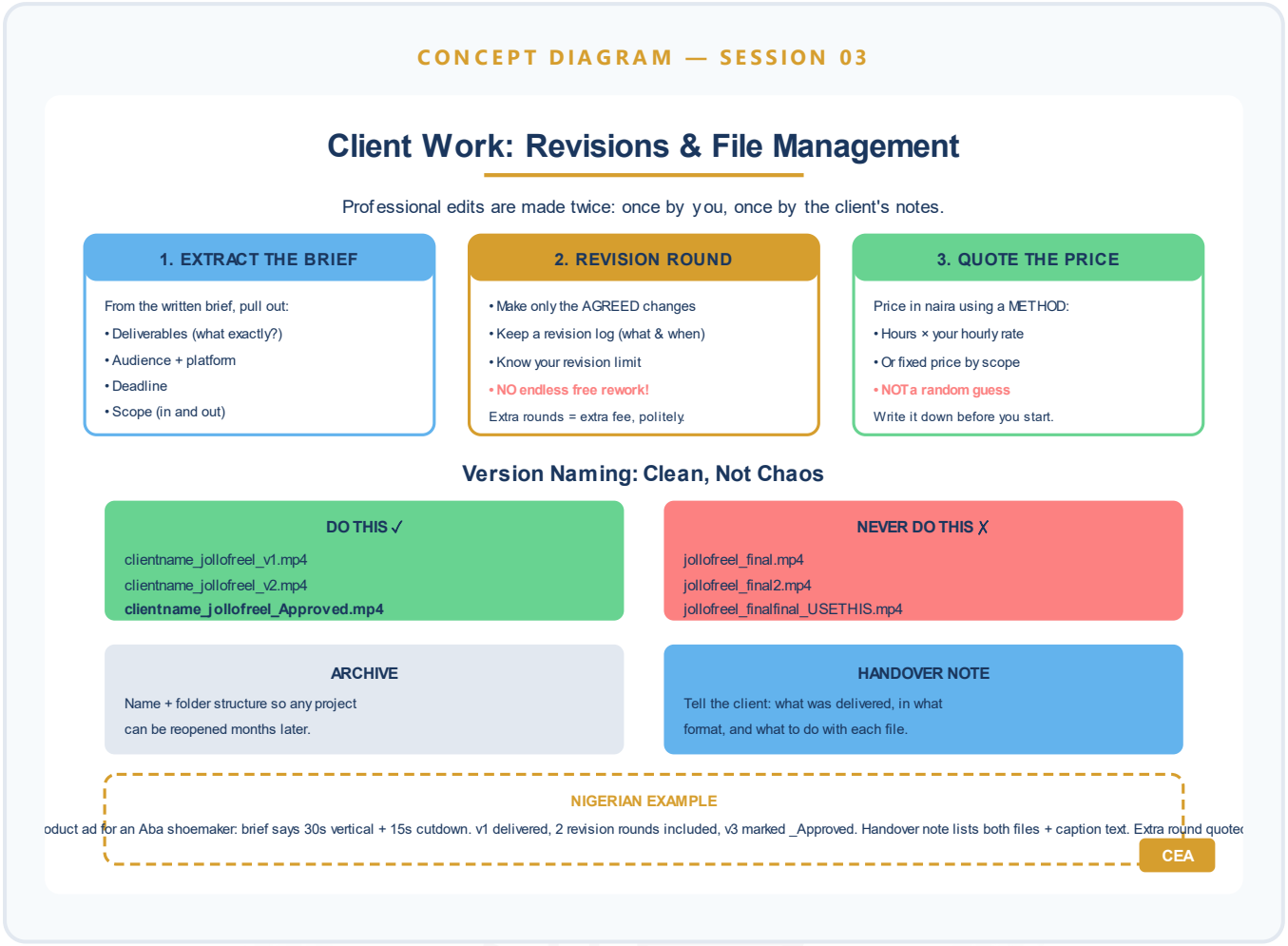
Timing guidance. The priority is **learners building their own first assembly** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the independent exercise to one assembly instead of two. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a completed assembly has no foundation for Session 3's cut craft.

END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€" Cuts, Pacing and Story.

SESSION 03 OF 9

Cuts Pacing and Story



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 3 â€" CUTS, PACING AND STORY

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 9
Session title	Cuts, Pacing and Story
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module 1: Foundations and Story
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first real cut craft)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1 and 2 â€" learners must have their organised, backed-up Pack A and their first assembly (from Session 2). They must be able to place, split, trim, reorder and delete in CapCut.

Item	Detail
	No prior cut-craft knowledge assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 2 you built your first assembly â€” clips in story order, no music or text. Today you turn that assembly into a **rough cut** with real craft: you learn the named cut types, the J-cut and L-cut, pacing and rhythm, story shape, and how B-roll covers a jump. The assembly is the raw material; today you shape it.
Preparation before class	CapCut installed and tested; Pack B (Product and B-roll) copied to the shared class folder and verified; each learner's first assembly available (from Session 2); a projector; printed cut-type reference cards (one set per learner); the instructor's own rough cut pre-built to show the finished result; a short "pacing test" clip prepared (a 60-second sequence the class will time).

Instructor note on tone: This is the session where editing becomes a *craft* rather than a task. Learners will feel the difference between a cut that is accidental and a cut that is deliberate. Celebrate that feeling. The goal is not to memorise terminology â€” it is to make decisions and explain them. Use the phrase "a cut is a decision, not an accident" early and often.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Name and demonstrate** the five main cut types â€” straight cut, jump cut, cut on action, match cut, and the J-cut/L-cut â€ and explain when each is used.
2. **Select cut points deliberately** â€ choosing the exact frame to cut on, and justifying the choice in one sentence.
3. **Explain** the difference between a J-cut (audio leads picture) and an L-cut (picture leads audio), and use at least one of them around dialogue.
4. **Analyse and adjust pacing** â€ identifying a sequence that drags or feels frantic, and explaining what to cut or hold to fix it.
5. **Describe** the short-video story shape â€ hook, beginning, middle, end, payoff â€ and build a short edit with that shape.
6. **Use B-roll purposefully** â€ covering a jump cut and adding meaning, not just filling space.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut installed.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- USB flash drives with each learner's organised Pack A (and the new Pack B).

Software

- CapCut desktop (free) â€ the tool for this session.
- File Explorer â€ to locate footage folders.

Sample files

- Each learner's **first assembly** (from Session 2) â€ the raw material for today's rough cut.
- **Pack B â€ Product and B-roll**: shop/product shots, hands working, street and exterior shots, no dialogue. This is the B-roll that will cover jump cuts.
- **Cut-type reference cards** â€ printed, one set per learner, naming the five cut types with a one-line description and a small diagram.
- A **pacing test clip** â€ a 60-second sequence the class will watch and time together.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 3.1 â€ "Cut-Decision Log" â€ a table: clip / cut point (time) / cut type / reason.
- Worksheet 3.2 â€ "Pacing Check" â€ a simple table: section / how it feels (drags / good / frantic) / what to cut or hold.

Accounts

- CapCut account (already created in Session 2).

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut works. A learner on a phone can do the entire session in CapCut mobile â€" the cut types are the same.

Instructor note on terminology: The cut-type names (straight cut, jump cut, cut on action, match cut, J-cut, L-cut) are the shared vocabulary of editors worldwide. Teach the *concept* first, then attach the name. A learner who can *do* a J-cut but calls it "the audio one" is ahead of a learner who memorises the name but cannot do it.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, play the **same 20-second dialogue clip twice**.

- **Version 1:** The dialogue is cut with obvious, clumsy cuts â€" each sentence starts with a breath, ends with a pause, and the cuts land mid-word. It feels uncomfortable.
- **Version 2:** The same dialogue, cut cleanly â€" pauses removed, cuts landing on natural breaks, the conversation flowing.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Same two people, same words, same footage. The first version feels uncomfortable. The second feels like a real conversation. The only difference is **where the cuts landed**.*
>
> *A cut is a decision, not an accident. Today you learn to make that decision on purpose. By the end of this session, you will be able to look at any dialogue and say: 'I cut here because _____.' That is the difference between a beginner and an editor."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "the first one is annoying," "the second one is smooth," "how did you do that?" Accept all answers. Say: "You already have the taste â€" you can feel the difference. Today we give that taste a method."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"We are going to turn your Session 2 assembly into a rough cut. Not by cutting randomly â€" by choosing every cut point on purpose, and being able to explain why. That is craft."*

Why this opener works: It isolates the cut as the variable (same footage, different cuts), it proves that learners already have the taste to feel good cuts, and it frames the session as giving that taste a method.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the five core editing actions, and which one removes a pause from the middle of a clip?"

- Expected answer: Place, split, trim, reorder, delete. The **split** removes a pause from the middle (split on both sides of the pause, then delete the middle part).
- Common gap: learners confuse split and trim. Clarify: trim shortens the *ends*; split cuts in the *middle*.

Question 2: "What is the playhead, and why does it matter for cutting?"

- Expected answer: The playhead is the vertical line on the timeline showing the exact moment you are working on. A split happens at the playhead â€" so the playhead's position decides where the cut lands.
- Common gap: learners split without looking at the playhead. Clarify: "The playhead is your scalpel â€" you would not cut without looking."

Question 3: "Why did we build the assembly in Session 2 with no music, text or effects?"

- Expected answer: Because the story order has to work on its own first. Music and text are decoration â€" they go on after the structure is solid.
- Common gap: learners want to add music now. Clarify: "Music comes in Session 4. Today is about the cut."

Question 4: "What is a J-cut?" (Give a hint: "It is named after the shape it makes on the timeline.")

- Expected answer: A cut where the audio of the next clip starts before the picture â€" you hear the next speaker before you see them. It makes dialogue feel natural.
- Common gap: learners have never heard the term. Do not worry â€" this is the session that teaches it. Say: "By the end of today, you will not only know what it is â€" you will have used it."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have the assembly and the five actions. Now we add the craft: the named cut types, the J-cut and L-cut, pacing, story shape and B-roll. By the end of today, your assembly will be a rough cut â€" and you will be able to explain every cut you made."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing split vs. trim on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 A cut is a decision

The idea. Every time two clips meet on the timeline, a **cut** happens. The cut is the most basic and most powerful tool in editing â€" and the one beginners make carelessly.

Plain-English definition. A **cut** is the moment one clip ends and the next begins. A good cut is chosen; a bad cut is an accident.

Why it matters. The audience feels a bad cut even if they cannot name it â€" a conversation feels choppy, a story feels confusing, a moment feels interrupted. A good cut is invisible: the audience simply experiences the story. The goal is not to make cuts the viewer notices, but to make cuts the viewer *feels*.

The decision framework (teach this for every cut):

1. **Where** does the cut land? (On a natural break â€" a pause, a breath, a movement.)
2. **Why** there? (Because it feels natural, or because it hides a jump, or because it matches the action.)
3. **What type** of cut is it? (Straight, jump, cut on action, match, J or L.)
4. **Does it earn its place?** (If removing it makes no difference, it should not be there.)

Real-life comparison. A cut is like a **sentence break in writing**. A story with no sentence breaks is exhausting to read. A story with random breaks in the middle of words is confusing. A story with well-placed breaks flows. The cut is the editor's punctuation.

Common misconception. "More cuts = more professional." No. A fast-cut action video and a slow interview need completely different cutting rhythms. The right number of cuts is the number the story needs â€" no more, no less.

F.2 The five cut types

The idea. Editors have named the common cuts so they can talk about them and choose them deliberately. You need to know five.

The five cut types (teach with a diagram of each on the board):

1. Straight cut. The simplest cut: one clip ends, the next begins, with no transition. This is the workhorse of editing â€" 90% of cuts in most videos are straight cuts. Use them everywhere; they are invisible when chosen well.

2. Jump cut. A cut that jumps forward in time within the same shot â€" the same person, the same angle, but a chunk of time removed. Jump cuts feel abrupt by design. They are popular in vlogs and YouTube videos because they create energy and honesty. Use them on purpose, not by accident.

3. Cut on action. A cut made *in the middle of a movement* â€" a door opening, a hand reaching, a person standing up. The movement hides the cut, so the viewer's eye follows the action and does not notice the edit. This is one of the most useful cuts in editing.

4. Match cut. A cut that matches a visual element between two shots â€" a shape, a colour, a movement. For example, a cut from a round plate to a round clock: the shapes match, so the cut feels clever and satisfying. Match cuts are advanced; use them sparingly.

5. J-cut and L-cut (the invisible workhorses). These are the cuts that make dialogue feel natural. They are named after the shape they make on the timeline.

The J-cut and L-cut in detail:

- **J-cut:** The **audio** of the next clip starts *before* the picture. You hear the next speaker's voice while still seeing the previous shot, then the picture changes. The timeline shape looks like a **J**.
- **L-cut:** The **picture** of the next clip starts before its audio. You see the next shot while still hearing the previous speaker's voice. The timeline shape looks like an **L**.

Why they exist. In real conversation, we often hear a person before we see them, or we keep listening while looking at something else. J-cuts and L-cuts mimic that natural flow. Without them, dialogue feels like a rigid back-and-forth. With them, it feels like life.

How to do them in CapCut (desktop):

1. Split the audio from the video on the timeline (right-click the clip â†' "Separate audio" or use the audio track).
2. For a **J-cut**: drag the audio of the next clip to the left, so it starts before its video.
3. For an **L-cut**: drag the video of the next clip to the left, so it starts before its audio.
4. Watch and adjust until the conversation flows.

Real-life comparison. A J-cut is like **hearing your friend's voice from the next room before you turn and see them** â€" the sound leads, the picture follows. An L-cut is like **still hearing the TV while you look up at someone** â€" the picture leads, the sound continues. Both are how our ears and eyes actually work.

Common misconception. "J-cuts and L-cuts are advanced." No. They are simple once you separate the audio. The hard part is not the technique â€" it is *hearing* when a conversation needs one. That is a skill you build by practising.

F.3 Pacing and rhythm â€" the speed of the story

The idea. Pacing is how fast or slow the video feels. It is controlled by how long each shot stays and how often you cut.

Plain-English definition. Pacing is the rhythm of the edit â€" the pattern of fast and slow that makes a video feel energetic, calm, tense or boring.

Why it matters. A video that drags loses the audience. A video that is frantic exhausts them. Good pacing serves the story: fast for excitement, slow for emotion, steady for information.

The three pacing problems (and their fixes):

Problem	What it feels like	How to fix it
Dragging	The audience is bored; shots stay too long	Cut more tightly; remove pauses and dead air; shorten clips
Frantic	The audience feels rushed; they cannot absorb anything	Hold shots longer; remove unnecessary cuts; let moments breathe
Uneven	Some parts drag, others rush â€" the video feels inconsistent	Watch the whole video; adjust section by section to a steady rhythm

The pacing check method: Watch the whole video once without touching anything. Note where your attention wanders (that part drags) and where you feel rushed (that part is frantic). Then fix those sections.

Real-life comparison. Pacing is like **the tempo of a song**. A fuji song has a steady, relaxing tempo. A hip-hop track is faster. A ballad is slower. A good song changes tempo on purpose â€" and so does a good video.

Nigerian context. A church sermon edit and a football highlight need completely different pacing. The sermon needs space for the message; the highlights need energy for the action. The editor serves the story, not a formula.

Common misconception. "Faster is always better for social media." No. Fast cuts can be exhausting; a well-held shot can be powerful. Match the pacing to the story and the platform.

F.4 Story shape â€” the invisible structure

The idea. Every good video has a shape: a beginning that hooks, a middle that builds, and an end that pays off. This is true for a 15-second TikTok and a 2-hour film.

Plain-English definition. Story shape is the structure of the video â€” the order and purpose of its parts.

The short-video story shape (teach this for social media and promos):

Part	Job	How long
Hook	Stop the viewer in the first 1â€“3 seconds	1â€“3 seconds
Beginning	Set the context â€” what is this about?	5â€–10 seconds
Middle	Build the story â€” the points, the action, the emotion	The bulk of the video
End / Payoff	Deliver the promise â€” the result, the call to action	5â€–10 seconds

The hook â€” the most important 3 seconds. The hook is the first thing the viewer sees and hears. It must make them want to stay. Good hooks: a bold question, a surprising image, a strong statement, a problem the viewer has. Bad hooks: a slow logo, a long intro, "hello everyone."

Why the shape matters. A video with no hook loses the audience immediately. A video with no payoff wastes the audience's time. The shape is the promise you make and keep.

Real-life comparison. Story shape is like **a journey**: the hook is the reason to leave home, the middle is the road, the payoff is the destination. A journey with no reason to leave and no destination is just walking.

Worked example â€” a 60-second restaurant promo:

- **Hook (0:0s):** A close-up of sizzling food, steam rising â€” "The smell that brings the whole street."
- **Beginning (3:0s):** The shop exterior and the owner's welcome â€” "Mama T's Kitchen, your neighbourhood kitchen."
- **Middle (10:0s):** Dishes being prepared, plates served, customers smiling â€” the food and the people.
- **End (50:0s):** The owner's final line, the order number, the end card â€” "Call 0803-XXX-XXXX to order."

Common misconception. "Story is only for films." No. A 15-second TikTok has a hook, a middle and a payoff. Structure is not about length â€” it is about purpose.

F.5 B-roll â€” the editor's best friend

The idea. B-roll is supplementary footage that supports the main footage (the A-roll). It covers jumps, adds interest, and shows what the voice describes.

Plain-English definition. B-roll is any footage that is not the main subject â€” cutaways of hands, places, objects, reactions, details.

Why it exists. When you cut a pause out of a talking-head clip, the picture jumps â€” the person's head suddenly moves. That jump is ugly. B-roll covers it: you place the B-roll on a track above the main clip, so the viewer sees the cutaway while the audio continues smoothly.

What B-roll does:

- **Covers jump cuts** â€” hides the visual jump when a pause is removed.
- **Adds meaning** â€” shows what the voice describes ("the kitchen" while the owner talks about cooking).
- **Adds interest** â€” a video of only a talking face gets boring; cutaways keep the eye engaged.
- **Controls pace** â€” a B-roll shot can be held to slow the video down, or cut quickly to speed it up.

How to use B-roll (the rule): B-roll supports the A-roll; it never competes with it. If the B-roll is more interesting than the main shot, the main shot should be replaced or shortened.

Real-life comparison. B-roll is like **the illustrations in a textbook**. The text (the talking head) explains; the pictures (the B-roll) show. A textbook with only text is dry; a textbook with only pictures has no depth. Together they teach.

Common misconception. "B-roll is filler." No. B-roll with purpose covers jumps and adds meaning. B-roll without purpose â€" random shots that show nothing â€" is filler. Every B-roll shot should earn its place.

F.6 When to cut and when to hold

The idea. Knowing when *not* to cut is as important as knowing when to cut.

The rules of thumb:

- **Cut on a natural break** â€" a pause, a breath, the end of a thought, a completed movement.
- **Hold when the moment matters** â€" a smile, a reaction, an emotion. Cutting too soon kills the feeling.
- **Cut to remove dead air** â€" pauses that add nothing. The audience's time is precious.
- **Hold to let the audience absorb** â€" after a key point or a beautiful shot, let it breathe.

The test: After making a cut, ask: "Does this cut earn its place?" If the answer is "I don't know," watch it again. If the cut does nothing, remove it. If it does something good, keep it.

Real-life comparison. Cutting is like **conversation**: you wait for a natural pause to speak, you do not interrupt mid-sentence, and you let a good story breathe before responding.

Common misconception. "If it feels awkward, cut it." Not always. Some of the most powerful moments in video are awkward â€" a long silence, a hesitation. Cut on purpose, not on discomfort.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- A **cut is a decision** â€" where it lands, why there, what type it is, whether it earns its place.
- The **five cut types**: straight cut, jump cut, cut on action, match cut, and the J-cut/L-cut.
- **J-cut**: audio leads picture. **L-cut**: picture leads audio. Both make dialogue natural.
- **Pacing** is the rhythm â€" fix dragging by cutting tighter, fix frantic by holding longer.
- **Story shape**: hook â†' beginning â†' middle â†' payoff. The hook is the most important 3 seconds.
- **B-roll** covers jumps, adds meaning and interest â€" but it supports, never competes.
- **Cut on natural breaks; hold when the moment matters.**

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Straight cut] --> D[Clean edit]
    B[J-cut] --> D
    C[L-cut] --> D
    D --> E[Good pacing]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Turn a raw assembly into a rough cut with deliberate, named cuts â€" narrating every decision so learners see the craft in action.

Setup: CapCut open on the projector. A raw assembly (clips in story order, no cuts made). Pack B B-roll available. Cut-type reference cards on the desk.

Step 1 â€" Watch and note (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "First, I watch the whole thing without touching it. I note where it drags, where it jumps, where the story is unclear."
- Play the assembly. Point out one drag and one jump.

Step 2 â€" Cut on natural breaks (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I remove the pause after the intro. I split on both sides of the pause and delete the middle. That is a straight cut â€" invisible."
- Perform the splits and delete. Point out the cut type: straight cut.
- **Ask:** "Why not use a transition here?" â†' Because straight cuts are invisible; transitions draw attention.

Step 3 â€” Cover the jump with B-roll (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "When I removed the pause, the picture jumps. That is ugly. I cover it with B-roll â€” a shot of the kitchen. The audio continues smoothly over the B-roll."
- Place a B-roll clip from Pack B on the track above the main clip, covering the jump.
- **Ask:** "What does the B-roll do?" â†' It hides the jump and shows what the voice describes.

Step 4 â€” A J-cut for dialogue (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "This conversation feels rigid â€" like a tennis match. I make a J-cut: the audio of the next speaker starts before the picture. Now it feels like a real conversation."
- Separate the audio, drag the next clip's audio to the left so it leads the picture.
- **Ask:** "What shape does this make on the timeline?" â†' A J.

Step 5 â€” Fix the pacing (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "The middle drags â€" this shot is too long. I trim it. The ending feels rushed â€" I hold the final shot a beat longer."
- Trim the long shot; extend the final shot.
- **Ask:** "What changed?" â†' The middle is tighter; the ending breathes.

Step 6 â€” Watch the rough cut (1 minute)

- Play the full rough cut. It is still rough â€" no music, no text â€" but every cut is deliberate.
- **Say:** "That is a rough cut. Every cut is a decision. In your practical, you will do the same."

Expected result: A rough cut with straight cuts, a B-roll cover, a J-cut, and adjusted pacing â€" the model learners will follow.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why is the straight cut invisible?" (Because the picture simply changes â€" no effect, no transition.)
- "What does the B-roll do?" (Covers the jump and adds meaning.)
- "What is the J-cut doing to the conversation?" (Making it feel natural â€" audio leads picture.)
- "How do I know when to hold a shot?" (When the moment matters â€" a smile, a reaction, an emotion.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner turns their Session 2 assembly into a **rough cut** with deliberate, named cuts.

Starting materials: The learner's Session 2 assembly open in CapCut; Pack B B-roll available; Worksheet 3.1 (Cut-Decision Log); the cut-type reference cards.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open your Session 2 assembly in CapCut.
2. **Watch** the full assembly once without touching it. Note one place that drags and one place that jumps.
3. **Straight cut:** Remove one pause by splitting on both sides and deleting the middle.
4. **B-roll cover:** Place one B-roll clip from Pack B on the track above the main clip to cover the jump.
5. **J-cut or L-cut:** Around one dialogue moment, separate the audio and make a J-cut (audio leads picture) or L-cut (picture leads audio).
6. **Pacing fix:** Trim one shot that drags; hold one shot that matters.
7. **Log your cuts:** Fill in Worksheet 3.1 â€" for each cut, write the clip, the cut point, the cut type and the reason.
8. **Watch** the full rough cut. Does every cut earn its place?

Expected result: A rough cut with at least one straight cut, one B-roll cover, one J-cut or L-cut, one pacing fix, and a completed Cut-Decision Log.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "What does the B-roll do to the jump?" (It covers it â€" the audio continues smoothly.)
- After step 7: "Can you explain each cut in one sentence?" (If not, the cut may be an accident.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- B-roll covers the dialogue â†' Lower the B-roll track's opacity or shorten it so it does not distract.
- J-cut audio is out of sync â†' Nudge the audio clip left or right until it feels natural.
- Cut lands mid-word â†' Zoom in, move the playhead to the exact frame, split again.
- Rough cut feels the same as the assembly â†' Check that the cuts are actually deliberate; remove one more pause.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Assembly watched and problems noted
- ☐ At least one straight cut (pause removed)
- ☐ At least one B-roll cover
- ☐ At least one J-cut or L-cut
- ☐ At least one pacing fix (trim or hold)
- ☐ Cut-Decision Log completed
- ☐ Full rough cut watched
- ☐ Every cut explained in one sentence

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Take a **new section of footage** (not the part you cut in the guided practical) and cut it independently â€" making your own decisions and explaining them.

Scenario. You are editing a community announcement video. You have a new clip: a 30-second interview with a community leader about a youth centre. The interview has pauses, a repeated point, and a long answer that needs tightening. You also have B-roll of the community hall, young people playing football, and a handwritten sign-up sheet.

Requirements:

1. Import the interview clip and the B-roll into a new CapCut project.
2. Cut the interview to remove pauses and the repeated point â€" using straight cuts.
3. Cover at least one jump with B-roll.
4. Use at least one J-cut or L-cut.
5. Adjust the pacing: trim one shot that drags, hold one shot that matters.
6. Complete a Cut-Decision Log (Worksheet 3.1) for every cut you make.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Interview tightened with deliberate straight cuts.
- At least one jump covered with B-roll.
- At least one J-cut or L-cut used.
- Pacing adjusted (one trim, one hold).
- Every cut logged with a type and a reason.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Start by watching the whole interview once â€" note the pauses and the repeated point.
- Hint 2: The B-roll of the football game can cover a jump in the middle of the interview.
- Hint 3: For the J-cut, separate the audio of the interview, then drag the audio of the next clip to the left.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: the interview clipped to remove pauses and the repeated point using straight cuts; at least one B-roll clip (the football game or the sign-up sheet) placed on an upper track to cover a jump; at least one J-cut (the leader's audio leading into the next shot) or L-cut; a pacing fix where a long answer is trimmed and a key moment (the leader's main point) is held; and a Cut-Decision Log where every row names the clip, the cut point, the cut type (straight cut, J-cut, etc.) and a reason ("removed pause," "covered jump," "audio leads picture").

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Straight cuts remove pauses and repetition (2)

- B-roll covers at least one jump (2)
- At least one J-cut or L-cut used (2)
- Pacing adjusted (one trim, one hold) (2)
- Cut-Decision Log complete with types and reasons (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Tunde* is a church media volunteer in Port Harcourt. His church records every Sunday service â€" a two-hour sermon â€" and posts a 10-minute highlights video on YouTube. Tunde's current method: he watches the whole service, finds the "best bits," and cuts them together with straight cuts and a fade between each one. The result is stiff â€" the sermon feels choppy, the fades look dated, and viewers stop watching after three minutes.

Relevant facts.

- Tunde has all the footage â€" the full service on a memory card.
- He knows CapCut but only uses straight cuts and fades.
- The church wants more watch-through â€" people should stay for the whole highlights video.
- Tunde has no B-roll of his own, but the church has photos of the congregation, the choir, and the building.

Decision point. What is Tunde doing wrong â€" and what should he change?

Possible approaches.

1. Keep the same method but make the fades shorter.
2. Add more transitions to make it look professional.
3. Learn the craft: deliberate cuts, J-cuts for the sermon, B-roll from the church's photos, and pacing that serves the message.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Tunde's problem is not the length of his fades â€" it is that every cut is the same. A sermon has natural rhythms: a pause for emphasis, a shift in topic, a moment of emotion. Cutting on those natural breaks, using J-cuts so the pastor's voice flows over cutaways, and placing B-roll (the choir, the congregation) to cover jumps â€" these make the video feel alive, not choppy.

Reasoning / what Tunde would do:

- Watch the service once and note the natural breaks and emotional moments.
- Cut on those breaks â€" not on a timer.
- Use J-cuts: the pastor's voice continues over a cutaway of the choir or the congregation.
- Place B-roll on an upper track to cover jumps.
- Hold the moments that matter â€" the congregation's response, the pastor's key point.
- Let the pacing serve the message: slower for reflection, steady for teaching.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: shorter fades are still fades â€" the video still feels dated and stiff.
- Approach 2: more transitions make it worse â€" transitions draw attention to themselves, not the message.
- Approach 3: takes more thought and time, but the result is a video people actually watch â€" which is the whole point.

Professional connection. A church media volunteer who can turn a two-hour service into a 10-minute video that people watch to the end is *invaluable*. The same skill applies to weddings, events and conferences. Tunde can also take this skill to small businesses â€" a â¦20,000â€"â¦40,000 job per event video is realistic for a volunteer who builds a reputation.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Cutting mid-word or mid-breath

Symptoms: The dialogue feels jagged; the conversation is uncomfortable to watch. **Likely cause:** The cut landed in the middle of a word or breath â€" the playhead was not on a natural break. **How to investigate:** Zoom in on the timeline; check the exact

frame of the cut. **Corrective steps:** Move the playhead to the natural break (end of a word, end of a breath); split again. **How to confirm resolved:** The cut lands on a clean break â€" the conversation flows. **Prevention:** Cut on natural breaks, not on a timer.

K.2 Using a transition between every clip

Symptoms: The video feels dated and amateur; the transitions draw attention to themselves. **Likely cause:** A fade or effect was added between every clip instead of using a straight cut. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" do you notice the transitions more than the story? **Corrective steps:** Replace transitions with straight cuts; save transitions for special moments. **How to confirm resolved:** The cuts are invisible â€" the story flows. **Prevention:** Straight cuts are the default; transitions are the exception.

K.3 B-roll that distracts instead of supports

Symptoms: The viewer watches the B-roll and loses the speaker; the B-roll competes with the main shot. **Likely cause:** The B-roll is too interesting, too long, or poorly placed. **How to investigate:** Watch with fresh eyes â€" where does your attention go? **Corrective steps:** Shorten the B-roll; choose less distracting shots; place it only where it supports the audio. **How to confirm resolved:** The B-roll supports the A-roll; the voice stays the focus. **Prevention:** B-roll supports; it never competes.

K.4 No hook â€" the video starts slowly

Symptoms: Viewers click away in the first 3 seconds. **Likely cause:** The video starts with a logo, a slow intro, or a long setup. **How to investigate:** Watch the first 3 seconds â€" would a stranger stop for this? **Corrective steps:** Start with the strongest moment â€" a bold image, a question, a surprising fact. **How to confirm resolved:** The first 3 seconds make a stranger want to stay. **Prevention:** The hook is the most important 3 seconds â€" protect it.

K.5 Ignoring the story shape

Symptoms: The video has no clear beginning, middle or end; it feels like a collection of clips. **Likely cause:** The clips were placed without a plan for the story's shape. **How to investigate:** Can you name the hook, the beginning, the middle and the payoff? **Corrective steps:** Reorder the clips to fit the shape; remove clips that do not serve a part. **How to confirm resolved:** The video has a clear beginning, middle and end. **Prevention:** Plan the shape before you cut; every clip should serve a part.

K.6 J-cut or L-cut that is out of sync

Symptoms: The audio leads or lags awkwardly; the conversation feels unnatural. **Likely cause:** The audio was dragged too far or not far enough. **How to investigate:** Watch the transition â€" does the audio lead or lag smoothly? **Corrective steps:** Nudge the audio clip left or right until the transition feels natural. **How to confirm resolved:** The conversation flows; the J or L shape is smooth. **Prevention:** Small adjustments â€" nudge, watch, nudge again.

K.7 Cutting too much â€" the video feels frantic

Symptoms: The viewer feels rushed; they cannot absorb anything. **Likely cause:** Too many cuts, too little holding. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" do you feel breathless? **Corrective steps:** Hold shots longer; remove unnecessary cuts; let moments breathe. **How to confirm resolved:** The pacing is steady â€" the viewer can absorb the story. **Prevention:** Cut on purpose, not on impulse.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the exact frame of the cut, or the B-roll placement). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Rough Cut with Cut Notes â€" Three Named Cuts"

Purpose: To practise deliberate cutting until it is instinctive, and to build the cut-craft skill the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You are editing a 90-second video for a Port Harcourt community group. You have a footage pack with talking-head interviews and B-roll. Your job is to produce a rough cut that demonstrates real cut craft â€" and to prove you made every cut on purpose.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open a new CapCut project with the correct settings (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps).

2. Import the supplied footage (your Pack A and Pack B from class).
3. Build a rough cut of 60â€“90 seconds that tells a clear story with a hook, beginning, middle and payoff.
4. Use **at least three named cut types** on purpose â€” for example: a straight cut, a cut on action, and a J-cut or L-cut.
5. Use **B-roll** to cover at least one jump cut.
6. Adjust the pacing: trim at least one shot that drags; hold at least one shot that matters.
7. Complete a **Cut-Decision Log** (Worksheet 3.1) for every cut: clip, cut point, cut type, reason.
8. Save the project as `CEA-YourName_RoughCut`.

Required deliverables:

- The saved CapCut project (checked in class or via screenshot).
- The completed Cut-Decision Log.

Submission format: Cut-Decision Log as a typed document (`Session3_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week1/RoughCut/`, plus the project checked in class.

Deadline: Before Session 4.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Story shape (hook, beginning, middle, payoff)	4	Clear structure; every clip serves a part
Three named cut types used on purpose	4	Straight cut, cut on action, J-cut or L-cut â€” deliberately chosen
B-roll covers at least one jump	3	B-roll placed to hide a jump and support the audio
Pacing adjusted	3	One shot trimmed; one shot held â€” with reason
Cut-Decision Log complete	4	Every cut logged with type and reason
Overall flow and watchability	2	The rough cut feels deliberate, not accidental

Common mistakes to avoid: transitions between every clip; cutting mid-word; B-roll that distracts; no hook; no story shape; a Cut-Decision Log with no reasons; cutting too much.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a rough cut with a clear hook (the strongest moment in the first 3 seconds), a beginning that sets context, a middle that builds, and a payoff that delivers; at least three named cut types used deliberately â€” a straight cut to remove a pause, a cut on action to hide a cut in a movement, and a J-cut or L-cut around dialogue; B-roll placed on an upper track to cover a jump; a pacing fix where a long shot is trimmed and an emotional moment is held; and a Cut-Decision Log where every row names the clip, the cut point (e.g., "0:23 â€” end of pause"), the cut type and a reason ("removed pause," "cut on action â€” hand reaching," "J-cut â€” audio leads picture").

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€” answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is a cut, and why is it a decision rather than an accident?

Q2. List. Name the five cut types covered in this session.

Q3. Multiple choice. Which cut type hides a cut in the middle of a movement? a) Straight cut b) Jump cut c) Cut on action d) Match cut

Q4. Explain. What is the difference between a J-cut and an L-cut?

Q5. Scenario. Your video drags in the middle â€” the audience is bored. What do you do, and what is the pacing principle?

Q6. Short answer. What are the four parts of the short-video story shape, in order?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1. A cut is the moment one clip ends and the next begins. It is a decision because the editor chooses exactly where it lands (on a natural break), why there, and what type it is â€" rather than letting it happen by accident.

A2. Straight cut, jump cut, cut on action, match cut, J-cut and L-cut. (Accept the five main ones; J-cut and L-cut count as the fifth pair.)

A3. (c) Cut on action â€" the movement hides the cut.

A4. A J-cut is when the audio of the next clip starts before its picture (audio leads picture). An L-cut is when the picture of the next clip starts before its audio (picture leads audio). Both make dialogue feel natural.

A5. Trim the shots that drag â€" cut more tightly, remove dead air and shorten clips. The pacing principle: fix dragging by cutting tighter; fix frantic by holding longer. The goal is a steady rhythm that serves the story.

A6. Hook â†' Beginning â†' Middle â†' End/Payoff.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that a cut is a decision, not an accident. You learned the five cut types â€" straight cut, jump cut, cut on action, match cut, and the J-cut/L-cut â€" and how to choose each on purpose. You learned that J-cuts and L-cut make dialogue feel natural by leading with audio or picture. You learned pacing â€" how to fix a video that drags or feels frantic â€" and story shape: hook, beginning, middle, payoff. You learned that B-roll covers jumps and adds meaning, but never competes with the main shot. And you learned that knowing when *not* to cut is as important as knowing when to cut. Your Session 2 assembly is now a rough cut â€" and you can explain every decision in it.

Five important takeaways:

1. **A cut is a decision** â€" where it lands, why there, what type it is.
2. **The five cut types** â€" straight, jump, cut on action, match, J-cut/L-cut.
3. **J-cuts and L-cuts** make dialogue natural â€" audio leads or picture leads.
4. **Pacing serves the story** â€" cut tighter to fix dragging; hold longer to fix frantic.
5. **Story shape** â€" hook, beginning, middle, payoff. The hook is the most important 3 seconds.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the five cut types and say when to use each?
- Can I make a J-cut or L-cut around dialogue?
- Can I explain why a cut lands where it does?
- Can I fix a video that drags or feels frantic?
- Can I build a video with a clear hook, beginning, middle and payoff?
- Can I use B-roll to cover a jump and add meaning?

Connection to the next session. Your rough cut has deliberate cuts, good pacing and a clear story. But it probably still sounds rough â€" the music is missing, the dialogue may be uneven, and the sound may be inconsistent. Next session is all about **audio**: levels, ducking music under voice, noise reduction, recording a voiceover, syncing cuts to a beat, and loudness. The rule you will learn first: **audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound.**

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner names the cut types correctly and uses them deliberately.
- Learner makes a J-cut or L-cut around dialogue without being told.
- Learner explains each cut in one sentence â€" type and reason.
- Learner covers a jump with B-roll.
- Learner identifies a hook, beginning, middle and payoff in their own edit.
- Learner fixes pacing by trimming a drag and holding a moment.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "More cuts = more professional." â†’ The right number is what the story needs.
- "Transitions make it professional." â†’ Straight cuts are invisible; transitions draw attention.
- "B-roll is filler." â†’ Purposeful B-roll covers jumps and adds meaning.
- "The hook can wait." â†’ The first 3 seconds decide whether anyone stays.
- "J-cuts are advanced." â†’ They are simple once you separate the audio.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Cut-type drill:** show five cut examples on the projector; the learner names each type and says why it works.
2. **Pacing drill:** play a 60-second clip; the learner notes where it drags and where it is frantic, then suggests the fix.
3. **B-roll placement:** give a talking-head clip with a jump; the learner places B-roll to cover it and explains the choice.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a rough cut with the pauses already marked; the learner removes them and logs the cuts.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€” guided practical plus independent second cut.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to cut the same footage two ways â€” once with fast pacing (for a promo) and once with slow pacing (for a reflection) â€” and explain how the pacing changes the feeling.

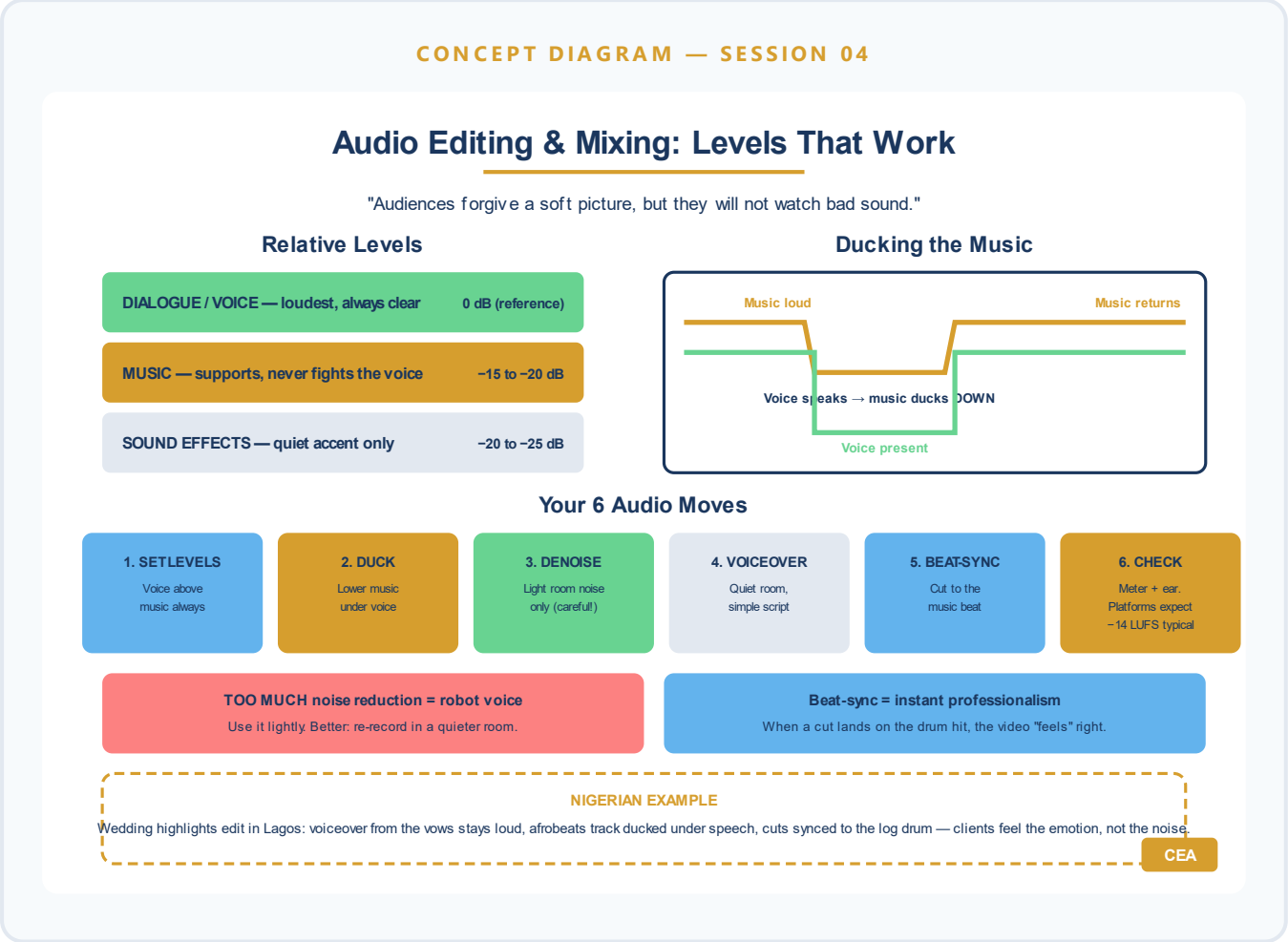
Timing guidance. The priority is **learners making deliberate cuts and logging them** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the independent exercise to the guided steps. Protect the practical time â€” a learner who leaves without a rough cut and a Cut-Decision Log has not built the cut craft that Sessions 4â€“9 depend on.

END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€” Audio Editing and Mixing.

SESSION 04 OF 9

Audio Editing and Mixing



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 4 â€" AUDIO EDITING AND MIXING

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 9
Session title	Audio Editing and Mixing
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Craft
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first audio work)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"3 â€" learners must have their rough cut (from Session 3) with deliberate cuts and a clear story. They must be able to split, trim and reorder in CapCut. No prior audio knowledge

Item	Detail
	assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 3 you built a rough cut with deliberate cuts, good pacing and a clear story. Today you make it **sound right**: you learn relative levels, ducking music under voice, noise reduction, recording a clean voiceover, syncing cuts to a beat, and loudness. The rule you learn first: audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound.
Preparation before class	CapCut installed and tested; headphones or earphones for **every learner** (essential â€" this is an audio session); Pack C (Event and Music) copied to the shared class folder and verified; a free music track from an approved source (YouTube Audio Library, Pixabay or Mixkit) downloaded and ready; a short voiceover script prepared; the instructor's own audio pass pre-built to show the finished result; a simple loudness meter or the platform's loudness normalisation explained.

Instructor note on tone: This session changes how learners *hear* video. Some will realise for the first time that the music in their old videos was louder than the speaking. That realisation is the lesson. Be patient â€" audio is invisible, so it takes repetition to build the ear. Use the phrase "the voice is the boss" early and often.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why audio matters more than picture for watch-through, and state the rule: "audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound."
2. **Set relative levels** for dialogue, music and effects so the voice is clearly above the music and the music supports rather than fights.
3. **Duck music under voice** â€" lowering the music volume automatically or manually when someone is speaking.
4. **Apply noise reduction** to a clip with light room noise, and explain when it helps and when it hurts.
5. **Record a clean voiceover** using a phone or computer, with a simple script and a quiet room.
6. **Sync cuts to a music beat** and explain why beat-sync makes a video feel professional.
7. **Check loudness** by meter and by ear, and state what platforms expect.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut installed.
- **Headphones or earphones for every learner** â€" essential. Audio cannot be judged on speakers in a noisy classroom.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- A quiet corner of the room (or a separate space) for recording voiceovers.
- USB flash drives with each learner's organised packs.

Software

- CapCut desktop (free) â€" the tool for this session.
- A simple voice recorder (the phone's built-in recorder or the computer's Voice Recorder app) for the voiceover exercise.
- File Explorer â€" to locate audio files.

Sample files

- Each learner's **rough cut** (from Session 3) â€" the raw material for today's audio pass.
- **Pack C â€" Event and Music**: event-style clips with natural sound, meant to be cut to a music bed.
- **A free music track** from an approved source (YouTube Audio Library, Pixabay or Mixkit) â€" downloaded and ready. The track must be licensed for free use.
- **A short voiceover script** â€" printed, one per learner (a 15-second script for a restaurant promo).

- **A "before" audio clip** â€" a talking-head clip with light room noise, for the noise-reduction exercise.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "Levels Checklist" â€" a table: element / target level / actual level / adjustment.
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "Before/After Listening Note" â€" a short form: what I heard before / what I hear after / what I changed.

Accounts

- CapCut account (already created in Session 2).

Internet

- Needed only if downloading a music track in class. Pre-download the track so the session works offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut and headphones works. A learner can record a voiceover on a phone and transfer the file to the computer.

Instructor note on headphones: If the academy has fewer headphones than learners, pair them â€" one listens while the other adjusts, then swap. Audio judgement requires hearing; do not let learners skip the headphones.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, play a **30-second video twice** â€" once with the audio mixed badly (music loud, voice buried, room noise hissing), and once with the audio mixed well (voice clear, music supportive, noise reduced). Use the same video both times.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Same video, same picture, same cuts. The first version is hard to watch â€" the music is shouting over the voice, and there is a hiss in the background. The second version is easy to watch â€" the voice is clear, the music supports, and the noise is gone.*
>
> *Here is the rule that will change how you edit forever: **audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound.** A slightly blurry video with great audio keeps people watching. A beautiful video with bad audio loses them in ten seconds.*
>
> *Today you learn to make video sound right. By the end of this session, you will have done a full audio pass on your rough cut â€" and you will hear the difference."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "the first one is annoying," "I can't hear the person," "I didn't know you could fix that." Accept all answers. Say: "You already have the ear â€" you can hear the difference. Today we give that ear a method."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"Audio is invisible, which is why beginners ignore it. But the audience feels it. Today you learn the five audio skills: levels, ducking, noise reduction, voiceover and beat-sync. And you learn the loudness rule that platforms expect."*

Why this opener works: It isolates audio as the variable (same video, different sound), it proves learners already have the ear to hear bad audio, and it frames the session as giving that ear a method.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is a J-cut, and why does it make dialogue feel natural?"

- Expected answer: A J-cut is when the audio of the next clip starts before its picture â€" you hear the next speaker before you see them. It makes dialogue feel natural because it mimics how we actually hear conversations.

- Common gap: learners remember the name but not the reason. Clarify: "The technique is simple; the reason is what makes it professional."

Question 2: "What are the four parts of the short-video story shape?"

- Expected answer: Hook, beginning, middle, payoff.
- Common gap: learners confuse the story shape with the cut types. Clarify: "Story shape is the *structure*; cut types are the *tools*."

Question 3: "What is B-roll, and what are two things it does?"

- Expected answer: B-roll is supplementary footage (cutaways of hands, places, objects). It covers jump cuts and adds meaning/interest.
- Common gap: learners think B-roll is just filler. Clarify: "B-roll with purpose covers jumps and shows what the voice describes."

Question 4: "Why did we use straight cuts instead of transitions in Session 3?"

- Expected answer: Because straight cuts are invisible â€" they let the story flow without drawing attention to the edit. Transitions draw attention to themselves.
- Common gap: learners still want to use transitions. Clarify: "Transitions are for special moments; straight cuts are the default."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have a rough cut with good cuts and a clear story. Now we make it sound right. The voice is the boss â€" everything else supports it. Today you learn to mix audio so the voice is clear, the music supports, and the noise is gone."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing the J-cut on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why audio matters more than picture

The idea. Audiences will watch a slightly soft or dark video if the sound is good. They will not watch a beautiful video if the sound is bad. Audio is the invisible foundation of watch-through.

Plain-English definition. Audio mixing is the process of balancing all the sounds in a video â€" dialogue, music, effects, room noise â€" so the voice is clear and everything supports the story.

Why it matters:

- **The voice carries the message.** If the viewer cannot hear the speaker, the video has failed â€" no matter how good the picture is.
- **Bad audio is physically uncomfortable.** Loud music over quiet speech makes the viewer strain. Hissing noise makes them click away.
- **Good audio is invisible.** When the mix is right, the viewer does not notice the sound â€" they simply experience the story.

The rule (say it with the class):

> *"Audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound."*

Real-life comparison. Audio is like **the seasoning in food**. You do not see it, but if it is wrong â€" too much salt, no spice â€" the meal fails. A simple meal with good seasoning beats a fancy meal with bad seasoning. A simple video with good audio beats a beautiful video with bad audio.

Common misconception. "Audio is the sound engineer's job." No. In small productions â€" and in most freelance work â€" the editor *is* the sound person. You do not need to be a studio engineer; you need to know the five skills in this session.

F.2 Relative levels â€” the voice is the boss

The idea. Relative levels means setting the volume of each audio element *in relation to the others* â€” not just making everything loud.

Plain-English definition. A **level** is how loud something is. **Relative levels** means the voice is the loudest, the music is lower, and the effects are balanced â€” so the voice is always clear.

The level hierarchy (teach this order):

Element	Job	Relative level
Dialogue / voice	Carries the message	**Loudest â€” the boss**
Music	Sets the mood	Lower â€” supports the voice
Sound effects	Adds detail	Balanced â€” never fights the voice
Room noise / hiss	Unwanted	Reduced or removed

The practical levels (a starting point, not a rule):

- **Dialogue:** the main voice sits around **-12 dB to -6 dB** on the meter (CapCut shows this in the audio settings).
- **Music under voice:** around **-20 dB to -15 dB** â€” clearly audible but clearly below the voice.
- **Music without voice:** can come up to **-12 dB to -6 dB** for emotional moments.

How to set levels in CapCut:

1. Select the audio clip on the timeline.
2. In the audio tools, find the **volume** slider.
3. Adjust while watching the meter and listening on headphones.
4. The goal: the voice is always clearly above the music.

Real-life comparison. Levels are like **a conversation in a noisy market**. The person speaking (the voice) talks loudly enough to be heard. The background noise (music) is there, but it does not drown the speaker. If the background noise gets too loud, the speaker has to shout â€” and the listener leaves.

Common misconception. "Louder is better." No. A video where everything is loud is exhausting. The goal is *balance* â€” the voice clear, the music present but supportive.

F.3 Ducking â€” music under voice

The idea. Ducking means automatically lowering the music volume when someone is speaking, and raising it when they stop.

Plain-English definition. Ducking is a technique where the music "ducks" (dips) under the dialogue so the voice is always clear â€” then comes back up when the voice stops.

Why it exists. Without ducking, the music and voice compete â€” the viewer has to strain to hear over the music. With ducking, the music supports the voice without fighting it.

How to duck in CapCut (two methods):

Method 1 â€” Automatic ducking (if available):

1. Select the music clip on the timeline.
2. In the audio tools, look for **"Ducking"** or **"Auto ducking"**.
3. Set the ducking amount (how far the music dips) and the threshold (when it dips).
4. CapCut lowers the music automatically when dialogue is present.

Method 2 â€” Manual ducking (the reliable way):

1. Split the music clip at the start and end of each dialogue section.
2. Lower the volume of the music clips that sit under dialogue.
3. Raise the music back up for the gaps between dialogue.
4. Add a short fade (a few frames) at each volume change so it does not click.

The rule: duck the music under *every* section of dialogue â€” not just the loud parts. The viewer should never have to strain.

Real-life comparison. Ducking is like **a good friend at a party**. When you are speaking, they lower their voice so you can be heard. When you stop, they come back up. They do not talk over you.

Common misconception. "Ducking is only for professionals." No. Ducking is one of the easiest and most impactful audio skills â€” and it is the difference between an amateur and a professional sound.

F.4 Noise reduction â€” cleaning the sound

The idea. Noise reduction is a tool that reduces unwanted background hiss, hum or room noise from a recording.

Plain-English definition. Noise reduction listens to the audio and tries to remove the steady background noise (air conditioner hum, room hiss, distant traffic) while keeping the voice.

When it helps:

- Light room noise (a quiet fan, a distant air conditioner).
- A steady hum or hiss in the background.
- Slightly noisy phone recordings.

When it hurts:

- Heavy noise (a busy street, a loud crowd) â€” noise reduction makes the voice sound underwater or robotic.
- Very short clips â€” there is not enough "clean" audio for the tool to work with.
- When the noise is *part of the story* (a market scene, a football match) â€” do not remove it.

How to apply noise reduction in CapCut:

1. Select the audio clip (or the video clip with its audio).
2. In the audio tools, find **"Noise reduction"** or **"Denoise"**.
3. Apply it at a moderate strength â€” start low and increase until the noise is reduced but the voice still sounds natural.
4. Listen on headphones. If the voice sounds robotic or underwater, reduce the strength.

The rule: noise reduction is a *light touch*, not a miracle. If the recording is very noisy, the best fix is to re-record in a quieter place â€” not to push the tool harder.

Real-life comparison. Noise reduction is like **washing a slightly dirty plate**. A light wash removes the dust. But if the plate is covered in mud, washing harder will not make it clean â€” you need a fresh plate. A fresh recording in a quiet room is always better than heavy noise reduction.

Common misconception. "Noise reduction can fix any bad recording." No. It helps with light noise; it cannot fix heavy noise. The best fix is a good recording â€” which is why the next skill (voiceover) matters.

F.5 Recording a clean voiceover

The idea. A **voiceover** (VO) is a recorded narration that plays over the video. It is one of the most useful skills in editing â€” and one of the easiest to learn.

Plain-English definition. A **voiceover** is a separate audio recording of a narrator speaking a script, placed on the timeline over the video.

Why it exists:

- To explain what the video shows ("Mama T's Kitchen has been serving Port Harcourt for ten years").
- To add information the footage cannot show (prices, dates, calls to action).
- To give the video a professional, polished feel.

The five rules of a clean voiceover:

1. **Use a quiet room.** Turn off fans, air conditioners and televisions. Close windows. Record in a room with soft furnishings (curtains, carpets) â€” they absorb echo.
2. **Use the phone's voice recorder or a computer microphone.** You do not need a professional microphone for a beginner voiceover.
3. **Hold the phone 15â€“20 cm from your mouth** â€” close enough to be clear, far enough to avoid popping sounds on "p" and "b".
4. **Speak slowly and clearly.** Beginners speak too fast when recording. Slow down. Pause between sentences.

5. **Record two or three takes.** Choose the best one. Delete the others.

How to add a voiceover to the edit:

1. Record the voiceover and transfer the file to the computer.
2. Import the voiceover file into CapCut.
3. Place it on an audio track below the video.
4. Adjust its level so it sits clearly above the music.
5. Trim the start and end so it begins and ends cleanly.

Real-life comparison. A voiceover is like **a tour guide at a museum**. The exhibits (the video) are interesting, but the guide (the voiceover) tells you what you are looking at and why it matters. Without the guide, you walk past things without understanding.

Common misconception. "I do not have a good voice for voiceover." No. A clear, warm, honest voice is better than a "professional" voice that sounds fake. The audience wants to hear a real person â€" not a radio announcer.

F.6 Syncing cuts to a beat

The idea. Beat-sync means cutting the video on the beat of the music â€" so the cuts land exactly when the music hits.

Plain-English definition. Beat-sync is the technique of placing your cuts on the strong beats of the music track, so the video and music feel like one thing.

Why it exists. When cuts land on the beat, the video feels rhythmic and professional. When they land off-beat, the video feels sloppy â€" even if the viewer cannot say why.

How to beat-sync in CapCut:

1. Place the music track on the timeline.
2. Listen and tap (or note) where the strong beats fall â€" usually the drum hits.
3. Mark the beats (CapCut has a "beat marker" feature, or you can add markers manually).
4. Move your cuts so they land on the beat markers.
5. Watch and adjust until the cuts feel locked to the music.

The rule: beat-sync is most important in music-driven videos â€" promos, event highlights, fashion edits. In dialogue-driven videos (interviews, sermons), the cuts follow the speech, not the beat.

Real-life comparison. Beat-sync is like **dancing**. When you move on the beat, you look natural. When you move off-beat, you look awkward â€" even if the steps are the same. The music is the rhythm; the cuts are the dance.

Common misconception. "Beat-sync is only for music videos." No. Any video with a music bed benefits from beat-sync â€" a restaurant promo, a church highlight, a product ad. The beat gives the video energy.

F.7 Loudness â€" what platforms expect

The idea. Loudness is how loud the finished video sounds overall. Platforms like YouTube, Instagram and TikTok adjust videos to a standard loudness â€" so your video should already be close to that standard.

Plain-English definition. Loudness is the perceived volume of the whole video. Platforms measure it and turn quiet videos up and loud videos down â€" so a video that is mixed at the right loudness sounds consistent with everything else on the platform.

The practical guidance:

- **Do not make your video as loud as possible.** Over-compressed, distorted audio sounds terrible and gets turned down by the platform anyway.
- **Aim for a balanced mix** â€" the voice clear, the music supportive, nothing clipping (distorting).
- **Check by meter and by ear.** The meter shows the levels; the ear confirms they sound right.
- **Platform targets (approximate):** YouTube normalises to around **-14 LUFS**; Instagram and TikTok are similar. For this course, the practical rule is: the voice is clear, the music is balanced, and nothing distorts.

How to check loudness in CapCut:

1. Watch the audio meter while the video plays.
2. The voice should peak around **-6 dB** â€" not hitting 0 dB (which distorts).
3. The music should sit lower.

4. Listen on headphones: does it sound balanced and comfortable?

Real-life comparison. Loudness is like **the volume of your shop's music**. If it is too quiet, nobody notices you. If it is too loud, people cover their ears and walk past. The right volume makes people stop and listen.

Common misconception. "Louder gets more attention." No. A distorted, over-loud video gets *less* watch-through because it is uncomfortable. Balanced and clear wins.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- **Audio matters more than picture** â€" "audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound."
- **Relative levels** â€" the voice is the boss; music and effects support.
- **Ducking** â€" music dips under dialogue so the voice is always clear.
- **Noise reduction** â€" a light touch for light noise; re-record for heavy noise.
- **Voiceover** â€" a clean recording in a quiet room, slow and clear.
- **Beat-sync** â€" cuts land on the music's strong beats.
- **Loudness** â€" balanced, clear, nothing distorting; platforms normalise anyway.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Voice level] --> D[Clear audio]
    B[Music level] --> D
    C[Noise reduction] --> D
    D --> E[Professional sound]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Do a full audio pass on a rough cut â€" levels, ducking, noise reduction, voiceover and beat-sync â€" narrating every decision so learners see the craft in action.

Setup: CapCut open on the projector. A rough cut ready. Headphones on the instructor. A music track imported. A voiceover script ready.

Step 1 â€" The before listen (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "First, I listen to the raw audio. The music is loud, the voice is buried, and there is room noise. I note the problems."
- Play the rough cut. Point out the problems: music too loud, voice unclear, noise present.
- **Ask:** "What is the first thing to fix?" â†' The levels â€" the voice must be above the music.

Step 2 â€" Set relative levels (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "The voice is the boss. I lower the music until the voice is clearly above it. I watch the meter and listen on headphones."
- Adjust the music volume down; adjust the voice up if needed.
- **Ask:** "How do I know the level is right?" â†' The voice is clearly audible over the music without straining.

Step 3 â€" Duck the music (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "Now I duck the music under the dialogue. I split the music at the start and end of each speaking section and lower it there."
- Split the music; lower the volume under dialogue; add short fades.
- **Ask:** "What does ducking do?" â†' The music dips under the voice so the voice is always clear.

Step 4 â€" Noise reduction (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "There is light room noise. I apply noise reduction at a moderate strength â€" enough to reduce the hiss, not so much that the voice sounds robotic."
- Apply noise reduction; listen and adjust.
- **Ask:** "When does noise reduction hurt?" â†' When the noise is heavy â€" it makes the voice sound underwater.

Step 5 â€" Record and add a voiceover (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I record a short voiceover in a quiet corner â€" slow and clear. I import it, place it on an audio track, and set its level above the music."
- Play the pre-recorded voiceover (recorded before class); place it on the timeline; adjust the level.
- **Ask:** "What makes a good voiceover?" â†' A quiet room, slow clear speech, and a level above the music.

Step 6 â€" Beat-sync one section (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "This section has no dialogue â€" it is music-driven. I mark the beats and move the cuts to land on them."
- Mark the beats; adjust the cuts.
- **Ask:** "Why does beat-sync matter?" â†' It makes the video feel rhythmic and professional.

Expected result: A rough cut with balanced levels, ducked music, reduced noise, a clean voiceover and beat-synced cuts â€" the model learners will follow.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why is the voice the boss?" (Because it carries the message.)
- "What does ducking do?" (Music dips under dialogue.)
- "When does noise reduction hurt?" (Heavy noise â€" it makes the voice robotic.)
- "What makes a good voiceover?" (Quiet room, slow clear speech, right level.)
- "Why beat-sync?" (Cuts on the beat feel professional.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner does a full **audio pass** on their rough cut.

Starting materials: The learner's rough cut open in CapCut; headphones on; a music track imported; a voiceover script; Worksheet 4.1 (Levels Checklist) and 4.2 (Before/After Listening Note).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Put on your headphones. **Listen** to your rough cut once. Note the audio problems.
2. **Set relative levels:** lower the music until the voice is clearly above it. Fill in Worksheet 4.1.
3. **Duck the music:** split the music under each dialogue section and lower it there. Add short fades.
4. **Apply noise reduction** to one clip with light noise. Listen â€" adjust if it sounds robotic.
5. **Record a voiceover** (15 seconds, from the script) in a quiet corner. Import it and place it on an audio track.
6. **Set the voiceover level** so it sits clearly above the music.
7. **Beat-sync one section:** mark the beats and move the cuts to land on them.
8. **Check loudness:** watch the meter â€" the voice should peak around -6 dB, nothing distorting.
9. **Complete Worksheet 4.2:** what you heard before, what you hear after, what you changed.

Expected result: A rough cut with balanced levels, ducked music, reduced noise, a clean voiceover, beat-synced cuts, and completed worksheets.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 2: "Is the voice clearly above the music without straining?" (If not, adjust.)
- After step 5: "Does the voiceover sound natural â€" or robotic and forced?" (If robotic, re-record slower.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Music still too loud â†' Lower it further; the voice must be clearly above.
- Ducking sounds choppy â†' Add longer fades at the volume changes.
- Voice sounds robotic after noise reduction â†' Reduce the strength; or re-record in a quieter spot.
- Voiceover too quiet â†' Raise its level; check it is not under the music.
- Cuts not on the beat â†' Zoom in, move the cut to the exact beat marker.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Headphones on; rough cut listened to once
- ☐ Relative levels set (voice above music)

- [ ] Music ducked under dialogue
- [ ] Noise reduction applied (and sounds natural)
- [ ] Voiceover recorded, imported and levelled
- [ ] One section beat-synced
- [ ] Loudness checked (voice peaks around -6 dB)
- [ ] Worksheets 4.1 and 4.2 completed

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Do an audio pass on a **different piece of footage** â€" Pack C (Event and Music) â€" making your own decisions and explaining them.

Scenario. You are editing a 45-second event highlight for a community football match. You have Pack C: event-style clips with natural sound (crowd, whistles, cheering) and a free music track. The client wants the energy of the match but with the music driving the video.

Requirements:

1. Import Pack C and the music track into a new CapCut project.
2. Build a 30â€"45 second edit cut to the music (beat-sync the cuts).
3. Set relative levels: the music drives, but the natural sound (crowd, whistles) is present and balanced.
4. Duck the music under any commentary or important natural sound.
5. Apply noise reduction if needed (and explain why you did or did not).
6. Record a short voiceover (10 seconds) introducing the event. Place it and set its level.
7. Complete a Levels Checklist (Worksheet 4.1) for the final mix.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Edit cut to the music with beat-synced cuts.
- Relative levels set â€" music drives, natural sound balanced.
- Music ducked under important sound.
- Noise reduction applied appropriately (with reason).
- Voiceover recorded, placed and levelled.
- Levels Checklist completed.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Start by placing the music track and marking the beats â€" then cut the video to match.
- Hint 2: The natural sound of the crowd is part of the energy â€" do not remove it all.
- Hint 3: The voiceover should sit above the music but below nothing â€" it is the boss when it speaks.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a 30â€"45 second edit cut to the music with cuts landing on the strong beats; the music driving the video but the natural crowd sound present and balanced (not removed); the music ducked under the voiceover and any important natural sound (a whistle, a cheer); noise reduction applied only if there is steady background hiss (and not if the noise is part of the event's energy); a voiceover recorded in a quiet room, placed on an audio track, and levelled above the music; and a Levels Checklist showing the voiceover as the loudest element, the music lower, and the natural sound balanced.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Beat-synced cuts to the music (2)
- Relative levels set (music drives, natural sound balanced) (2)
- Music ducked under important sound (2)
- Noise reduction applied appropriately with reason (1)
- Voiceover recorded, placed and levelled (2)
- Levels Checklist completed (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ngozi* runs a small bakery in Port Harcourt. She posts videos of her cakes on Instagram, but the videos get few views and fewer orders. She watches her own videos and notices: the music is loud, her voice explaining the prices is hard to hear, and there is a constant hum from her mixer in the background. A competitor's bakery posts similar videos â€" but the voice is clear, the music is soft, and the videos feel professional. The competitor gets orders every week.

Relevant facts.

- Ngozi's videos are well-shot â€" the cakes look beautiful.
- The music is louder than her voice.
- There is a steady hum from the mixer in the background.
- She records her voice explaining the prices in the same noisy kitchen.
- The competitor's videos have clear voice, soft music and no hum.

Decision point. What is Ngozi's problem â€" and what should she fix first?

Possible approaches.

1. Buy a better phone and reshoot.
2. Use louder music to make the videos more energetic.
3. Fix the audio: lower the music, record the voice in a quiet room, and reduce the hum.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ngozi's problem is not her phone or her cakes â€" it is her audio. The music is drowning her voice (which carries the order information), and the hum makes the videos feel amateur. Lowering the music, recording the voice in a quiet room, and applying light noise reduction will transform the videos â€" for free.

Reasoning / what Ngozi would do:

- Lower the music so her voice is clearly above it.
- Record her price explanations in a quiet room (or a quieter corner, with the mixer off).
- Apply light noise reduction to reduce the hum.
- Duck the music under her voice when she speaks.
- The result: a video where the customer hears the prices clearly â€" and orders.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: a better phone will not fix audio that is mixed badly â€" the same problems will appear.
- Approach 2: louder music makes the problem worse â€" the voice becomes even harder to hear.
- Approach 3: free, immediate, and directly fixes the actual weakness. The customer can finally hear the prices.

Professional connection. A bakery that gets orders from Instagram is worth **â‚¦50,000â€"â‚¦150,000 a month** in extra sales. The difference between Ngozi and her competitor is not the cakes â€" it is the audio. An editor who can fix audio is worth **â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦30,000 per video** to small businesses like this. The skill is free to learn and immediately valuable.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Music louder than voice

Symptoms: The viewer cannot hear the speaker; the video feels uncomfortable. **Likely cause:** The music level was set too high relative to the voice. **How to investigate:** Listen on headphones â€" can you hear the voice clearly over the music? **Corrective steps:** Lower the music until the voice is clearly above it. The voice is the boss. **How to confirm resolved:** The voice is clearly audible without straining. **Prevention:** Set levels with the voice as the reference â€" everything else sits below it.

K.2 No ducking â€" music fights the voice throughout

Symptoms: The music and voice compete the whole time; the viewer has to strain. **Likely cause:** The music was not ducked under the dialogue. **How to investigate:** Listen â€" does the music dip when the voice speaks? **Corrective steps:** Split the

music under each dialogue section and lower it there. **How to confirm resolved:** The music supports the voice without fighting it. **Prevention:** Duck the music under every section of dialogue.

K.3 Heavy noise reduction â€" voice sounds robotic

Symptoms: The voice sounds underwater or robotic after noise reduction. **Likely cause:** The noise reduction strength was too high for the amount of noise. **How to investigate:** Listen â€" does the voice sound natural? **Corrective steps:** Reduce the strength; if the noise is heavy, re-record in a quieter place. **How to confirm resolved:** The voice sounds natural and the noise is reduced. **Prevention:** Use noise reduction as a light touch, not a miracle.

K.4 Voiceover recorded in a noisy room

Symptoms: The voiceover has echo, hum or background noise. **Likely cause:** The recording was made in a noisy room. **How to investigate:** Listen to the voiceover alone â€" is the background quiet? **Corrective steps:** Re-record in a quiet room â€" turn off fans, close windows, use soft furnishings. **How to confirm resolved:** The voiceover is clean and clear. **Prevention:** The recording environment is half the quality â€" choose it carefully.

K.5 Cuts not on the beat

Symptoms: The video feels sloppy even though the cuts are deliberate. **Likely cause:** The cuts do not land on the music's strong beats. **How to investigate:** Watch with the music â€" do the cuts land on the beat? **Corrective steps:** Mark the beats and move the cuts to land on them. **How to confirm resolved:** The cuts feel locked to the music. **Prevention:** Mark the beats before cutting; cut to the rhythm.

K.6 Audio distorting (clipping)

Symptoms: The audio crackles or distorts on loud moments. **Likely cause:** The level is too high â€" hitting 0 dB and clipping. **How to investigate:** Watch the meter â€" is it hitting the red? **Corrective steps:** Lower the level of the distorting clip. **How to confirm resolved:** The meter stays below 0 dB; the audio is clean. **Prevention:** Keep peaks around -6 dB; never let the meter hit the red.

K.7 Ignoring loudness â€" the video is too quiet or too loud

Symptoms: The video sounds inconsistent with other videos on the platform. **Likely cause:** The overall loudness was not checked. **How to investigate:** Compare with a professional video â€" is yours much quieter or louder? **Corrective steps:** Adjust the overall mix to a balanced level; check by meter and ear. **How to confirm resolved:** The video sounds consistent with professional content. **Prevention:** Check loudness at the end of every audio pass.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the meter reading, or the ducked music on the timeline). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Audio Pass â€" Before and After with a Levels Checklist"

Purpose: To practise the five audio skills until they are instinctive, and to build the audio skill the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You are editing a 60-second video for a Port Harcourt restaurant. You have a footage pack with talking-head interviews, B-roll and natural sound, plus a free music track. The client wants the video to sound professional â€" clear voice, supportive music, no noise.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open a new CapCut project with the correct settings (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps).
2. Import the footage and the music track.
3. Build a 45â€"60 second edit with a clear story (hook, beginning, middle, payoff).
4. Do a full audio pass:
    - Set relative levels (voice above music).
    - Duck the music under all dialogue.
    - Apply noise reduction where needed (and explain why).

- Record a 10-second voiceover introducing the restaurant. Place and level it.
- Beat-sync at least one music-driven section.

5. Check loudness â€" the voice should peak around -6 dB, nothing distorting.
6. Complete a **Levels Checklist** (Worksheet 4.1) and a **Before/After Listening Note** (Worksheet 4.2).
7. Save the project as `CEA-YourName_AudioPass`.

Required deliverables:

- The saved CapCut project (checked in class or via screenshot).
- The completed Levels Checklist and Before/After Listening Note.

Submission format: Checklists and notes as a typed document (`Session4_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week2/AudioPass/` , plus the project checked in class.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Relative levels set	4	Voice clearly above music; balanced mix
Music ducked under dialogue	4	Every dialogue section ducked; smooth fades
Noise reduction applied appropriately	3	Applied where needed; voice still natural
Voiceover recorded and levelled	3	Clean recording; placed and levelled above music
Beat-sync in one section	2	Cuts land on the beats
Loudness checked	2	Voice peaks around -6 dB; nothing distorting
Worksheets completed	2	Levels Checklist and Before/After Note filled in

Common mistakes to avoid: music louder than voice; no ducking; heavy noise reduction; voiceover recorded in a noisy room; cuts off the beat; distorting audio; no loudness check.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a 45â€"60 second edit with a clear story; the voice clearly above the music (music around -20 dB, voice around -12 to -6 dB); the music ducked under every dialogue section with smooth fades; noise reduction applied only to clips with light steady noise (not to the natural sound of the restaurant); a voiceover recorded in a quiet room, placed on an audio track, and levelled above the music; at least one music-driven section with cuts landing on the beats; loudness checked with the voice peaking around -6 dB and nothing distorting; and both worksheets completed â€" the Levels Checklist showing the hierarchy (voice loudest, music lower, effects balanced) and the Before/After Note describing the changes ("before: music drowned the voice; after: voice clear, music supportive").

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the rule about audio and picture â€" and why does it matter?

Q2. List. Name the five audio skills covered in this session.

Q3. Multiple choice. What does "ducking" mean? a) Removing the music entirely b) Lowering the music volume when someone is speaking c) Making the voice quieter d) Adding an echo effect

Q4. Explain. What is a voiceover, and what are two rules for recording a clean one?

Q5. Scenario. Your video's music is louder than the speaker's voice. What do you do, and what is the principle?

Q6. Short answer. What is beat-sync, and why does it make a video feel professional?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. "Audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound." It matters because the voice carries the message â€” if the viewer cannot hear it, the video has failed, no matter how good the picture is.

A2. Relative levels, ducking, noise reduction, voiceover, beat-sync (and loudness).

A3. (b) Lowering the music volume when someone is speaking â€” so the voice is always clear.

A4. A voiceover is a separate recorded narration placed over the video. Two rules for a clean one: (1) record in a quiet room (turn off fans, close windows), and (2) speak slowly and clearly, holding the phone 15â€“20 cm from your mouth.

A5. Lower the music until the voice is clearly above it. The principle: the voice is the boss â€” it carries the message, and everything else supports it.

A6. Beat-sync is cutting the video on the strong beats of the music. It makes the video feel professional because the cuts and music feel like one thing â€” rhythmic and intentional.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that audio matters more than picture â€” "audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound." You learned the five audio skills: relative levels (the voice is the boss), ducking (music dips under dialogue), noise reduction (a light touch for light noise), voiceover (a clean recording in a quiet room) and beat-sync (cuts on the beat). You learned to check loudness by meter and by ear. And you did a full audio pass on your rough cut â€” and heard the difference.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Audio matters more than picture** â€” bad sound loses viewers faster than a soft picture.
2. **The voice is the boss** â€” music and effects support, never fight.
3. **Ducking** â€” music dips under dialogue so the voice is always clear.
4. **Noise reduction is a light touch** â€” re-record in a quiet room for heavy noise.
5. **Beat-sync and loudness** â€” cuts on the beat; balanced, clear, nothing distorting.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain why audio matters more than picture?
- Can I set relative levels so the voice is clearly above the music?
- Can I duck the music under dialogue?
- Can I apply noise reduction without making the voice robotic?
- Can I record a clean voiceover?
- Can I sync cuts to a beat and check loudness?

Connection to the next session. Your rough cut now has good cuts, a clear story and balanced audio. Next session we make it **look right**: colour correction (exposure, contrast, white balance), matching clips, a light grade, and then text and graphics â€” titles, lower thirds and captions that are correctly spelled, timed and inside safe areas. The rule you will learn: **correction is fixing, grading is styling â€” and beginners master fixing first.**

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner puts on headphones before judging audio.
- Learner sets the voice clearly above the music without being told.
- Learner ducks the music under dialogue.
- Learner applies noise reduction at a moderate strength and checks it sounds natural.
- Learner records a voiceover in a quiet room, slowly and clearly.
- Learner syncs cuts to the beat and checks loudness.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Louder is better." â†’ Balance, not volume, is the goal.

- "Music makes the video." â†’ Music supports; the voice carries the message.
- "Noise reduction fixes everything." â†’ It helps with light noise; re-record for heavy noise.
- "I don't have a good voice." â†’ A clear, honest voice beats a fake "professional" one.
- "Beat-sync is only for music videos." â†’ Any video with a music bed benefits.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Levels drill:** give a clip with loud music and quiet voice; the learner adjusts the levels and explains the hierarchy.
2. **Ducking drill:** give a 30-second clip with dialogue; the learner ducks the music under every speaking section.
3. **Voiceover drill:** the learner records a 10-second voiceover in a quiet room and plays it back â€" then re-records it slower and compares.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a rough cut with the music already imported; the learner sets levels, ducks and records a voiceover.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full audio pass plus independent Pack C exercise.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to mix a video with three audio elements (voice, music, natural sound) and explain the hierarchy and every ducking decision.

Timing guidance. The priority is **learners doing a full audio pass and hearing the difference** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the independent exercise to the guided steps. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a mixed audio pass has not built the audio skill that Sessions 5â€"9 depend on.

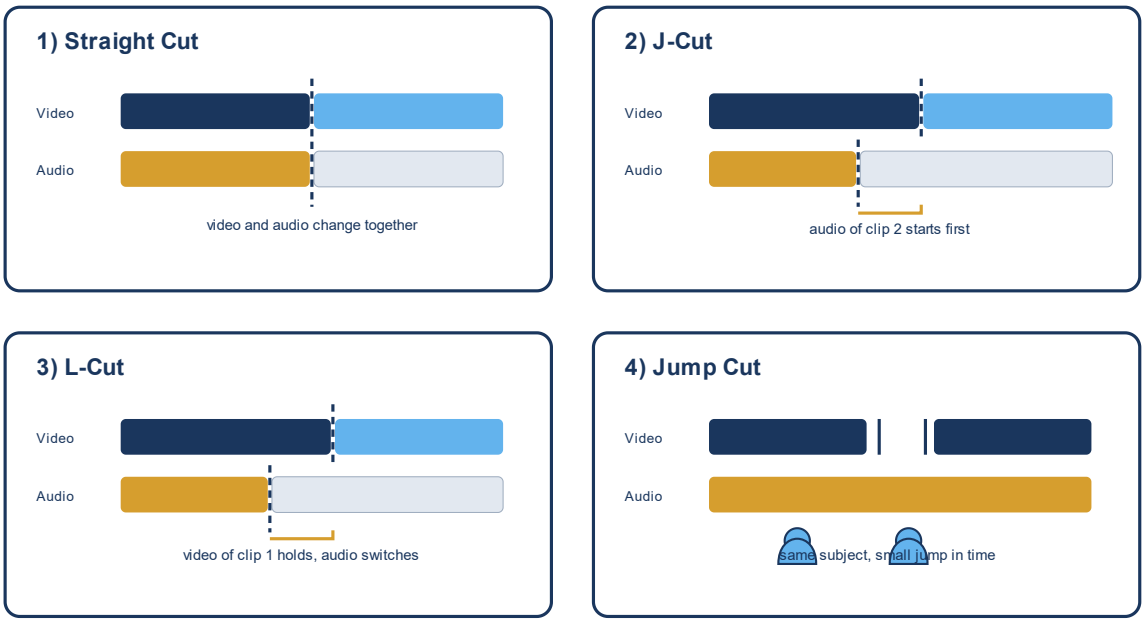
END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" Colour, Text and Graphics.

SESSION 05 OF 9

Colour Text and Graphics

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 05



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 5 â€" COLOUR, TEXT AND GRAPHICS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 9
Session title	Colour, Text and Graphics
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Craft
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first colour and text work)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"4 â€" learners must have their rough cut with balanced audio (from Session 4). They must be able to set up a project, use the five core actions and do a basic audio pass. No

Item	Detail
	prior colour or design knowledge assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 4 you made your video sound right. Today you make it **look right**: colour correction (exposure, contrast, white balance), matching clips of the same scene, a light grade, and then text and graphics â€" titles, lower thirds and captions that are correctly spelled, timed and inside safe areas. The rule: correction is fixing, grading is styling â€" and beginners master fixing first.
Preparation before class	CapCut installed and tested; a footage pack with mixed-colour clips (some dark, some warm, some cool) prepared and verified; a projector; printed safe-area diagrams (16:9, 9:16, 1:1, 4:5); the instructor's own colour pass pre-built to show the finished result; optional: DaVinci Resolve free version installed on the instructor's computer for the 5-minute first look (not required for learners).

Instructor note on tone: This session is where editing starts to look "professional" to the untrained eye â€" and learners will be tempted to overdo it. The key message: **fix first, style second, and less is more.** A natural, corrected video beats a heavily graded one every time. Keep the class disciplined about taste.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** the difference between colour correction (fixing) and colour grading (styling), and why beginners master fixing first.
2. **Correct exposure and white balance** on a clip â€" making a dark clip brighter and a warm/cool clip neutral.
3. **Match two clips** of the same scene so they look like they belong together.
4. **Apply a light, tasteful grade** that suits the story â€" without destroying the natural look.
5. **Create readable titles and lower thirds** that are correctly spelled, well placed and timed.
6. **Add captions** that are correctly spelled, timed to the speech, and inside safe areas on every platform.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut installed.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- USB flash drives with each learner's organised packs.

Software

- CapCut desktop (free) â€" the tool for this session.
- Optional: DaVinci Resolve (free) â€" for the instructor's 5-minute first look at a professional colour page. **Not required for learners.**

Sample files

- Each learner's **audio pass** (from Session 4) â€" the raw material for today's colour and text pass.
- A **mixed-colour footage pack**: clips that are too dark, too warm (orange), too cool (blue), and correctly exposed â€" for the correction exercises.
- **Safe-area diagrams** â€" printed, one per learner, showing the safe margins for 16:9, 9:16, 1:1 and 4:5.
- A **caption script** â€" a short printed script with deliberate spelling errors for learners to catch and fix.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "Colour Correction Log" â€" a table: clip / problem (dark/warm/cool) / adjustment made / result.
- Worksheet 5.2 â€" "Text and Caption Check" â€" a checklist: spelled correctly / timed to speech / inside safe areas / readable font.

Accounts

- CapCut account (already created in Session 2).

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut works. A learner on a phone can do the entire session in CapCut mobile â€" the colour tools and text tools are the same.

Instructor note on DaVinci Resolve: The 5-minute Resolve first look is *optional* and *instructor-only*. It shows learners what a professional colour page looks like â€" and reassures them that the CapCut skills transfer. Do not teach Resolve; just show it and move on.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show the **same 10-second clip three times**:

- **Version 1 (uncorrected):** The clip is too dark and too orange â€" the speaker's face is murky and the colours look sickly.
- **Version 2 (corrected):** The clip is bright, neutral and natural â€" the speaker's face is clear and the colours look real.
- **Version 3 (over-graded):** The clip has a heavy teal-and-orange grade â€" it looks like a Hollywood trailer, not a real video.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Same clip, same footage. Version 1 is what the camera recorded â€" too dark, too orange. Version 2 is corrected â€" bright, neutral, natural. Version 3 is over-graded â€" it looks like a movie trailer.*
>
> *Here is the rule for today: **correction is fixing, grading is styling â€" and beginners master fixing first.** Version 2 is the goal. Version 3 is what happens when you style before you learn to fix.*
>
> *Today you learn to make your video look right: fix the exposure, fix the white balance, match your clips, and add a light grade if the story needs it. Then you add text â€" titles, lower thirds and captions â€" that are correctly spelled, timed and inside safe areas. By the end of this session, your video will look intentional."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "version 2 looks real," "version 3 is too much," "how do I fix the orange?" Accept all answers. Say: "You already have the eye â€" you can see the difference. Today we give that eye a method."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"Colour is not magic â€" it is three adjustments: exposure, contrast and white balance. Text is not decoration â€" it is communication with rules. Learn both, and your video will look professional."*

Why this opener works: It shows the three states (uncorrected, corrected, over-graded), it proves learners have the eye to tell them apart, and it frames the session as disciplined fixing, not wild styling.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is ducking, and why do we do it?"

- Expected answer: Ducking is lowering the music volume when someone is speaking, so the voice is always clear. We do it so the music supports the voice without fighting it.
- Common gap: learners confuse ducking with noise reduction. Clarify: "Ducking is music under voice; noise reduction is removing background hiss."

Question 2: "What are the four parts of the short-video story shape?"

- Expected answer: Hook, beginning, middle, payoff.

- Common gap: learners forget the payoff. Clarify: "The payoff is the promise kept â€" the result or call to action."

Question 3: "What is the difference between a J-cut and an L-cut?"

- Expected answer: A J-cut is when the audio of the next clip starts before its picture. An L-cut is when the picture of the next clip starts before its audio. Both make dialogue feel natural.
- Common gap: learners remember the shapes but not which leads. Clarify: "J = audio leads. L = picture leads."

Question 4: "What is loudness, and how do you check it?"

- Expected answer: Loudness is the overall volume of the finished video. You check it by meter (the voice should peak around -6 dB, nothing distorting) and by ear.
- Common gap: learners think loudness is the same as volume. Clarify: "Volume is one clip; loudness is the whole mix."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your video now has good cuts, a clear story and balanced audio. Today we make it look right â€" and add the words that make it communicate. Colour first, then text. Fix first, style second. Less is more."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing ducking on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Correction vs. grading â€" fixing vs. styling

The idea. Colour correction is fixing problems â€" making a dark clip brighter, a warm clip neutral. **Colour grading** is styling â€" giving the video a mood or look. Beginners master fixing first.

Plain-English definitions:

- **Colour correction** â€" adjusting the picture so it looks natural and consistent: bright enough, neutral colours, no unwanted tint.
- **Colour grading** â€" adjusting the picture to create a mood: warm and golden for nostalgia, cool and blue for tension, teal-and-orange for a cinematic look.

Why the distinction matters. A beginner who grades before correcting is painting a wall that is still cracked. The grade cannot fix a dark, orange clip â€" it can only make a dark, orange clip look *dramatically* dark and orange. Fix first, then style â€" and only if the story needs it.

The rule (say it with the class):

> *"Correction is fixing, grading is styling â€" and beginners master fixing first."*

Real-life comparison. Correction is like **cleaning a room** â€" removing the dust, straightening the chairs. Grating is like **decorating the room** â€" choosing the curtains and the wall colour. You clean before you decorate, and a clean room with no decoration is still better than a decorated room that is dirty.

Common misconception. "Grading makes it look professional." No. A natural, corrected video looks professional. A heavily graded video looks amateur â€" unless the grade is done by an experienced colourist for a specific story purpose.

F.2 The three correction adjustments

The idea. Every colour correction is built from three adjustments. Master these and you can fix most clips.

The three adjustments (teach them in this order):

1. Exposure (brightness). How light or dark the whole clip is. If a clip is too dark â€" the speaker's face is murky, the details are lost â€" raise the exposure. If it is too bright â€" the sky is white, the highlights are blown â€" lower it.

- **The rule:** the subject's face should be clearly visible, with detail in the shadows and no pure white areas.

2. Contrast. The difference between the dark and light parts of the picture. Low contrast looks flat and washed out; high contrast looks punchy but can lose detail.

- **The rule:** increase contrast slightly to make the picture "pop" â€” but not so much that the shadows go pure black or the highlights go pure white.

3. White balance (colour temperature). Whether the clip looks warm (orange) or cool (blue). A clip shot under indoor lights often looks orange; a clip shot in the shade often looks blue.

- **The rule:** white objects should look white â€” not orange, not blue. Adjust the temperature until the colours look natural.

How to apply them in CapCut:

1. Select the clip on the timeline.
2. Open the colour tools (usually "Adjust" or "Colour").
3. Find the **exposure**, **contrast** and **temperature** (or "tint") sliders.
4. Adjust while watching the preview â€” fix exposure first, then white balance, then contrast.
5. Compare with the uncorrected version to check you have not overdone it.

Real-life comparison. The three adjustments are like **cooking a pot of soup**: exposure is how much soup there is (too little = hungry, too much = overflowing), contrast is how rich it is (watery vs. thick), and white balance is the seasoning (too salty = orange, too bland = blue). Adjust each until it tastes right.

Common misconception. "I can fix any clip." No. If a clip is very dark, very noisy or very blurry, correction can improve it â€” but the result is limited by what was captured. The best fix is a good recording.

F.3 Matching clips â€” making one scene look like one scene

The idea. When you cut between two clips of the same scene (for example, two camera angles of the same interview), the colours may not match â€” one is warmer, one is darker. **Matching** means adjusting them so they look like they belong together.

Plain-English definition. Matching (or "shot matching") is adjusting the colour of two or more clips of the same scene so the cut between them is invisible.

Why it exists. When the colours jump at a cut, the viewer notices â€” the scene feels broken. When the colours match, the cut is invisible and the scene feels whole.

The matching method:

1. Place the two clips on the timeline, one after the other.
2. Watch the cut â€” do the colours jump?
3. Select the second clip and adjust its exposure, contrast and temperature until it matches the first.
4. Watch the cut again â€” is it invisible?
5. If the difference is too large, consider using a different clip â€” some shots simply cannot be matched.

Real-life comparison. Matching is like **buying two pots of paint for the same wall**. If one pot is slightly darker, you adjust it until the two walls look like one. If the difference is too great, no amount of adjusting will hide the join.

Common misconception. "I can match any two clips." No. If the lighting is completely different (one indoors, one outdoors), matching is impossible â€” and the cut should be hidden with a B-roll cover instead.

F.4 A light grade â€” styling with restraint

The idea. A **grade** is a stylistic adjustment that gives the video a mood. A *light* grade is subtle â€” it enhances without shouting.

Plain-English definition. Grading is adjusting the colours to create a mood: warm for nostalgia, cool for calm, slightly desaturated for seriousness.

When to grade:

- When the story has a clear mood (a warm family video, a cool tech product).
- When you have already corrected everything â€” grade on top of correction.
- When the client asks for a specific look.

When not to grade:

- When the clips are not yet corrected.
- When the story is neutral (a tutorial, an interview).
- When you are not sure â€” a natural corrected video is always safe.

How to apply a light grade in CapCut:

1. Correct all clips first (exposure, white balance, contrast).
2. Apply a subtle adjustment to the whole video â€” for example, a slight warmth (+5 to +10 temperature) or a slight desaturation (-5 to -10 saturation).
3. Watch the whole video â€” does it feel natural? If it looks "filtered," you have overdone it.

Real-life comparison. A light grade is like **a light spice in food** â€” it enhances the flavour without overwhelming it. Heavy grading is like dumping in a whole bottle of pepper â€” it drowns everything else.

Common misconception. "Grading is what professionals do, so I should grade everything." No. Professionals grade *selectively* â€” when the story needs it. A beginner who grades everything learns bad habits.

F.5 Titles and lower thirds â€” the words that communicate

The idea. Titles and **lower thirds** are text overlays that communicate information: the name of the video, the name of a speaker, a location, a price.

Plain-English definitions:

- **Title** â€” the main text, usually at the start or end: the name of the video or business.
- **Lower third** â€” text in the lower third of the screen, usually introducing a speaker: their name and role.

Why they exist. Titles tell the viewer what they are watching. Lower thirds tell them who is speaking. Both make the video feel professional and help the viewer follow the story.

The five rules of good text (teach these exactly):

1. **Spell correctly.** A misspelt title destroys trust. Always proofread.
2. **Use a readable font.** Sans-serif fonts (clean, simple) are easiest to read. Avoid decorative fonts for important information.
3. **Keep it short.** A title is 2â€“5 words. A lower third is a name and a role â€” nothing more.
4. **Place it inside safe areas.** (See F.6.) Text must not be covered by the platform's interface.
5. **Time it well.** A title appears for 2â€“4 seconds. A lower third appears when the speaker starts and disappears when they finish.

Real-life comparison. A title is like **the signboard of a shop** â€” it tells you what the shop sells. A lower third is like **a name badge** â€” it tells you who is speaking. Both are simple, clear and necessary.

Common misconception. "More text = more professional." No. Too much text clutters the screen and competes with the video. The best text is the minimum that communicates.

F.6 Safe areas â€” where text survives the platform

The idea. Safe areas are the parts of the screen that are not covered by the platform's interface â€” the play button, the progress bar, the username, the caption.

Plain-English definition. The **safe area** is the central region of the screen where text will always be visible â€” not covered by buttons, icons or overlays.

Why it exists. Every platform puts its interface on top of the video: the play button, the progress bar, the likes, the username. If your text sits under those elements, it is unreadable.

The safe-area rule for each platform (teach the margins):

Platform	Aspect ratio	Safe area rule
YouTube	16:9	Keep text inside the central 80% â€” avoid the very edges
TikTok / Reels / Shorts	9:16	Keep text inside the central 70% â€” avoid the top (username) and bottom (caption, buttons)

Platform	Aspect ratio	Safe area rule
Instagram feed	1:1 or 4:5	Keep text inside the central 75% â€” avoid the edges
WhatsApp Status	9:16	Same as TikTok â€” central 70%

The practical method: In CapCut, turn on the **safe area guide** (usually in the preview settings). It shows a grid â€” keep all text inside the inner grid.

Real-life comparison. Safe areas are like **the clear space around a road sign**. A sign planted in the bushes is useless. A sign in the clear space is seen by everyone. Text in the safe area is seen; text outside it is hidden.

Common misconception. "I will place text wherever it looks nice." No. Text that looks nice in the editor but sits under the platform's play button is invisible to the viewer. Always check the safe area.

F.7 Captions â€” the words everyone needs

The idea. Captions are the text of what is being said, placed on the screen as the video plays. They are for everyone â€” not just the deaf.

Plain-English definition. Captions are a text transcription of the audio, timed to appear as the words are spoken.

Why they exist:

- **Many people watch with the sound off** â€” on buses, at work, in church.
- **Captions improve comprehension** â€” for people who are hard of hearing, or who speak a different first language.
- **Captions improve watch-through** â€” platforms report higher completion rates for captioned videos.
- **Captions are standard, not optional** â€” this course teaches them as a core skill.

The five rules of good captions:

1. **Spell correctly.** A misspelt caption is worse than no caption.
2. **Time them accurately.** Each caption appears when the word is spoken and disappears after.
3. **Keep them short.** One line, or two short lines at most. Do not fill the screen with text.
4. **Place them inside safe areas.** (See F.6.)
5. **Use a readable style.** White text with a black outline (or shadow) is readable on any background.

How to add captions in CapCut:

1. Use the **auto-captions** feature (if available) to generate a first draft.
2. **Proofread** the draft carefully â€” auto-captions make mistakes, especially with accents and names.
3. **Adjust the timing** â€” nudge captions that appear too early or too late.
4. **Style them** â€” readable font, white text with outline, inside safe areas.

Real-life comparison. Captions are like **subtitles in a Nollywood film** â€” they let everyone follow the story, regardless of the language or the noise in the room. A video without captions excludes everyone who cannot hear it clearly.

Common misconception. "Captions are only for deaf people." No. Captions are for the bus, the office, the church, the noisy market â€” and for anyone who reads faster than they listen. Most viewers under 30 watch with captions at least sometimes.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- **Correction is fixing; grading is styling** â€” master fixing first.
- **The three corrections:** exposure (brightness), contrast, white balance (temperature).
- **Matching** makes two clips of the same scene look like one scene.
- **A light grade** styles with restraint â€” only after correction, only if the story needs it.
- **Titles and lower thirds** communicate â€” spelled correctly, short, readable, timed well, inside safe areas.
- **Safe areas** are where text survives the platform interface.
- **Captions** are for everyone â€” spelled correctly, timed accurately, short, inside safe areas.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Color correction] --> D[Polished video]
    B[Title cards] --> D
    C[Lower thirds] --> D
    D --> E[Ready to export]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Do a full colour and text pass â€” correction, matching, a light grade, titles, lower thirds and captions â€” narrating every decision.

Setup: CapCut open on the projector. A rough cut ready. Mixed-colour clips available. Safe-area diagrams on the board.

Step 1 â€” Correct a dark, orange clip (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "This clip is too dark and too orange. I fix exposure first â€” raise it until the face is clear. Then white balance â€— adjust the temperature until white looks white. Then a touch of contrast."
- Apply the adjustments. Show the before and after.
- **Ask:** "Why exposure first?" â†' Because brightness affects everything else.

Step 2 â€— Match two clips (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "These two angles of the same interview do not match â€— one is warmer. I adjust the second until the cut is invisible."
- Apply the matching adjustment.
- **Ask:** "What if the difference is too great?" â†' Use a different clip or hide the cut with B-roll.

Step 3 â€— Apply a light grade (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "This is a warm family video. I apply a slight warmth â€— just enough to feel cosy, not so much that it looks filtered."
- Apply the grade. Show the result.
- **Ask:** "How do I know if I overdid it?" â†' If it looks filtered, you overdid it.

Step 4 â€— Add a title and a lower third (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "I add a title at the start â€— the business name, short and spelled correctly. Then a lower third when the speaker appears â€— their name and role. Both inside the safe area."
- Add the title and lower third. Show the safe-area guide.
- **Ask:** "Why inside the safe area?" â†' Because the platform's interface covers the edges.

Step 5 â€— Add captions (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "I generate captions with the auto feature, then proofread â€— the auto-captions made two mistakes with the name. I fix the spelling and nudge the timing. White text with a black outline, inside the safe area."
- Generate, proofread and style the captions.
- **Ask:** "Why proofread?" â†' Because auto-captions make mistakes â€— and a misspelt caption destroys trust.

Expected result: A corrected, matched, lightly graded video with a title, a lower third and accurate captions â€— the model learners will follow.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why fix before grade?" â†' Because grading cannot fix a broken clip.
- "What are the three corrections?" â†' Exposure, contrast, white balance.
- "Why proofread captions?" â†' Auto-captions make mistakes.
- "Why safe areas?" â†' The platform's interface covers the edges.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner does a full **colour and text pass** on their edit.

Starting materials: The learner's edit open in CapCut; mixed-colour clips available; safe-area diagrams; Worksheet 5.1 (Colour Correction Log) and 5.2 (Text and Caption Check).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. **Correct a dark clip:** raise exposure until the face is clear; adjust white balance until colours are neutral; add a touch of contrast.
2. **Correct a warm or cool clip:** adjust the temperature until white objects look white.
3. **Match two clips:** adjust the second clip until the cut between them is invisible.
4. **Log your corrections:** fill in Worksheet 5.1 â€" clip, problem, adjustment, result.
5. **Apply a light grade** (optional, if the story has a clear mood): a slight warmth or coolness â€" subtle.
6. **Add a title:** the business name, short, spelled correctly, inside safe areas, 2â€"4 seconds.
7. **Add a lower third:** the speaker's name and role, inside safe areas, timed to their appearance.
8. **Add captions:** generate with auto-captions, proofread for spelling, adjust timing, style with white text and outline.
9. **Complete Worksheet 5.2:** check every text element â€" spelled correctly, timed, inside safe areas, readable.

Expected result: A corrected, matched, lightly graded video with a title, a lower third and accurate captions â€" and completed worksheets.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 4: "What did you adjust, and why?" (If they cannot say, the correction is accidental.)
- After step 8: "Did the auto-captions make any mistakes?" (Almost always yes â€" this is why proofreading matters.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Clip still dark after raising exposure â†' Check the original â€" if it is very dark, the detail may not exist.
- Colours look worse after white balance â†' Reset and adjust temperature in smaller steps.
- Grade looks filtered â†' Reduce the adjustment; less is more.
- Title covered by the platform interface â†' Move it inside the safe area.
- Captions out of sync â†' Nudge them left or right until they match the speech.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Dark clip corrected (exposure, white balance, contrast)
- ☐ Warm/cool clip corrected (temperature)
- ☐ Two clips matched
- ☐ Colour Correction Log completed
- ☐ Light grade applied (if appropriate) â€" subtle
- ☐ Title added (spelled correctly, inside safe areas, timed)
- ☐ Lower third added (name, role, inside safe areas, timed)
- ☐ Captions added (proofread, timed, styled, inside safe areas)
- ☐ Text and Caption Check completed

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Do a colour and text pass on a **new piece of footage** â€" a product video with challenging colour â€" making your own decisions and explaining them.

Scenario. You are editing a 30-second product video for a Port Harcourt phone-accessory shop. The footage includes: a clip shot under orange shop lights (too warm), a clip shot in the shade outside (too cool), and a clip that is correctly exposed. The owner appears in one clip and must be introduced. The video will be posted to Instagram Reels.

Requirements:

1. Import the clips into a new CapCut project set to 9:16 (for Reels).
2. Correct the warm clip (temperature) and the cool clip (temperature).
3. Match the corrected clips so they look consistent.
4. Add a title with the shop name and a lower third introducing the owner.

5. Add captions for the owner's key sentence â€" proofread for spelling.
6. Complete a Colour Correction Log (Worksheet 5.1) for every adjustment.
7. Check every text element against safe areas for 9:16.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Warm and cool clips corrected (temperature adjusted).
- Clips matched for consistency.
- Title and lower third added â€" spelled correctly, timed, inside safe areas.
- Captions added â€" proofread, timed, inside safe areas.
- Colour Correction Log completed.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: The warm clip needs a cooler temperature; the cool clip needs a warmer temperature â€" adjust until white objects look white.
- Hint 2: For Reels, keep text inside the central 70% â€" the top and bottom are covered by the interface.
- Hint 3: Generate captions with auto-captions, then proofread â€" the shop name is a common mistake.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a 9:16 project; the warm clip corrected by lowering the temperature (removing the orange cast); the cool clip corrected by raising the temperature (removing the blue cast); the two clips matched so the cut between them is invisible; a title with the shop name, short and spelled correctly, inside the safe area; a lower third with the owner's name and role, timed to their appearance; captions for the owner's key sentence, proofread (especially the shop name), timed to the speech, styled with white text and outline, inside the safe area; and a Colour Correction Log where every row names the clip, the problem (too warm / too cool), the adjustment (temperature down / temperature up) and the result (white objects look white).

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Warm clip corrected (temperature) (2)
- Cool clip corrected (temperature) (2)
- Clips matched (1)
- Title added (spelled, timed, safe area) (1)
- Lower third added (name, role, safe area) (1)
- Captions added (proofread, timed, safe area) (2)
- Colour Correction Log completed (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ifeoma* runs a hair salon in Port Harcourt. She wants to post a 30-second video on Instagram Reels showing a new hairstyle. She has three clips: one shot under her salon's orange lights, one shot outside in the shade, and one correctly exposed clip of the finished hairstyle. She adds a title with the salon name â€" but she spells "Glamour" as "Glamor." She adds no lower third introducing herself. She does not add captions. The video gets few views and no new bookings.

Relevant facts.

- The orange-lights clip makes the hair colour look wrong.
- The shade clip makes the video look cold and unflattering.
- The title has a spelling mistake.
- Viewers cannot hear the audio clearly over the music in the first 5 seconds.
- The video is posted in 16:9, so it has black bars on Reels.

Decision point. What is wrong â€" and what should Ifeoma fix first?

Possible approaches.

1. Post more videos â€" the problem is consistency, not quality.
2. Fix everything at once: colour, text, captions, aspect ratio and audio.

3. Fix the biggest problems first: aspect ratio, colour correction, title spelling and captions â€” then improve audio.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ifeoma's video has several problems, but the biggest are: wrong aspect ratio (16:9 on Reels means black bars), uncorrected colour (the hair looks wrong), a misspelt title (destroys trust) and no captions (excludes viewers who watch without sound). Fixing these four transforms the video. Audio improvements matter too â€” but the visual and text problems are losing viewers first.

Reasoning / what Ifeoma would do:

- Set the project to 9:16 for Reels.
- Correct the orange and cool clips so the hair colour looks true.
- Fix the title spelling â€" "Glamour," not "Glamor."
- Add a lower third introducing herself ("Ifeoma, Glamour Salon").
- Add captions â€" proofread.
- Lower the music so her voice is clear.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: more videos with the same problems get the same poor results â€" consistency without quality is just repeated failure.
- Approach 2: trying to fix everything at once is overwhelming â€" and the learner may fix nothing well.
- Approach 3: fixing the biggest problems first gives the fastest improvement â€" and teaches the habit of prioritising.

Professional connection. A salon that gets one new booking per week from a 30-second video has earned back the cost of the video many times over. A 30-second Reel edited with correct colour, a spelt title and captions is worth **â‚¦15,000â€"â‚¦30,000** as a freelance job. The skill is the same skill Ifeoma needs for her own business â€" and it is the skill this course teaches.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Grading before correcting

Symptoms: The video looks dramatically stylised but the colours are wrong â€" dark clips are dramatically dark, orange clips are dramatically orange. **Likely cause:** A grade was applied before the clips were corrected. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" does it look natural, or does it look filtered? **Corrective steps:** Remove the grade; correct all clips (exposure, white balance, contrast); then apply a light grade only if the story needs it. **How to confirm resolved:** The clips look natural; any grade is subtle. **Prevention:** Correction first, grading second â€" always.

K.2 Over-grading â€" the "filtered" look

Symptoms: The video looks like a movie trailer, not a real video. The colours are unnatural. **Likely cause:** The grade adjustment is too strong. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" does it look filtered? **Corrective steps:** Reduce the grade to a subtle level, or remove it entirely. **How to confirm resolved:** The video looks natural and intentional. **Prevention:** Less is more â€" a light grade enhances; a heavy grade destroys.

K.3 Text outside safe areas

Symptoms: The title or captions are partially covered by the platform's interface when posted. **Likely cause:** The text was placed in the outer margins, where the platform puts its buttons and overlays. **How to investigate:** Turn on the safe-area guide and check â€" is the text inside the inner grid? **Corrective steps:** Move the text inside the safe area. **How to confirm resolved:** The text is fully visible on the platform. **Prevention:** Always check the safe area before exporting.

K.4 Misspelt titles or captions

Symptoms: A title says "Glamor" instead of "Glamour"; a caption misspells a name. **Likely cause:** The text was not proofread; or auto-captions made a mistake that was not caught. **How to investigate:** Read every word of every text element out loud. **Corrective steps:** Fix the spelling; for captions, proofread the auto-generated draft. **How to confirm resolved:** Every word is spelled correctly. **Prevention:** Proofread every text element â€" a misspelt title destroys trust.

K.5 Captions out of sync

Symptoms: Captions appear before or after the words are spoken. **Likely cause:** The caption timing was not adjusted after generation. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" do the captions match the speech? **Corrective steps:** Nudge the captions left or right until they match. **How to confirm resolved:** Each caption appears when the word is spoken. **Prevention:** Adjust timing after generating captions â€" auto-timing is close but not perfect.

K.6 Clips that do not match

Symptoms: The cut between two angles of the same interview is jarring â€" the colours jump. **Likely cause:** The two clips have different colour temperatures or exposure. **How to investigate:** Watch the cut â€" do the colours jump? **Corrective steps:** Adjust the second clip's exposure and temperature until it matches; if the difference is too great, use a different clip or hide the cut with B-roll. **How to confirm resolved:** The cut is invisible. **Prevention:** Match clips during correction â€" do not leave it for later.

K.7 Unreadable text (poor font or contrast)

Symptoms: The text is hard to read â€" a decorative font, or text that blends into the background. **Likely cause:** The font is too decorative, or the text colour clashes with the video. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" can you read every word easily? **Corrective steps:** Use a clean sans-serif font; add a black outline or shadow so the text reads on any background. **How to confirm resolved:** Every word is readable at a glance. **Prevention:** Sans-serif font, white text with outline â€" readable on any background.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the safe-area guide with the text inside it, or the corrected clip's settings). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Colour Pass and Text Set â€" Correction, Grade, Titles and Captions"

Purpose: To practise colour correction and text skills until they are instinctive, and to build the look and text skill the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You are editing a 60-second video for a Port Harcourt restaurant. You have a footage pack with clips of mixed colour quality (some warm, some cool, some correctly exposed), a speaking owner, and a clear story. The client wants the video to look natural, warm and appetising â€" with a title, a lower third for the owner and captions.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open a new CapCut project with the correct settings (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps).
2. Import the footage.
3. **Correct** every clip: exposure, white balance and contrast â€" until the colours look natural.
4. **Match** clips of the same scene so the cuts are invisible.
5. Apply a **light grade** if the story has a clear mood (a warm restaurant video can take a slight warmth).
6. Add a **title** with the restaurant name â€" spelled correctly, short, inside safe areas.
7. Add a **lower third** introducing the owner â€" name and role, inside safe areas, timed to their appearance.
8. Add **captions** for the owner's key lines â€" proofread for spelling, timed to the speech, styled readably, inside safe areas.
9. Complete a **Colour Correction Log** (Worksheet 5.1) and a **Text and Caption Check** (Worksheet 5.2).
10. Save the project as `CEA-YourName_ColourTextPass`.

Required deliverables:

- The saved CapCut project (checked in class or via screenshot).
- The completed Colour Correction Log and Text and Caption Check.

Submission format: Logs and checks as a typed document (`Session5_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week2/ColourText/`, plus the project checked in class.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Exposure corrected	3	Dark clips brightened; faces clear
White balance corrected	3	Warm/cool clips neutralised; colours natural
Clips matched	3	Cuts between same-scene clips are invisible
Light grade applied (if appropriate)	2	Subtle, natural, not filtered
Title added	2	Spelled correctly, short, inside safe areas, timed
Lower third added	2	Name and role, inside safe areas, timed
Captions added	3	Proofread, timed, styled, inside safe areas
Worksheets completed	2	Colour Correction Log and Text Check filled in

Common mistakes to avoid: grading before correcting; over-grading; text outside safe areas; misspelt titles or captions; captions out of sync; clips that do not match; unreadable text.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: every clip corrected (dark clips brightened with exposure, warm clips cooled with temperature, cool clips warmed, contrast adjusted for punch); clips of the same scene matched so cuts are invisible; a light grade applied only if the story warrants it (a slight warmth for a restaurant); a title with the restaurant name, short, spelled correctly, inside safe areas, shown for 2â€“4 seconds; a lower third with the owner's name and role, timed to their appearance, inside safe areas; captions for the owner's key lines, proofread (especially names and menu items), timed to the speech, styled with white text and a black outline, inside safe areas; and both worksheets completed â€” the Colour Correction Log showing each clip's problem and adjustment, and the Text Check confirming every element is spelled correctly, timed, inside safe areas and readable.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€” answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the difference between colour correction and colour grading?

Q2. List. Name the three colour correction adjustments.

Q3. Multiple choice. What is a "safe area"? a) The area where the subject stands b) The part of the screen not covered by the platform's interface c) The area around the playhead d) The folder where text files are stored

Q4. Explain. Why are captions for everyone â€” not just deaf people?

Q5. Scenario. Your video has a clip shot under orange lights and a clip shot in the shade. What do you do to each, and what is the principle?

Q6. Short answer. What are the five rules of good text (titles and lower thirds)?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1. Colour correction is fixing problems â€” making a dark clip brighter, a warm clip neutral. Colour grading is styling â€” giving the video a mood (warm, cool, cinematic). Beginners master fixing first.

A2. Exposure (brightness), contrast, and white balance (temperature/tint).

A3. (b) The part of the screen not covered by the platform's interface â€” where text will always be visible.

A4. Because many people watch with the sound off (on buses, at work, in church), captions improve comprehension for everyone, and platforms report higher watch-through for captioned videos. They are standard, not optional.

A5. Correct the orange-lights clip by lowering the temperature (removing the orange cast); correct the shade clip by raising the temperature (removing the blue cast). The principle: white objects should look white â€” adjust until the colours are natural.

A6. (1) Spell correctly, (2) use a readable font, (3) keep it short, (4) place it inside safe areas, (5) time it well.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that correction is fixing and grading is styling â€” and beginners master fixing first. You learned the three corrections: exposure (brightness), contrast and white balance (temperature). You learned to match clips of the same scene so cuts are invisible, and to apply a light grade only when the story needs it. You learned to add titles and lower thirds that are correctly spelled, short, readable, timed well and inside safe areas. You learned that safe areas are where text survives the platform's interface. And you learned that captions are for everyone â€” proofread, timed, styled and inside safe areas. Your video now looks intentional.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Correction first, grading second** â€” fix the clip, then style it.
2. **The three corrections** â€” exposure, contrast, white balance.
3. **Match clips** so cuts between same-scene angles are invisible.
4. **Text has rules** â€” spelled correctly, short, readable, timed, inside safe areas.
5. **Captions are for everyone** â€” proofread, timed, inside safe areas.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain the difference between correction and grading?
- Can I correct a dark, warm or cool clip?
- Can I match two clips of the same scene?
- Can I apply a light grade without making it look filtered?
- Can I add titles, lower thirds and captions that are correct and inside safe areas?

Connection to the next session. Your video now has good cuts, a clear story, balanced audio, corrected colour and readable text. Next session we make it **move right**: tasteful transitions, keyframes and a slow zoom, a speed ramp, and a basic motion title. The rule you will learn first: **the best transition is usually no transition.** Every effect must pass the test: does this help the story, or only my ego?

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner corrects before grading â€” without being reminded.
- Learner adjusts exposure, white balance and contrast deliberately.
- Learner matches clips so cuts are invisible.
- Learner applies a light grade â€” or correctly decides not to grade.
- Learner places text inside safe areas and checks it.
- Learner proofreads captions and fixes auto-caption mistakes.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Grading makes it professional." â†’ A natural corrected video looks professional; heavy grading looks amateur.
- "I can fix any clip." â†’ Correction improves; it cannot create detail that was never captured.
- "Text anywhere is fine." â†’ Text outside safe areas is covered by the platform.
- "Captions are optional." â†’ Captions are standard â€” they improve reach, inclusion and watch-through.
- "Auto-captions are perfect." â†’ They make mistakes â€” always proofread.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Correction drill:** give three clips (dark, warm, cool); the learner corrects each and explains the adjustments.
2. **Safe-area drill:** show a 9:16 frame; the learner places a title and captions inside the safe area and explains why.
3. **Caption proofread drill:** give a caption script with five deliberate errors; the learner finds and fixes them.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide clips that are only slightly warm or cool; the learner corrects with small adjustments.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€” full colour and text pass plus independent exercise.

- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to correct a clip, match it with a second clip, and design a light grade that suits a specific mood (warm for a family video, cool for a tech product) â€" and explain the mood choice.

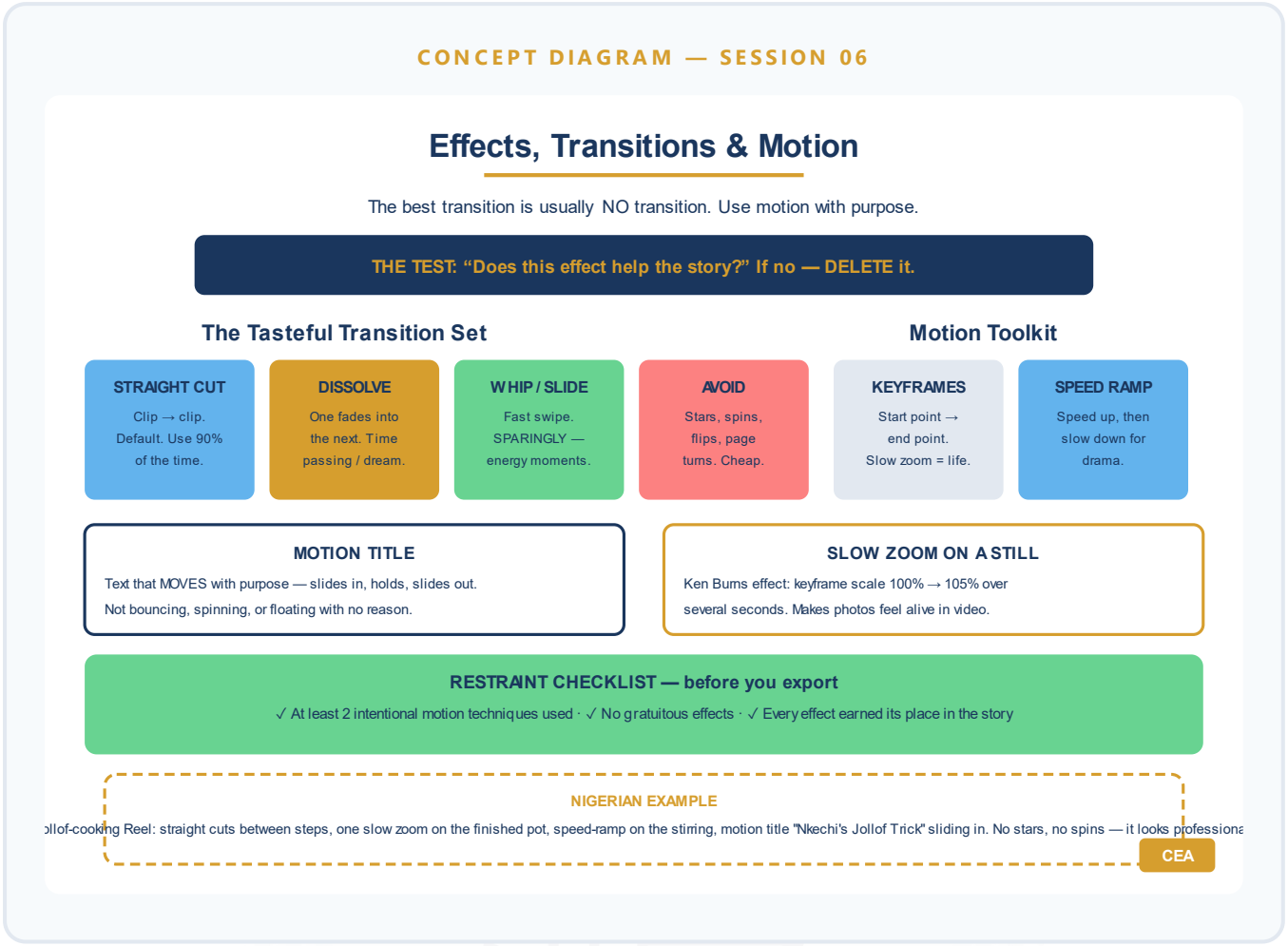
Timing guidance. The priority is **learners doing a colour and text pass** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the independent exercise to the guided steps. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a corrected, captioned video has not built the look and text skill that Sessions 6â€"9 depend on.

END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Effects, Transitions and Motion.

SESSION 06 OF 9

Effects Transitions and Motion



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 6 â€" EFFECTS, TRANSITIONS AND MOTION

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 9
Session title	Effects, Transitions and Motion
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 2: Craft
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first effects and motion work)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"5 â€" learners must have their colour and text pass (from Session 5) with corrected colour, titles, lower thirds and captions. They must be able to do a full audio pass. No prior

Item	Detail
	effects or motion knowledge assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 5 you made your video look right â€” corrected colour, a light grade, titles, lower thirds and captions. Today you make it **move right**: tasteful transitions, keyframes and a slow zoom, a speed ramp, and a basic motion title. The rule: the best transition is usually no transition. Every effect must pass the test â€” does this help the story, or only my ego?
Preparation before class	CapCut installed and tested; a footage pack with a mix of still images and video clips (for the slow zoom and speed ramp exercises); a projector; the instructor's own motion pass pre-built to show the finished result; printed "effect justification" cards (a table of effects and when they help or hurt).

Instructor note on tone: This is the session where learners are most tempted to overdo it â€” and the session where discipline matters most. The key message: **the best transition is usually no transition, and the best effect is the one the viewer does not notice.** Celebrate restraint. A learner who uses two effects well is ahead of one who uses twenty badly.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** why the best transition is usually no transition, and identify the tasteful set: straight cut, dissolve, and a sparing whip or slide.
2. **Apply a dissolve** between two clips where it helps â€” and remove it where it hurts.
3. **Animate with keyframes** â€” including a slow zoom on a still image or video clip.
4. **Create a speed ramp** â€ speeding up and slowing down a clip for dramatic effect.
5. **Build a basic motion title** â€ text that moves with purpose.
6. **Apply the "does this help the story?" test** to every effect â€ and delete every effect that does not earn its place.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut installed.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- USB flash drives with each learner's organised packs.

Software

- CapCut desktop (free) â€ the tool for this session.
- File Explorer â€ to locate footage.

Sample files

- Each learner's **colour and text pass** (from Session 5) â€ the raw material for today's motion pass.
- A **mixed footage pack**: still images (for the slow zoom), a video clip of movement (for the speed ramp), and two similar clips (for the dissolve exercise).
- **Effect justification cards** â€ printed, one set per learner: a table of common effects and when they help or hurt.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 6.1 â€ "Effect Justification Log" â€ a table: effect / where used / does it help the story? (yes/no) / reason.
- Worksheet 6.2 â€ "Motion Pass Checklist" â€ a tick-list for the practical.

Accounts

- CapCut account (already created in Session 2).

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut works. A learner on a phone can do the entire session in CapCut mobile â€" keyframes, speed ramps and transitions are the same.

Instructor note on keyframes: Keyframes are the most important concept in this session. They are the mechanism behind almost all motion in editing â€" zooms, pans, fades, animations. Teach the *concept* (a keyframe marks a value at a moment; the software interpolates between keyframes) before the *button*.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, play a **20-second video twice**:

- **Version 1:** The video uses a different transition between every clip â€" a whip, a spin, a glitch, a zoom, a flash. It feels chaotic and exhausting.
- **Version 2:** The same video uses straight cuts and one dissolve. It feels calm and professional.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Same video, same clips, same story. Version 1 uses a different transition between every clip. Version 2 uses straight cuts and one dissolve.*
>
> *Here is the rule that will save you from the most common beginner mistake:* ***the best transition is usually no transition.*** *A straight cut is invisible â€" the viewer simply experiences the story. A transition draws attention to itself. If the viewer is noticing your transitions, they are not feeling your story.*
>
> *Today you learn the tasteful set â€" straight cut, dissolve, and a sparing whip or slide. You learn keyframes, a slow zoom, a speed ramp and a basic motion title. And you learn the test every effect must pass:* ***does this help the story, or only my ego?*** *By the end of this session, you will have applied at least two motion techniques â€" and deleted every effect that does not earn its place."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "version 1 is too much," "version 2 is calm," "I want to use the cool ones." Accept all answers. Say: "You already have the taste â€" you can feel the difference. Today we give that taste a method â€" and the discipline to say no."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"Effects are like pepper in food. A little enhances the meal. Too much ruins it. Today you learn to use pepper â€" and to know when the meal is better without it."*

Why this opener works: It shows the contrast between over-use and restraint, it proves learners have the taste to feel the difference, and it frames the session as disciplined choice, not button collection.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is the difference between colour correction and colour grading?"

- Expected answer: Correction is fixing problems (exposure, white balance, contrast). Grading is styling (creating a mood). Beginners master fixing first.
- Common gap: learners still want to grade everything. Clarify: "Grade only when the story needs it â€" and only after correction."

Question 2: "What are safe areas, and why do they matter?"

- Expected answer: Safe areas are the parts of the screen not covered by the platform's interface. They matter because text placed outside them is hidden by buttons and overlays.
- Common gap: learners place text wherever it looks nice. Clarify: "Text in the editor is not text on the platform â€" check the safe area."

Question 3: "What is a J-cut, and why does it make dialogue feel natural?"

- Expected answer: A J-cut is when the audio of the next clip starts before its picture. It makes dialogue natural because it mimics how we hear conversations.
- Common gap: learners remember the shape but not the reason. Clarify: "The technique is simple; the reason is what makes it professional."

Question 4: "What is the rule about audio and picture?"

- Expected answer: "Audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound." Audio matters more than picture for watch-through.
- Common gap: learners still focus on picture first. Clarify: "The voice carries the message â€" protect it."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your video now has good cuts, a clear story, balanced audio, corrected colour and readable text. Today we make it move â€" with taste. The best transition is usually no transition. Every effect must earn its place. Learn the discipline, and your video will feel professional."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing correction vs. grading on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 The best transition is usually no transition

The idea. A **transition** is a visual effect between two clips â€" a fade, a wipe, a spin. The most powerful transition is the one the viewer does not notice: the straight cut.

Plain-English definition. A **transition** is a visual effect that connects two clips. A **straight cut** is the absence of a transition â€" one clip simply ends and the next begins.

Why the straight cut is king. A straight cut is invisible. The viewer's eye follows the story, not the edit. A transition â€" a fade, a wipe, a spin â€" draws attention to itself. If the viewer is noticing the transition, they are not feeling the story.

The tasteful set (teach these three):

Transition	What it does	When to use it
Straight cut	No effect â€" one clip ends, the next begins	**Default â€" 90% of cuts**
Dissolve (crossfade)	One clip fades into the next	To show time passing, or a gentle change of scene
Whip / slide (sparring)	A fast, energetic movement between clips	For high-energy moments â€" sports, music, fashion â€" and only a few times

The rule: use straight cuts by default. Use a dissolve when the story needs a gentle shift. Use a whip or slide sparingly â€" a few times in a video, never between every clip.

Real-life comparison. A straight cut is like **turning a page in a book** â€" you do not notice the page turn; you simply continue the story. A transition is like **a page turn with a flashy animation** â€" it is fun once, annoying every time.

Common misconception. "More transitions = more professional." No. A video with a different transition between every clip looks amateur. A video with straight cuts and one well-placed dissolve looks professional.

F.2 Keyframes â€” the engine of motion

The idea. A **keyframe** is a marker that tells the software: "at this moment, the value is this." The software then interpolates (creates the in-between frames) between keyframes.

Plain-English definition. A **keyframe** is a point on the timeline where you set a value â€” position, scale, opacity, rotation. The software animates smoothly between keyframes.

Why keyframes matter. Keyframes are the mechanism behind almost all motion in editing: zooms, pans, fades, animations. Once you understand keyframes, you can create any motion effect â€” and you understand how the software thinks.

The keyframe concept (teach this with a simple example):

- At the start of a clip, set a keyframe with **scale = 100%** (normal size).
- At the end of the clip, set a keyframe with **scale = 120%** (slightly larger).
- The software animates between them: the clip slowly zooms in. That is a **slow zoom** â€” built from two keyframes.

The three properties you animate most:

- **Scale** â€ size (zoom in = scale up, zoom out = scale down).
- **Position** â€ location (move the clip up, down, left, right).
- **Opacity** â€ transparency (fade in = opacity 0% to 100%, fade out = 100% to 0%).

How to use keyframes in CapCut:

1. Select the clip on the timeline.
2. Move the playhead to where the animation should start.
3. Set the first keyframe (e.g., scale = 100%).
4. Move the playhead to where the animation should end.
5. Set the second keyframe (e.g., scale = 120%).
6. The software animates between them.

Real-life comparison. Keyframes are like **giving someone directions**: "Start here (keyframe 1). End there (keyframe 2)." The software drives the route between them. You decide the start and end; the software handles the journey.

Common misconception. "Keyframes are advanced." No. They are simple once you understand the concept: set a value, set another value, let the software connect them. The hard part is not the technique â€ it is *choosing* when motion serves the story.

F.3 The slow zoom â€ the most useful motion technique

The idea. A **slow zoom** is a gradual zoom in or out on a still image or video clip. It is the most useful motion technique in editing â€ and the easiest.

Plain-English definition. A **slow zoom** is a gradual change in scale over time â€ the clip slowly gets bigger (zoom in) or smaller (zoom out).

Why it exists. A still image with no motion is dead. A slow zoom gives it life â€ the viewer's eye moves, the image feels present. A slow zoom on a video clip adds emphasis â€ drawing the viewer's attention to the subject.

When to use it:

- On a still image â€ to make it feel alive.
- On a video clip â€ to add emphasis or emotion.
- At the start of a video â€ to draw the viewer in.
- At the end of a video â€ to create a sense of closure.

How to create a slow zoom (the keyframe method):

1. Select the clip on the timeline.
2. At the start, set a keyframe with **scale = 100%**.
3. At the end, set a keyframe with **scale = 110â€“120%** (a subtle zoom â€ not a dramatic one).
4. The software animates the slow zoom.

The rule: a slow zoom is *slow* â€ 10â€“20% over the length of the clip. A fast zoom looks like a mistake; a slow zoom feels intentional.

Real-life comparison. A slow zoom is like **leaning in to listen** â€" you move closer to what matters. A fast zoom is like **jumping toward the speaker** â€" it startles. Lean in; do not jump.

Common misconception. "A bigger zoom is more dramatic." No. A subtle zoom (10â€"20%) is elegant. A big zoom (50%+) looks like a mistake. Less is more.

F.4 Speed ramps â€" controlling time

The idea. A **speed ramp** is a change in playback speed within a single clip â€" speeding up, then slowing down (or the reverse).

Plain-English definition. A **speed ramp** is a gradual change in the playback speed of a clip â€" for example, starting fast, then slowing to normal speed at the key moment.

Why it exists. A speed ramp controls the viewer's experience of time. Speeding up creates energy; slowing down creates emphasis. A well-placed speed ramp makes a moment feel dramatic.

When to use it:

- To emphasise a key moment â€" slow down as the action peaks.
- To compress time â€" speed up a long, uneventful section.
- To create energy â€" speed up a sequence of quick cuts.

How to create a speed ramp in CapCut:

1. Select the clip on the timeline.
2. Use the **speed** tool to change the playback speed.
3. For a ramp, split the clip into sections and set different speeds for each â€" or use the curve speed tool if available.
4. The transition between speeds should be gradual (a ramp), not abrupt.

The rule: a speed ramp should feel intentional â€" the viewer should feel the change, not be confused by it. Use it sparingly â€" a few times in a video, not in every clip.

Real-life comparison. A speed ramp is like **a drummer's roll** â€" the beat speeds up, then slows to a stop at the key moment. It is dramatic because it is controlled. A constant fast tempo is just noise.

Common misconception. "Speed ramps are for action videos only." No. A slow-down on a speaker's key line can be powerful. A speed-up on a preparation sequence can compress time elegantly. Match the ramp to the story.

F.5 Motion titles â€" text that moves with purpose

A motion title is text that animates â€" it slides, fades, or scales onto the screen. It is more engaging than static text â€" but only when the motion serves the message.

Plain-English definition. A **motion title** is a title or text element that animates onto (or off) the screen â€" using keyframes for position, opacity or scale.

Why it exists. Static text is functional. Motion text is engaging â€" it draws the eye and adds energy. But motion text that is too flashy distracts from the message.

The rules of motion titles:

1. **The motion serves the message.** A gentle fade or slide is professional; a spinning, bouncing title is a distraction.
2. **Keep it short.** A motion title is 2â€"4 seconds â€" long enough to read, short enough to not annoy.
3. **Time it to the story.** The title appears when the story is ready for it â€" not before.
4. **Use keyframes.** Animate position, opacity or scale â€" not all three at once.

How to build a basic motion title in CapCut:

1. Add a text element to the timeline.
2. At the start, set a keyframe with **opacity = 0%** (invisible) and **position = below the screen**.
3. A second later, set a keyframe with **opacity = 100%** and **position = centre**.
4. The title fades in and slides up â€" a simple, professional motion title.

Real-life comparison. A motion title is like **a shopkeeper opening the store** â€" the sign appears when the store is ready, not before, and it does not spin wildly to get attention. It appears, clearly, and lets the customer in.

Common misconception. "More motion = more professional." No. A gentle, well-timed motion title is professional. A chaotic one is a distraction. The motion serves the message â€” never the reverse.

F.6 The "does this help the story?" test

The idea. Every effect, transition and motion technique must pass one test: **does this help the story, or only my ego?**

Plain-English definition. The **story test** is a question you ask before keeping any effect: does this effect help the viewer understand or feel the story â€” or does it just show off the editor's tools?

How to apply the test:

1. Add the effect.
2. Watch the video.
3. Ask: "Does this help the story?"
4. If yes â€” keep it. If no â€” delete it.
5. If you are not sure â€” delete it. (When in doubt, cut it out.)

The three categories of effects:

Category	What it is	What to do
Helps the story	A dissolve showing time passing; a slow zoom on a key moment; a speed ramp on the action peak	Keep it
Neutral	A straight cut; a gentle fade	Keep it (it is invisible)
Hurts the story	A spin transition; a glitch effect; a chaotic motion title	Delete it

Real-life comparison. The story test is like **the market trader's question**: "Does this spice help the food, or am I just showing off my pepper?" A good cook adds spice that enhances the meal. A bad cook adds spice to show off â€” and the meal suffers.

Common misconception. "If I made the effect, I should use it." No. The effect is a tool, not a trophy. If it does not serve the story, it is clutter. Delete it without mercy.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **The best transition is usually no transition** â€” straight cuts are invisible.
- **The tasteful set:** straight cut (default), dissolve (gentle shifts), whip/slide (sparring, high energy).
- **Keyframes** are markers that set values; the software animates between them.
- **A slow zoom** (10â€“20%) brings stills to life and adds emphasis.
- **A speed ramp** controls time â€” speed up for energy, slow down for emphasis.
- **A motion title** animates with purpose â€” the motion serves the message.
- **The story test:** does this help the story, or only my ego? If unsure, delete it.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Tasteful transition] --> D[Smooth video]
    B[Keyframe zoom] --> D
    C[Speed ramp] --> D
    D --> E[Engaging edit]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Do a full motion pass â€” a dissolve, a slow zoom, a speed ramp and a motion title â€” narrating every decision and applying the story test.

Setup: CapCut open on the projector. A rough cut ready. Still images and video clips available. Effect justification cards on the desk.

Step 1 â€" The straight cut default (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "Most of my cuts are straight cuts â€" invisible. I only add a transition when the story needs it. Watch: this cut is a straight cut. The viewer does not notice it â€" they simply continue the story."
- Point out a straight cut on the timeline.
- **Ask:** "Why is the straight cut invisible?" â†' Because there is no effect â€" one clip simply ends and the next begins.

Step 2 â€" A dissolve for time passing (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "Here the story jumps forward â€" from morning to evening. A dissolve shows time passing gently. I add a dissolve between the two clips."
- Add a dissolve. Show the result.
- **Ask:** "Why a dissolve here?" â†' Because the story needs to show time passing â€" a dissolve is the gentle way to do it.

Step 3 â€" A slow zoom on a still image (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "This still image is dead â€" no motion. I add a slow zoom: 100% to 115% over the clip. Now it feels alive."
- Set the keyframes for the slow zoom. Show the result.
- **Ask:** "Why 100% to 115%?" â†' Because a subtle zoom is elegant; a big zoom looks like a mistake.

Step 4 â€" A speed ramp on the action (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "This is the key moment â€" the reveal. I speed up the preparation, then slow down at the reveal. The speed ramp controls time."
- Split the clip and set different speeds. Show the result.
- **Ask:** "Why slow down at the reveal?" â†' Because slowing down creates emphasis â€" the viewer feels the moment.

Step 5 â€" A motion title (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I add a motion title â€" it fades in and slides up. Gentle, professional. The motion serves the message."
- Add the motion title with keyframes. Show the result.
- **Ask:** "Why not a spinning title?" â†' Because a spinning title distracts from the message.

Expected result: A video with straight cuts, one dissolve, a slow zoom, a speed ramp and a motion title â€" every effect justified by the story.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "Why is the straight cut the default?" â†' Because it is invisible.
- "When do you use a dissolve?" â†' When the story needs to show time passing or a gentle shift.
- "What is a keyframe?" â†' A marker that sets a value; the software animates between keyframes.
- "What is the story test?" â†' Does this help the story, or only my ego?

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner does a full **motion pass** on their edit â€" applying at least two motion techniques and deleting every effect that does not earn its place.

Starting materials: The learner's edit open in CapCut; still images and video clips available; Worksheet 6.1 (Effect Justification Log) and 6.2 (Motion Pass Checklist).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. **Review your edit:** watch it once. Note where motion could help â€" a still image, a key moment, a title.
2. **Add a dissolve** where the story shows time passing or a gentle shift.
3. **Add a slow zoom** (100% to 115%) on one still image or video clip.
4. **Add a speed ramp** on one key moment â€" speed up, then slow down.
5. **Add a motion title** â€" fade in and slide up, gentle and professional.
6. **Apply the story test:** for each effect, ask "does this help the story?" â€" delete any that do not.
7. **Log your effects:** fill in Worksheet 6.1 â€" effect, where used, does it help the story?, reason.

8. **Complete Worksheet 6.2:** check every motion technique â€" keyframes used, slow zoom subtle, speed ramp intentional, motion title professional.

Expected result: A video with at least two motion techniques, every effect justified, and completed worksheets.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 6: "Which effect did you delete â€" and why?" (If they deleted none, ask: "Are you sure every effect earns its place?")
- After step 7: "Can you explain each effect in one sentence?" (If not, the effect may be accidental.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Dissolve looks like a mistake â†' Check it is placed where the story shifts â€" not randomly.
- Slow zoom too fast â†' Extend the keyframes further apart; the zoom should be gradual.
- Speed ramp is abrupt â†' Use a curve or split the clip into more sections for a gradual ramp.
- Motion title too flashy â†' Simplify: fade and slide only, no spinning or bouncing.
- Too many effects â†' Apply the story test ruthlessly â€" delete until only the essential remain.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Edit reviewed; motion opportunities noted
- ☐ Dissolve added where the story shifts
- ☐ Slow zoom added (100% to 115%)
- ☐ Speed ramp added on a key moment
- ☐ Motion title added (fade and slide)
- ☐ Story test applied â€" weak effects deleted
- ☐ Effect Justification Log completed
- ☐ Motion Pass Checklist completed

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Do a motion pass on a **new piece of footage** â€" a product launch video â€" making your own decisions and applying the story test.

Scenario. You are editing a 45-second product launch video for a Port Harcourt tech shop. You have: a still image of the product, a video clip of the product being unboxed, a clip of the shop owner speaking, and a clip of customers reacting. The client wants the video to feel energetic and modern.

Requirements:

1. Import the footage into a new CapCut project.
2. Build a 30â€"45 second edit with a clear story.
3. Apply **at least two motion techniques** from this session: a slow zoom, a speed ramp, a motion title, or a dissolve.
4. Apply the **story test** to every effect â€" delete any that do not earn their place.
5. Complete an Effect Justification Log (Worksheet 6.1) for every effect you keep.
6. Explain in one sentence why each kept effect helps the story.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- At least two motion techniques applied.
- Every effect passes the story test.
- Effect Justification Log completed with reasons.
- The video feels energetic but not chaotic.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: A slow zoom on the product still image is an easy, elegant start.
- Hint 2: A speed ramp on the unboxing moment adds energy.

- Hint 3: If an effect feels like showing off, delete it â€” the story test is strict.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€” do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a 30â€“45 second edit with a clear story; at least two motion techniques applied deliberately â€” for example, a slow zoom (100% to 115%) on the product still image to make it feel alive, and a speed ramp on the unboxing moment to build energy; a dissolve where the story shifts from the product to the owner; a motion title that fades in and slides up; and an Effect Justification Log where every kept effect has a reason ("slow zoom â€” makes the still image feel alive," "speed ramp â€” builds energy at the unboxing," "dissolve â€” shows the shift from product to owner"). Any effect that does not help the story has been deleted.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- At least two motion techniques applied (3)
- Every effect passes the story test (3)
- Effect Justification Log completed with reasons (2)
- Video feels energetic but not chaotic (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Kelechi* is a freelance editor in Port Harcourt. His first client â€” a gym owner â€ asks for a 30-second promo. Kelechi is excited and uses every transition he knows: a whip, a spin, a glitch, a zoom, a flash â€ between every clip. He adds a spinning title and a speed ramp on every clip. The client watches the video and says: "It is too much. I cannot even hear what you are saying. Can you make it calm?"

Relevant facts.

- Kelechi's footage is good â€ clear shots of the gym, people training, the owner speaking.
- The transitions are so frequent that the viewer cannot focus.
- The spinning title distracts from the gym's name.
- The speed ramps on every clip make the video feel chaotic.
- The client's main request â€ "show the gym and give the address" â€ is lost in the effects.

Decision point. What went wrong â€ and what should Kelechi do differently?

Possible approaches.

1. Use even more effects â€ the client just does not understand good editing.
2. Remove all effects and make the video completely static.
3. Apply the story test: keep only the effects that help the story, delete the rest.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Kelechi's problem is not that he knows effects â€ it is that he used them all. The story test would have saved him: a straight cut between most clips, one dissolve where the story shifts, a slow zoom on the gym's logo, a calm title with the gym's name. The client wants to see the gym and hear the address â€ not watch a effects showcase.

Reasoning / what Kelechi would do:

- Replace most transitions with straight cuts.
- Keep one dissolve where the story shifts.
- Add a slow zoom on the gym's logo.
- Replace the spinning title with a calm fade-in.
- Remove the speed ramps except one â€ on the most energetic moment.
- The result: a video that shows the gym, gives the address, and feels professional.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: more effects make the problem worse â€ the client already said "too much."
- Approach 2: removing all effects makes the video flat â€ motion, used well, is engaging.
- Approach 3: the story test keeps the effects that help and removes the ones that hurt â€ the video feels professional and the client's message is clear.

Professional connection. Kelechi's first client could lead to many more â€" a gym, a salon, a shop, a church. But only if the first video is professional. An editor who applies the story test â€" who uses effects with discipline â€" builds a reputation. An editor who overdoes it loses clients. The difference is not skill â€" it is judgement. And judgement is what this session teaches.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 A different transition between every clip

Symptoms: The video feels chaotic and exhausting; the viewer cannot focus on the story. **Likely cause:** A transition was added between every clip instead of using straight cuts. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" are there more transitions than straight cuts? **Corrective steps:** Replace most transitions with straight cuts; keep only the ones the story needs. **How to confirm resolved:** The video feels calm; transitions are rare and purposeful. **Prevention:** Straight cuts are the default; transitions are the exception.

K.2 Over-using keyframes â€" everything moves

Symptoms: The video feels busy; the viewer does not know where to look. **Likely cause:** Keyframes were added to every clip â€" zooms, pans, fades everywhere. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" does everything move? **Corrective steps:** Remove keyframes from clips that do not need motion; keep only the essential. **How to confirm resolved:** Motion is rare and purposeful. **Prevention:** Motion serves the story â€" not every clip needs it.

K.3 A slow zoom that is too fast or too big

Symptoms: The zoom looks like a mistake â€" too sudden or too dramatic. **Likely cause:** The keyframes were too close together (too fast) or the scale change was too large (too big). **How to investigate:** Watch the zoom â€" is it gradual and subtle? **Corrective steps:** Move the keyframes further apart; reduce the scale change to 10â€"20%. **How to confirm resolved:** The zoom is slow and subtle. **Prevention:** A slow zoom is 10â€"20% over the length of the clip â€" no more.

K.4 A speed ramp that is abrupt

Symptoms: The speed change feels jarring â€" the viewer is confused. **Likely cause:** The speed changed instantly instead of ramping gradually. **How to investigate:** Watch the ramp â€" is the change gradual? **Corrective steps:** Use a curve or split the clip into more sections for a gradual ramp. **How to confirm resolved:** The speed change is smooth and intentional. **Prevention:** A ramp is gradual â€" the viewer should feel the change, not be shocked by it.

K.5 A motion title that distracts

Symptoms: The title spins, bounces or flashes â€" the viewer watches the animation, not the message. **Likely cause:** The title animation is too complex or too flashy. **How to investigate:** Watch the title â€" does the animation serve the message? **Corrective steps:** Simplify â€" fade in and slide up, nothing more. **How to confirm resolved:** The title is calm and readable. **Prevention:** The motion serves the message â€" gentle and professional.

K.6 Keeping an effect because it was hard to make

Symptoms: The video has an effect that does not help the story â€" but the learner keeps it because they spent time on it. **Likely cause:** The learner is attached to the effect, not the story. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Does this help the story, or only your ego?" **Corrective steps:** Delete it. The time is spent; the story is what matters. **How to confirm resolved:** Every effect earns its place. **Prevention:** The story test is strict â€" if it does not help, delete it.

K.7 No motion at all â€" the video is static

Symptoms: The video feels flat and dead â€" especially if it uses still images. **Likely cause:** No motion techniques were applied. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" do still images feel dead? **Corrective steps:** Add a slow zoom to still images; add a motion title; add a dissolve where the story shifts. **How to confirm resolved:** The video feels alive but not chaotic. **Prevention:** Motion, used well, brings a video to life.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the timeline with the transitions, or the keyframe settings). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Motion Pass â€" Two Techniques and a Justification Log"

Purpose: To practise motion techniques until they are instinctive, and to build the motion skill the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You are editing a 60-second video for a Port Harcourt event centre. You have a footage pack with still images of the venue, video clips of events, and a speaking owner. The client wants the video to feel elegant and professional â€" with motion that serves the story.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open a new CapCut project with the correct settings (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps).
2. Import the footage.
3. Build a 45â€"60 second edit with a clear story.
4. Apply **at least two motion techniques** from this session: a slow zoom, a speed ramp, a motion title, or a dissolve.
5. Apply the **story test** to every effect â€" delete any that do not earn their place.
6. Complete an **Effect Justification Log** (Worksheet 6.1) for every effect you keep: effect, where used, does it help the story?, reason.
7. Complete a **Motion Pass Checklist** (Worksheet 6.2).
8. Save the project as `CEA-YourName_MotionPass`.

Required deliverables:

- The saved CapCut project (checked in class or via screenshot).
- The completed Effect Justification Log and Motion Pass Checklist.

Submission format: Logs and checklist as a typed document (`Session6_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week2/MotionPass/` , plus the project checked in class.

Deadline: Before Session 7.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
At least two motion techniques applied	4	Slow zoom, speed ramp, motion title or dissolve â€" deliberately chosen
Story test applied	4	Weak effects deleted; every kept effect justified
Slow zoom subtle (if used)	2	10â€"20%, gradual
Speed ramp intentional (if used)	2	Gradual, on a key moment
Motion title professional (if used)	2	Fade and slide, not flashy
Effect Justification Log completed	4	Every effect logged with reason
Overall elegance and restraint	2	The video feels professional, not chaotic

Common mistakes to avoid: a different transition between every clip; over-using keyframes; a slow zoom that is too fast or too big; an abrupt speed ramp; a distracting motion title; keeping an effect because it was hard to make; no motion at all.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a 45â€"60 second edit with a clear story; at least two motion techniques applied deliberately â€" for example, a slow zoom (100% to 115%) on a still image of the venue to make it feel alive, and a motion title that fades in and slides up; a dissolve where the story shifts from the venue to the owner; an Effect Justification Log where every kept effect has a reason ("slow zoom â€" makes the still image feel alive," "dissolve â€" shows the shift from venue to owner," "motion title â€" introduces the event centre calmly"); and any effect that does not help the story has been deleted. The video feels elegant and professional â€" motion serves the story, never the reverse.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What is the rule about transitions â€" and why?

Q2. List. Name the three transitions in the tasteful set.

Q3. Multiple choice. What is a keyframe? a) A type of transition b) A marker that sets a value at a moment; the software animates between keyframes c) A tool for removing background noise d) A type of caption

Q4. Explain. What is a slow zoom, and what is the rule for how big it should be?

Q5. Scenario. You added a spinning, bouncing title to your video. A friend says it is distracting. What do you do â€" and what is the principle?

Q6. Short answer. What is the "story test"?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. The best transition is usually no transition â€" because a straight cut is invisible; the viewer simply experiences the story. A transition draws attention to itself, which pulls the viewer out of the story.

A2. Straight cut (default), dissolve (gentle shifts), whip/slide (sparring, high energy).

A3. (b) A marker that sets a value at a moment; the software animates between keyframes.

A4. A slow zoom is a gradual change in scale over time â€" the clip slowly gets bigger or smaller. The rule: 10â€"20% over the length of the clip â€" subtle, not dramatic.

A5. Simplify the title â€" fade in and slide up, nothing more. The principle: the motion serves the message. A spinning, bouncing title distracts from the message; a calm title communicates it.

A6. The story test is the question you ask before keeping any effect: "Does this help the story, or only my ego?" If yes, keep it. If no â€" or if you are not sure â€" delete it.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that the best transition is usually no transition â€" straight cuts are invisible. You learned the tasteful set: straight cut, dissolve, and a sparing whip or slide. You learned keyframes â€" the markers that set values and let the software animate between them. You learned a slow zoom (10â€"20%) to bring stills to life, a speed ramp to control time, and a motion title that moves with purpose. And you learned the story test: does this help the story, or only my ego? You applied at least two motion techniques â€" and deleted every effect that did not earn its place.

Five important takeaways:

1. **The best transition is usually no transition** â€" straight cuts are invisible.
2. **The tasteful set** â€" straight cut, dissolve, sparing whip/slide.
3. **Keyframes** are the engine of motion â€" set values, let the software animate.
4. **A slow zoom and a speed ramp** â€" subtle, intentional, on key moments.
5. **The story test** â€" does this help the story, or only my ego? If unsure, delete it.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain why the best transition is usually no transition?
- Can I name the tasteful set of transitions?
- Can I use keyframes to create a slow zoom?
- Can I create a speed ramp and a motion title?
- Can I apply the story test and delete effects that do not earn their place?

Connection to the next session. Your video now has good cuts, a clear story, balanced audio, corrected colour, readable text and disciplined motion. Next session is the technical session that separates a hobbyist from a professional: **export settings,**

formats and delivery. You will learn codecs, containers, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratios â€” and how to export the right file for the right platform without destroying quality. The rule: export to specification, then check the exported file.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner uses straight cuts by default and adds transitions sparingly.
- Learner uses keyframes to create a slow zoom, speed ramp or motion title.
- Learner applies the story test and deletes effects that do not earn their place.
- Learner's slow zoom is subtle (10â€“20%).
- Learner's speed ramp is gradual and intentional.
- Learner's motion title is calm and professional.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "More transitions = more professional." â†’ Straight cuts are invisible; transitions draw attention.
- "Keyframes are advanced." â†’ They are simple: set values, let the software animate.
- "A bigger zoom is more dramatic." â†’ A subtle zoom is elegant; a big zoom looks like a mistake.
- "If I made the effect, I should use it." â†’ The effect is a tool, not a trophy.
- "Motion on every clip." â†’ Motion serves the story â€” not every clip needs it.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Transition drill:** give a 5-clip edit; the learner replaces most transitions with straight cuts and keeps only one dissolve â€” and explains why.
2. **Keyframe drill:** the learner creates a slow zoom on a still image using two keyframes â€” and explains the concept.
3. **Story test drill:** give an edit with 10 effects; the learner deletes the ones that do not help the story and justifies each deletion.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide an edit with the clips already placed; the learner adds a slow zoom and a motion title.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€” full motion pass plus independent exercise.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to build a 30-second edit using only motion techniques (no transitions) â€” slow zooms, speed ramps and a motion title â€” and explain how motion alone can carry the video.

Timing guidance. The priority is **learners applying motion techniques and applying the story test** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the independent exercise to one motion technique. Protect the practical time â€” a learner who leaves without a motion pass and a justification log has not built the motion skill that Sessions 7â€“9 depend on.

END OF SESSION 6

Next: Session 7 â€” Export Settings, Formats and Delivery.

SESSION 07 OF 9

Export Settings Formats and Delivery

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 07

Export Settings by Platform

Match your render settings to where the video will be published

Platform	Resolution	Aspect Ratio	Max Duration
YouTube	1920×1080	16:9	60min+
TikTok	1080×1920	9:16	10min
Instagram Reels	1080×1920	9:16	90s
Instagram Feed	1080×1080	1:1	60s

Tip: Always export at the highest quality, then let the platform compress.
Vertical 9:16 fills the phone screen; horizontal 16:9 is best for desktop viewing.

CEA

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 7 â€" EXPORT SETTINGS, FORMATS AND DELIVERY

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	7 of 9
Session title	Export Settings, Formats and Delivery
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Polish and Deliver
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first export and delivery work)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"6 â€" learners must have their motion pass (from Session 6) with disciplined effects. They must be able to do a full edit: cuts, audio, colour, text and motion. No prior

Item	Detail
	export or codec knowledge assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 6 you made your video move right with disciplined effects. Today you learn the technical session that separates a hobbyist from a professional: **export settings, formats and delivery.** You will learn codecs, containers, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratios â€" and how to export the right file for the right platform without destroying quality. The rule: export to specification, then check the exported file.
Preparation before class	CapCut installed and tested; a projector; a pre-edited video ready to export; printed platform specification sheets (YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp); the instructor's own export spec sheet pre-built as a model; a USB drive for each learner to take their exports home.

Instructor note on tone: This session is technical and some learners will find it dry. The key is to make it *relevant*: every setting you teach is the difference between a file that plays beautifully and one that looks terrible or will not upload. Use the phrase "export to specification, then check the file" as the session's mantra. Connect every setting to a real consequence.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain** in plain English what a codec, a container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratio are â€" and why each matters for delivery.
2. **Choose the correct export settings** for a given platform â€" YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp â€" including codec, resolution, frame rate and bitrate.
3. **Export a video** from CapCut to a specified platform without visible quality damage.
4. **Check the exported file** against the brief â€" resolution, aspect ratio, file size and playback quality.
5. **Explain** how compression can be invisible or ruin a video â€" and how to avoid the ruin.
6. **Name** the common export mistakes and how to fix them.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut installed.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- USB flash drives (16 GB) for each learner to take exports home.

Software

- CapCut desktop (free) â€" the tool for this session.
- A media player (VLC or Windows Media Player) to check exported files.
- File Explorer â€" to check file sizes and properties.

Sample files

- A **pre-edited video** (the instructor's motion pass from Session 6, or a fresh edit) ready to export.
- **Platform specification sheets** â€" printed, one per learner: YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp â€" with the recommended settings for each.
- A **deliberately bad export** (a video exported at very low bitrate) to show what ruin looks like.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 7.1 â€" "Export Specification Sheet" â€" a table: platform / codec / container / resolution / frame rate / bitrate / aspect ratio.
- Worksheet 7.2 â€" "Export Check" â€" a checklist: resolution matches / aspect ratio matches / file plays / no visible damage / file size reasonable.

Accounts

- CapCut account (already created in Session 2).

Internet

- Not required for the export itself. Needed only if checking a platform's current specifications online â€" the printed sheets are sufficient.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut works. The export settings are the same in CapCut mobile.

Instructor note on codecs: Codecs are the most technical part of this session. Teach them in plain English with analogies â€" do not teach the mathematics. The goal is not to make learners codec engineers; it is to make them choose correctly and explain their choice.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show the **same 10-second video exported three ways**:

- **Export 1 (correct):** 1080p, H.264, reasonable bitrate â€" the video looks sharp and plays smoothly.
- **Export 2 (too low bitrate):** 1080p but very low bitrate â€" the video looks blocky and smeared, especially in areas of detail.
- **Export 3 (wrong resolution):** 480p â€" the video looks soft and blurry on the projector.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Same video, same edit, same footage. Export 1 looks sharp. Export 2 looks blocky â€" you can see little squares in the detail. Export 3 looks soft and blurry.*
>
> *The difference is not the edit â€" it is the **export settings.** A codec, a bitrate, a resolution â€" these are the decisions that determine whether your video looks professional or amateur when the client watches it.*
>
> *Here is the rule for today: **export to specification, then check the file.** Every platform has a specification â€" a set of recommended settings. If you export to that specification, the video looks right. If you guess, you risk a file that looks terrible or will not upload.*
>
> *Today you learn the six export settings â€" codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratio â€" and how to choose them for YouTube, Instagram, TikTok and WhatsApp. By the end of this session, you will have exported a video to specification and checked it against the brief."*

Expected learner response: Learners will say "I didn't know there were settings," "I just clicked export," "why does the blocky one look like that?" Accept all answers. Say: "Most beginners just click export â€" and most beginners deliver files that look wrong. Today you learn to export like a professional."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"The export is the last step â€" and the one the client sees. A beautiful edit exported badly is a bad video. A good edit exported to specification is a professional video. Today you learn to finish properly."*

Why this opener works: It shows the consequences of bad export settings in seconds, it proves learners can see the difference, and it frames the session as the professional finish â€" not a technical chore.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is the story test, and how do you apply it?"

- Expected answer: The story test is the question "does this help the story, or only my ego?" You apply it by asking that question before keeping any effect â€" and deleting any effect that does not help.

- Common gap: learners apply the story test to effects but not to exports. Clarify: "The story test applies to exports too â€” does this setting serve the viewer?"

Question 2: "What is a keyframe, and what does it do?"

- Expected answer: A keyframe is a marker that sets a value at a moment; the software animates between keyframes. It is the engine of motion.
- Common gap: learners confuse keyframes with cuts. Clarify: "A cut is where one clip ends; a keyframe is where a value is set."

Question 3: "What is the difference between correction and grading?"

- Expected answer: Correction is fixing problems (exposure, white balance, contrast). Grading is styling (creating a mood). Fix first, style second.
- Common gap: learners still want to grade everything. Clarify: "Grade only when the story needs it â€” and only after correction."

Question 4: "What are safe areas, and why do they matter?"

- Expected answer: Safe areas are the parts of the screen not covered by the platform's interface. They matter because text placed outside them is hidden.
- Common gap: learners place text wherever it looks nice. Clarify: "Text in the editor is not text on the platform â€” check the safe area."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Your video now has good cuts, a clear story, balanced audio, corrected colour, readable text and disciplined motion. Today we finish it properly â€" with the right export settings for the right platform. Export to specification, then check the file. That is the professional habit."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing the story test on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 The six export settings â€" the vocabulary of delivery

The idea. Every export is defined by six settings. Learn what each one is in plain English, and you can choose correctly for any platform.

The six settings (teach them with analogies):

1. Codec (compressor-decompressor). The codec is the method used to shrink the video file so it can be stored and streamed. Think of it as a **zip file for video** â€" it packs the data efficiently.

- **H.264 (AVC):** the universal standard. Plays everywhere. Use this for almost everything.
- **H.265 (HEVC):** newer, smaller files, but not all devices play it. Use it when file size matters and you know the device supports it.
- **ProRes:** a heavy, high-quality codec used in professional post-production. Do not use it for delivery â€" the files are enormous.

2. Container. The container is the file "box" that holds the video, audio and metadata. It is the file extension you see.

- **MP4:** the universal container. Use this for almost everything.
- **MOV:** an Apple container. Fine, but MP4 is more universal.
- **MKV:** a flexible container, but not always supported by platforms.

3. Resolution. The width Ã— height of the video in pixels. (You learned this in Session 1.)

- **1920Ã—1080 (1080p):** the standard for professional work.
- **1280Ã—720 (720p):** acceptable for quick social posts, not for client work.
- **1080Ã—1920:** the 9:16 version for vertical video.

4. Frame rate. How many frames play per second. (You learned this in Session 1.)

- **30 fps:** the standard for online video.
- **25 fps:** common in some broadcast traditions.
- **60 fps:** for smooth slow motion.

5. Bitrate. How much data is used per second of video. This is the most important setting for quality.

- **Think of bitrate as the bandwidth of a pipe:** a bigger pipe (higher bitrate) carries more data and looks better; a smaller pipe (lower bitrate) carries less and looks worse.
- **Too low:** the video looks blocky and smeared â€" especially in areas of detail (foliage, fast movement, text).
- **Too high:** the file is enormous, with no visible quality gain.
- **The sweet spot:** high enough to look clean, low enough to be practical.

6. Aspect ratio. The shape of the frame. (You learned this in Session 1.)

- **16:9** for YouTube and TV; **9:16** for TikTok, Reels and Shorts; **1:1** or **4:5** for Instagram feed.

Real-life comparison. The six settings are like **posting a parcel**: the codec is how well you pack it, the container is the box, the resolution is the size, the frame rate is how smoothly it moves, the bitrate is how much protection you use, and the aspect ratio is the shape of the box. A professional packs the parcel so it arrives perfectly â€" not so heavy it costs a fortune, not so light it breaks.

Common misconception. "Higher settings are always better." No. A 4K video on a phone screen is wasted weight. A 10 Mbps bitrate for a talking head is wasted space. Choose what the platform and the story need.

F.2 Platform specifications â€" export to the target

The idea. Every platform has a specification â€" a set of recommended settings. Export to that specification and the video looks right.

The platform specifications (teach these as the course standard):

Platform	Codec	Container	Resolution	Frame rate	Bitrate (1080p)	Aspect ratio
YouTube	H.264	MP4	1920Ã—1080	30 fps	8â€"12 Mbps	16:9
Instagram (Reels/Feed)	H.264	MP4	1080Ã—1920 (Reels) or 1080Ã—1080 (Feed)	30 fps	5â€"8 Mbps	9:16 or 1:1
TikTok	H.264	MP4	1080Ã—1920	30 fps	5â€"8 Mbps	9:16
WhatsApp Status	H.264	MP4	1080Ã—1920	30 fps	4â€"6 Mbps	9:16

How to use the table:

1. Ask: "Where will this video be watched?"
2. Find the platform in the table.
3. Export with those settings.
4. Check the exported file against the table.

Why platforms have specifications. Platforms re-encode every video to their own standard. If you upload a video that is already close to their standard, the re-encoding is gentle and the quality holds. If you upload a video that is far from their standard (too low bitrate, wrong resolution), the re-encoding is harsh and the quality drops.

Real-life comparison. Exporting to specification is like **dressing for the occasion**. You would not wear a suit to the market or shorts to a wedding. The platform is the occasion; the settings are the clothes. Dress the video for where it will be watched.

Common misconception. "One export works for every platform." No. A 16:9 YouTube video on TikTok gets black bars. A 4K video on WhatsApp is compressed to nothing. Export for the platform â€" or export twice for two platforms.

F.3 Compression â€" invisible or ruin

The idea. Compression is the process of shrinking the video file. Done well, it is invisible. Done badly, it ruins the video.

Plain-English definition. Compression reduces the file size by removing data the viewer is unlikely to notice â€” or by reducing the overall data (bitrate).

The two types of compression:

- **Lossless compression:** no quality loss. The file is smaller but perfect. (Rarely used for delivery â€” the files are still large.)
- **Lossy compression:** some quality loss. The file is much smaller, but the quality drops. (This is what H.264 and H.265 do.)

How to compress without ruin:

1. **Use the right codec** (H.264 for compatibility).
2. **Use a high enough bitrate** â€” the single most important factor.
3. **Use the right resolution** â€” do not export 4K for a phone screen.
4. **Check the exported file** â€” watch it for blocking, smearing and artifacts.

What ruin looks like:

- **Blocking:** little squares in areas of detail (foliage, fast movement).
- **Smearing:** fine details blur together.
- **Banding:** visible stripes in gradients (skies, walls).
- **Audio distortion:** crackling or clipping.

Real-life comparison. Compression is like **photocopying a document**. A good copy is clean and readable. A bad copy is blurry, with smudges and missing text. The bitrate is the quality of the copy â€” too low and the text is unreadable.

Common misconception. "I can compress as much as I want â€" the platform will fix it." No. The platform re-encodes what you give it. If you give it a low-bitrate file, the re-encoding makes it worse. Give the platform a good file.

F.4 Exporting from CapCut â€" the steps

The idea. Exporting is the final step â€" and the one that determines what the client sees. Do it deliberately.

The export steps in CapCut:

1. **Click "Export"** (usually top-right).
2. **Set the resolution** â€" 1080p for most work.
3. **Set the frame rate** â€" 30 fps.
4. **Set the codec** â€" H.264 (the default for most exports).
5. **Set the bitrate** â€" choose "Higher quality" or set a specific bitrate (8â€"12 Mbps for 1080p YouTube; 5â€"8 Mbps for social).
6. **Choose the format** â€" MP4.
7. **Name the file** â€" using the naming convention (see Session 8).
8. **Choose the destination** â€" your `03_Exports` folder.
9. **Click Export** and wait.
10. **Check the exported file** â€" watch it, check the resolution, check the file size.

The rule: export to specification, then check the file. Never export and deliver without checking.

Real-life comparison. Exporting is like **baking a cake**. The ingredients are the edit; the oven settings are the export settings; the finished cake is the video. A good cake needs the right temperature and time â€" too hot and it burns, too cool and it is raw. The export settings are the temperature and time.

Common misconception. "Export is automatic â€" I just click the button." No. Export is a decision. The button is easy; the settings are the skill.

F.5 Checking the exported file â€" the professional habit

The idea. The export is not finished when the progress bar reaches 100%. It is finished when you have **checked the file**.

The export check (teach this checklist):

1. **Does it play?** Open the file in a media player â€" does it play smoothly?

2. **Is the resolution right?** Check the file properties â€" does it match the specification?
3. **Is the aspect ratio right?** Does it look correct â€" no stretching, no black bars?
4. **Is the quality clean?** Watch for blocking, smearing, banding and audio distortion.
5. **Is the file size reasonable?** A 60-second 1080p video should be roughly 50â€"150 MB. If it is 5 MB, the bitrate is too low. If it is 2 GB, it is too high.
6. **Does it match the brief?** Check every requirement â€" length, format, captions, content.

The rule: if any check fails, do not deliver. Re-export with better settings.

Real-life comparison. Checking the export is like **tasting the food before serving**. A cook who does not taste is guessing. A professional editor checks the file â€" every time.

Common misconception. "The export looked fine in the editor." No. The editor shows a preview â€" the export is the real thing. Always check the exported file, not the preview.

F.6 Common export mistakes and how to fix them

The idea. Beginners make the same export mistakes. Learn them now and avoid them.

The seven common mistakes:

Mistake	What happens	How to fix
Bitrate too low	Blocky, smeared video	Raise the bitrate to the platform standard
Wrong resolution	Soft or cropped video	Set the resolution to the platform standard
Wrong aspect ratio	Black bars or stretching	Set the aspect ratio to the platform standard
Wrong codec	File will not play	Use H.264 for compatibility
Exporting 4K for a phone	Huge file, no visible gain	Export 1080p for phone delivery
Not checking the file	Delivering a bad export	Always check the exported file
One export for all platforms	Wrong shape or quality on some	Export separately for each platform

Real-life comparison. Export mistakes are like **posting a letter with the wrong address** â€" it does not matter how good the letter is; it will not arrive. The settings are the address; the file is the letter.

Common misconception. "The platform will fix my mistakes." No. The platform re-encodes what you give it â€" and a bad file gets worse, not better.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- **The six settings:** codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate, aspect ratio.
- **Codec:** H.264 for compatibility; H.265 for smaller files; ProRes for post-production only.
- **Container:** MP4 for almost everything.
- **Resolution:** 1080p for professional work; 1080Ã—1920 for vertical.
- **Frame rate:** 30 fps for online video.
- **Bitrate:** the most important quality setting â€" high enough to look clean, low enough to be practical.
- **Aspect ratio:** 16:9 for YouTube; 9:16 for TikTok/Reels; 1:1 or 4:5 for Instagram feed.
- **Export to specification, then check the file.**

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[YouTube] --> B[1920x1080 16:9]
    A --> C[TikTok 1080x1920 9:16]
    A --> D[Instagram Reels 1080x1920]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Export a video to specification for two platforms â€" YouTube and TikTok â€" and check both files, narrating every decision.

Setup: CapCut open on the projector. A pre-edited video ready to export. Platform specification sheets on the board.

Step 1 â€" Choose the first platform (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "This video will go to YouTube. I check the specification: H.264, MP4, 1920Ã—1080, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps, 16:9. I set those in the export dialog."
- Walk through the export settings on screen.
- **Ask:** "Why H.264?" â†' Because it plays everywhere.

Step 2 â€" Export for YouTube (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I name the file `CEA-Instructor_YouTube_v1` and export to my `03_Exports` folder."
- Click Export. Wait for it to finish.
- **Ask:** "Is it finished when the bar reaches 100%?" â†' No â€" I must check the file.

Step 3 â€" Check the YouTube export (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I check: does it play? Is the resolution 1920Ã—1080? Is the aspect ratio 16:9? Is the quality clean? Is the file size reasonable?"
- Open the file; check the properties; watch a section.
- **Ask:** "What would I do if the quality was bad?" â†' Re-export with a higher bitrate.

Step 4 â€" Export for TikTok (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "Now the same video for TikTok. The specification is different: 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, 5â€"8 Mbps. I change the aspect ratio and the bitrate."
- Change the settings; export.
- **Ask:** "Why a different export?" â†' Because the platform is different â€" vertical, lower bitrate.

Step 5 â€" Check the TikTok export (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I check this file too: does it play? Is it 1080Ã—1920? Is the quality clean?"
- Open the file; check the properties; watch a section.
- **Ask:** "What is the professional habit?" â†' Export to specification, then check the file â€" every time.

Expected result: Two exported files â€" one for YouTube, one for TikTok â€" both checked against their specifications.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What are the six export settings?" â†' Codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate, aspect ratio.
- "Why H.264?" â†' Because it plays everywhere.
- "What is the most important quality setting?" â†' Bitrate.
- "When is the export finished?" â†' When you have checked the file.
- "Why two exports?" â†' Because the platforms have different specifications.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner exports their edit to specification for two platforms and checks both files.

Starting materials: The learner's edit open in CapCut; platform specification sheets; Worksheet 7.1 (Export Specification Sheet) and 7.2 (Export Check).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. **Choose the first platform** â€" YouTube. Look up the specification on the sheet.
2. **Set the export settings** â€" H.264, MP4, 1920Ã—1080, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps, 16:9.
3. **Name the file** â€" `CEA-YourName_YouTube_v1`.

4. **Export** to your `03_Exports` folder.
5. **Check the file** â€" does it play? Resolution? Aspect ratio? Quality? File size?
6. **Choose the second platform** â€" TikTok. Look up the specification.
7. **Change the settings** â€" 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, 5â€"8 Mbps.
8. **Name the file** â€" `CEA-YourName_TikTok_v1`.
9. **Export** to your `03_Exports` folder.
10. **Check the file** â€" does it play? Resolution? Aspect ratio? Quality? File size?
11. **Complete Worksheet 7.1 and 7.2** â€" fill in the specification sheet and the export check for both files.

Expected result: Two exported files â€" one for YouTube, one for TikTok â€" both checked against their specifications, with completed worksheets.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "What did you check? Did everything pass?" (If not, what failed?)
- After step 10: "Why two different files?" (Because the platforms are different.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Export fails â†' Check the file name has no special characters; check the destination folder exists.
- File will not play â†' Check the codec is H.264 and the container is MP4.
- Quality is blocky â†' The bitrate is too low; re-export with a higher bitrate.
- File is huge â†' The bitrate is too high; re-export with a lower bitrate.
- Wrong aspect ratio â†' Check the project settings match the export settings.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ YouTube specification looked up
- ☐ Export settings set correctly (H.264, MP4, 1080p, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps, 16:9)
- ☐ File named correctly
- ☐ Exported to `03_Exports`
- ☐ File checked (plays, resolution, aspect ratio, quality, size)
- ☐ TikTok specification looked up
- ☐ Settings changed (1080Ã—1920, 9:16, 5â€"8 Mbps)
- ☐ File named correctly
- ☐ Exported to `03_Exports`
- ☐ File checked (plays, resolution, aspect ratio, quality, size)
- ☐ Worksheets 7.1 and 7.2 completed

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Export a video to specification for **Instagram Reels** and **WhatsApp Status** â€" and write a one-page export specification sheet for all four platforms.

Scenario. You are delivering a 45-second video for a Port Harcourt client. The client wants it on Instagram Reels and WhatsApp Status. You also need to document your export specifications for all four platforms (YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp) so the client can see your professional process.

Requirements:

1. Export the video for **Instagram Reels** â€" 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€"8 Mbps.
2. Check the export â€" does it play? Resolution? Aspect ratio? Quality?
3. Export the video for **WhatsApp Status** â€" 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 4â€"6 Mbps.
4. Check the export â€" does it play? Resolution? Aspect ratio? Quality?
5. Write a **one-page export specification sheet** (Worksheet 7.1) for all four platforms: YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp â€" with the codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratio for each.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Instagram Reels export correct and checked.
- WhatsApp Status export correct and checked.
- One-page export specification sheet completed for all four platforms.
- Both files named correctly and saved to `03_Exports`.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: Reels and WhatsApp are both vertical â€" 9:16, 1080Ã—1920.
- Hint 2: WhatsApp has a lower bitrate than Reels â€" 4â€"6 Mbps.
- Hint 3: The specification sheet is a table â€" one row per platform, one column per setting.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: an Instagram Reels export at 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€"8 Mbps, checked and playing cleanly; a WhatsApp Status export at 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 4â€"6 Mbps, checked and playing cleanly; and a one-page export specification sheet with all four platforms:

Platform	Codec	Container	Resolution	Frame rate	Bitrate	Aspect ratio
YouTube	H.264	MP4	1920Ã—1080	30 fps	8â€"12 Mbps	16:9
Instagram Reels	H.264	MP4	1080Ã—1920	30 fps	5â€"8 Mbps	9:16
TikTok	H.264	MP4	1080Ã—1920	30 fps	5â€"8 Mbps	9:16
WhatsApp Status	H.264	MP4	1080Ã—1920	30 fps	4â€"6 Mbps	9:16

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Instagram Reels export correct (2)
- Instagram Reels export checked (1)
- WhatsApp Status export correct (2)
- WhatsApp Status export checked (1)
- Export specification sheet complete for all four platforms (4)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Obi* is a freelance editor in Port Harcourt. His first client â€" a real estate agent â€" asks for a 60-second property video for YouTube. Obi edits the video beautifully, then exports it. He does not check the settings â€" he just clicks export with the default settings. The default is 720p at a low bitrate. He uploads it to YouTube. The video looks soft and blocky â€" the property details are lost. The client is disappointed and does not pay the full amount.

Relevant facts.

- Obi's edit is excellent â€" good cuts, clear story, balanced audio.
- The export is 720p at a low bitrate â€" far below YouTube's 1080p standard.
- Obi did not check the exported file.
- The client expected a professional 1080p video.

Decision point. What went wrong â€" and what should Obi have done?

Possible approaches.

1. Blame the platform â€" YouTube compressed it.
2. Tell the client that 720p is good enough.
3. Acknowledge the mistake, re-export to specification, and deliver a better file â€" and learn the lesson.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Obi's problem is not the platform â€" it is that he exported below the specification and did not check the file. YouTube re-encoded his low-bitrate 720p file and made it worse. The fix: re-export at 1080p, H.264, 8â€"12 Mbps, check the file, and deliver. The lesson: export to specification, then check the file â€" every time.

Reasoning / what Obi would do:

- Re-export at 1080p, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps.
- Check the file â€" resolution, quality, file size.
- Deliver the better file and explain the mistake honestly.
- Learn the habit: export to specification, check the file.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: blaming the platform is dishonest â€" and the client will not believe it.
- Approach 2: 720p is not good enough for a professional property video â€" the details matter.
- Approach 3: acknowledging the mistake costs a little pride â€" but it builds trust and teaches the habit that prevents every future mistake.

Professional connection. Obi's first client could lead to many more â€" real estate is a steady market for video. But only if the first delivery is professional. An editor who exports to specification and checks the file delivers quality every time. An editor who guesses delivers disappointment. The difference is one habit â€" and it is worth thousands of naira in client trust.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Bitrate too low â€" blocky video

Symptoms: The video looks blocky and smeared, especially in areas of detail. **Likely cause:** The bitrate was set too low for the resolution. **How to investigate:** Check the export settings â€" what was the bitrate? **Corrective steps:** Re-export with a higher bitrate (8â€"12 Mbps for 1080p YouTube; 5â€"8 Mbps for social). **How to confirm resolved:** The video looks clean â€" no blocking or smearing. **Prevention:** Use the platform specification â€" never guess the bitrate.

K.2 Wrong resolution â€" soft or cropped video

Symptoms: The video looks soft (too low resolution) or cropped (too high resolution for the frame). **Likely cause:** The resolution did not match the platform specification. **How to investigate:** Check the file properties â€" what is the resolution? **Corrective steps:** Re-export with the correct resolution. **How to confirm resolved:** The resolution matches the specification. **Prevention:** Set the resolution before exporting â€" check the platform sheet.

K.3 Wrong aspect ratio â€" black bars or stretching

Symptoms: The video has black bars (wrong ratio) or looks stretched (mismatched ratio). **Likely cause:** The aspect ratio did not match the platform. **How to investigate:** Watch the video â€" are there black bars? Does it look stretched? **Corrective steps:** Re-export with the correct aspect ratio. **How to confirm resolved:** The video fills the screen correctly. **Prevention:** Set the aspect ratio before exporting â€" check the platform sheet.

K.4 Wrong codec â€" file will not play

Symptoms: The file will not play on some devices or platforms. **Likely cause:** The codec is not widely supported (e.g., H.265 on an old device). **How to investigate:** Check the export settings â€" what codec was used? **Corrective steps:** Re-export with H.264. **How to confirm resolved:** The file plays everywhere. **Prevention:** Use H.264 for compatibility â€" the universal standard.

K.5 Not checking the exported file

Symptoms: The delivered file has a problem that was not caught. **Likely cause:** The file was not checked after export. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you watch the exported file?" **Corrective steps:** Check every export â€" plays, resolution, aspect ratio, quality, size. **How to confirm resolved:** The file passes every check. **Prevention:** Export to specification, then check the file â€" every time.

K.6 One export for all platforms

Symptoms: The video looks wrong on some platforms â€" black bars, poor quality. **Likely cause:** One file was used for all platforms, but the platforms have different specifications. **How to investigate:** Check the platforms â€" do they have different

aspect ratios or resolutions? **Corrective steps:** Export separately for each platform. **How to confirm resolved:** Each platform gets a file that matches its specification. **Prevention:** Export for the platform â€" not for convenience.

K.7 Exporting 4K for a phone screen

Symptoms: The file is enormous; the quality gain is invisible on a phone. **Likely cause:** The resolution is too high for the delivery platform. **How to investigate:** Check the resolution â€" is it 4K for a phone video? **Corrective steps:** Re-export at 1080p. **How to confirm resolved:** The file is smaller and looks the same on a phone. **Prevention:** Choose the resolution for the platform â€" not the maximum.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the export settings or the file properties). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Export Specification Sheet and Dual-Format Delivery"

Purpose: To practise export skills until they are instinctive, and to build the technical delivery skill the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You are delivering a 60-second video for a Port Harcourt client. The client wants it on YouTube and TikTok. You also need to document your export specifications for all four platforms (YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp) so the client can see your professional process.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open your best edit in CapCut (or use the supplied footage to build a 45â€"60 second edit).
2. Export for **YouTube** â€" 1920Ã—1080, 16:9, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps. Check the file.
3. Export for **TikTok** â€" 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€"8 Mbps. Check the file.
4. Write a **one-page export specification sheet** (Worksheet 7.1) for all four platforms: YouTube, Instagram, TikTok, WhatsApp â€" with the codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratio for each.
5. Complete an **Export Check** (Worksheet 7.2) for both exported files.
6. Save both exports to your `03_Exports` folder with correct names.

Required deliverables:

- Two exported files (YouTube and TikTok), checked and saved to `03_Exports`.
- The one-page export specification sheet.
- The completed Export Check for both files.

Submission format: Specification sheet and Export Check as a typed document (`Session7_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week3/Export/` , plus the two exported files on your USB drive.

Deadline: Before Session 8.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
YouTube export correct	3	1080p, 16:9, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps
YouTube export checked	2	Plays, resolution, aspect ratio, quality, size
TikTok export correct	3	1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€"8 Mbps
TikTok export checked	2	Plays, resolution, aspect ratio, quality, size
Export specification sheet	6	All four platforms, all six settings each
Export Check completed	2	Both files checked against the specification
File naming and organisation	2	Correct names, saved to `03_Exports`

Common mistakes to avoid: bitrate too low; wrong resolution; wrong aspect ratio; wrong codec; not checking the file; one export for all platforms; exporting 4K for a phone; no specification sheet.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a YouTube export at 1920Ã—1080, 16:9, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 8â€“12 Mbps, checked and playing cleanly; a TikTok export at 1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€“8 Mbps, checked and playing cleanly; a one-page export specification sheet with all four platforms and all six settings each; and an Export Check confirming both files pass every check. The files are named correctly (e.g., `CEA-YourName_YouTube_v1.mp4`, `CEA-YourName_TikTok_v1.mp4`) and saved to `03_Exports`.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€” answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the six export settings?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which codec should you use for maximum compatibility? a) H.265 b) ProRes c) H.264 d) MKV

Q3. Explain. What is bitrate, and why is it the most important quality setting?

Q4. Scenario. You exported a video for YouTube, but it looks blocky and smeared. What went wrong, and how do you fix it?

Q5. Short answer. What is the professional habit for exporting?

Q6. List. What are the four checks you should make on every exported file?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q6)

A1. Codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate, aspect ratio.

A2. (c) H.264 â€” the universal standard that plays everywhere.

A3. Bitrate is how much data is used per second of video. It is the most important quality setting because too low a bitrate causes blocking and smearing â€” the video looks amateur â€” while too high a bitrate creates enormous files with no visible gain.

A4. The bitrate was too low. Fix: re-export with a higher bitrate (8â€“12 Mbps for 1080p YouTube). The principle: export to the platform specification â€” never guess the bitrate.

A5. Export to specification, then check the file. Every time.

A6. (1) Does it play? (2) Is the resolution right? (3) Is the aspect ratio right? (4) Is the quality clean? (Also: is the file size reasonable, and does it match the brief?)

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned the six export settings â€” codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate and aspect ratio â€” and what each one does in plain English. You learned the platform specifications for YouTube, Instagram, TikTok and WhatsApp, and why you export to the target. You learned that compression can be invisible or ruin a video â€” and that bitrate is the most important quality setting. You learned to export from CapCut deliberately, and to check the exported file against the brief. And you learned the professional habit: **export to specification, then check the file.**

Five important takeaways:

1. **The six settings** â€” codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate, aspect ratio.
2. **H.264 and MP4** â€” the universal standard for compatibility.
3. **Bitrate is the most important quality setting** â€” too low ruins the video.
4. **Export to the platform specification** â€” every platform is different.
5. **Export to specification, then check the file** â€” the professional habit.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I name the six export settings?
- Can I choose the correct settings for YouTube, Instagram, TikTok and WhatsApp?
- Can I explain why bitrate matters most?

- Can I export to specification and check the file?
- Can I explain why one export does not fit all platforms?

Connection to the next session. You can now export a professional file to specification. Next session you learn to work like a professional with **clients, revisions and file management**: reading a brief, handling revision rounds without endless free rework, versioning files honestly, naming and archiving deliverables, and pricing editing work in naira. The rule: a professional is not just skilled â€" a professional is organised, honest and clear about scope.

Simulation notice: the date and full brief for **The Rush Job simulation (15%)** will be announced in Session 8, where the simulation block runs.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner names the six export settings and explains each in plain English.
- Learner chooses the correct settings for a given platform.
- Learner exports to specification and checks the file.
- Learner explains why bitrate matters most.
- Learner exports separately for different platforms.
- Learner's exported files play cleanly at the correct resolution and aspect ratio.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Higher settings are always better." â†' Choose what the platform and story need.
- "One export works for every platform." â†' Every platform has its own specification.
- "The platform will fix my mistakes." â†' The platform re-encodes what you give it â€" a bad file gets worse.
- "Export is automatic." â†' Export is a decision; the settings are the skill.
- "The export looked fine in the editor." â†' The editor shows a preview; check the exported file.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Settings matching:** give four platforms and a list of settings; the learner matches each platform to its correct settings.
2. **Export check drill:** give a deliberately bad export; the learner identifies the problems and states the fix.
3. **Specification sheet drill:** the learner fills in the specification sheet for all four platforms from memory.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide the specification sheet pre-filled; the learner exports and checks.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" dual export plus specification sheet.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to export the same video for all four platforms and write a short delivery note explaining which file goes where and why.

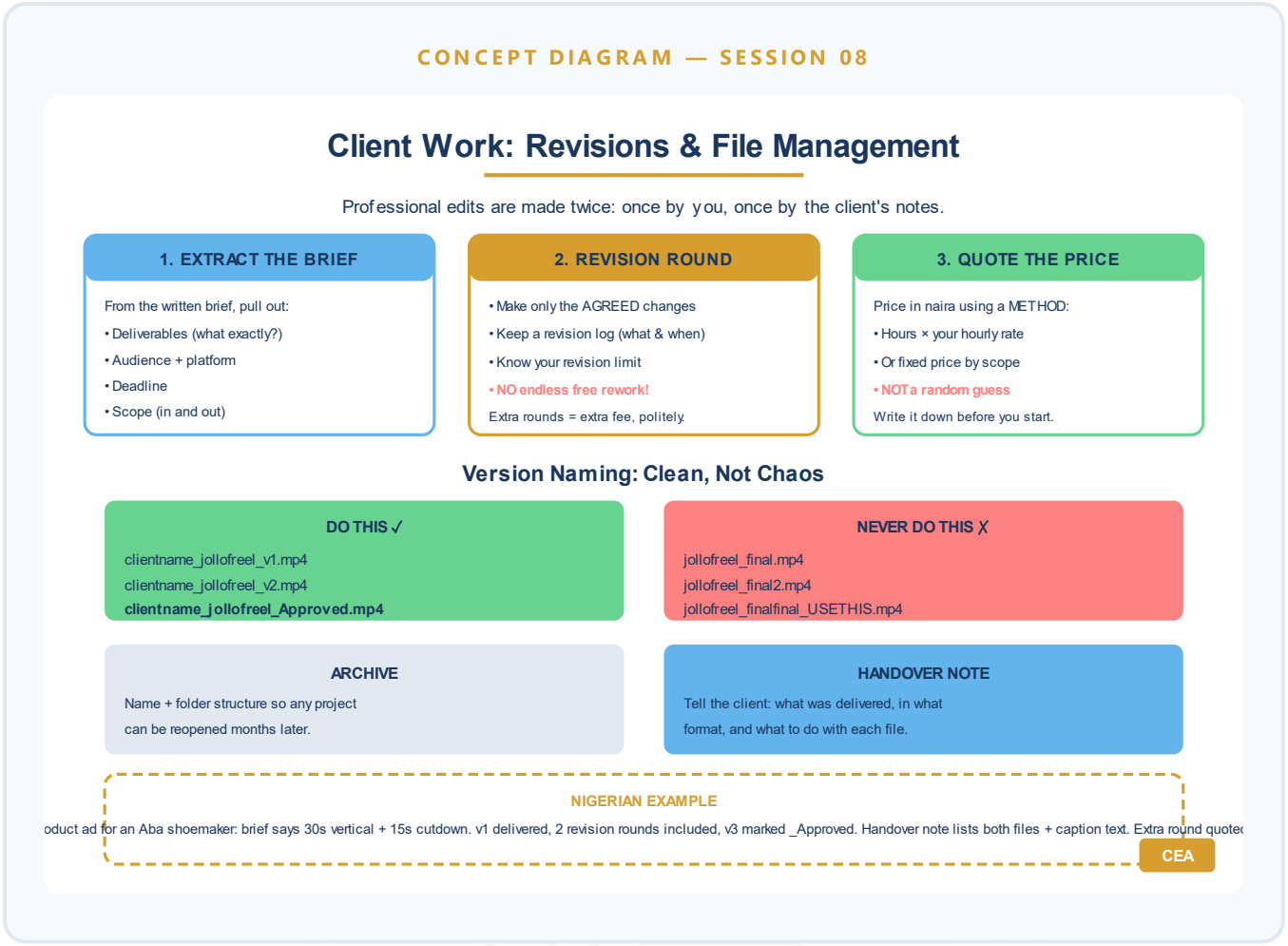
Timing guidance. The priority is **learners exporting to specification and checking the file** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the independent exercise to one export plus the specification sheet. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a checked, correctly exported file has not built the delivery skill that Sessions 8â€"9 depend on.

END OF SESSION 7

Next: Session 8 â€" Client Work, Revisions and File Management.

SESSION 08 OF 9

Client Work Revisions and File Management



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 8 â€" CLIENT WORK, REVISIONS AND FILE MANAGEMENT

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	8 of 9
Session title	Client Work, Revisions and File Management
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Polish and Deliver
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (first professional practice)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"7 â€" learners must have their export specification sheet and dual-format delivery (from Session 7). They must be able to do a full edit and export to specification. No prior client

Item	Detail
	or business knowledge assumed.
Connection to previous work	In Session 7 you learned to export to specification. Today you learn to work like a professional with **clients, revisions and file management**: reading a brief, handling revision rounds without endless free rework, versioning files honestly, naming and archiving deliverables, and pricing editing work in naira. The rule: a professional is not just skilled â€" a professional is organised, honest and clear about scope.
Preparation before class	**Simulation first:** Pack R (6â€"10 previously unseen clips, under 300 MB, with manifest and consent note) and the printed Rush Brief and rubric (Part 4 Â§8.3; Part 5 simulation template) ready for the 30-minute **SIMULATION â€" THE RUSH JOB (15%)** block below. Then: a projector; printed sample briefs (two different client jobs); printed revision request forms; a sample versioned file set (showing `_final`, `_final2`, `_finalfinal` vs. the clean convention); a naira pricing worksheet; the instructor's own client job pack pre-built as a model.

Instructor note on tone: This session is about professionalism â€" the habits that turn a skilled editor into a reliable one. The key message: **a professional is not just skilled â€" a professional is organised, honest and clear about scope.** Use real naira figures, real scenarios and real consequences. The goal is not to make learners business experts; it is to make them professionals who get hired again.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Extract requirements from a written brief** â€" identifying the deliverables, the audience, the platform, the deadline and the scope.
2. **Handle a revision round** â€" making agreed changes, keeping a revision log, and avoiding endless free rework.
3. **Version files honestly** â€" using a clean naming convention (`_v1`, `_v2`, `_Approved`) instead of `_final`, `_final2`, `_finalfinal`.
4. **Name and archive deliverables** â€" so they can be found later and the project can be reopened.
5. **Quote a price in naira** for a defined editing job â€" using a clear method based on hours and scope, not a guess.
6. **Write a short handover note** â€" telling the client what was delivered, in what format, and what to do with each file.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops).
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- USB flash drives for learners to take their job packs home.

Software

- File Explorer â€" for organising and naming files.
- A word processor or notes app â€" for writing briefs, revision logs and handover notes.

Sample files

- **Two sample briefs** â€" printed, one per learner: (1) a 60-second restaurant promo for YouTube; (2) a 30-second product video for Instagram Reels.
- **Revision request forms** â€" printed, one per learner: a simple form with fields for change requested, reason, and agreed/not agreed.
- **A sample versioned file set** â€" showing the "trap" (`_final`, `_final2`, `_finalfinal`) vs. the clean convention (`_v1`, `_v2`, `_Approved`).
- **A naira pricing worksheet** â€" printed, one per learner: a table for estimating hours and calculating a price.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 8.1 â€" "Brief Summary" â€" a table: deliverable / audience / platform / deadline / scope / budget.
- Worksheet 8.2 â€" "Revision Log" â€" a table: version / change requested / reason / agreed? / notes.
- Worksheet 8.3 â€" "Naira Quote" â€" a table: task / hours / rate / subtotal / total.

Accounts

- None required this session.

Internet

- Not required. The session works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with File Explorer and a word processor works. A learner can do the entire session with pen and paper â€" the skill is the *thinking*, not the tool.

Instructor note on pricing: Pricing is sensitive â€" learners may undercharge (losing money) or overcharge (losing clients). Teach a clear method based on hours and scope, and give realistic naira ranges for the Port Harcourt market. Emphasise that a quote is a professional document â€" not a guess.

SIMULATION â€" THE RUSH JOB (15%) â€" 30 MINUTES, RUNS FIRST

*(Delivery block for the 15% simulation component. It is not an Aâ€"O section â€" the Aâ€"O structure of this session is unchanged. Full brief, Pack R specification and the 20-mark rubric: **Part 4 Â§8.3** and **Part 5, "Template: Rush Job Simulation Brief and Marking Rubric."**)*

What it is. A timed, closed-resource test of the whole workflow: a fresh one-page Rush Brief, the supplied Pack R, a visible clock, and a presentable export at the end. Maps to LO4, LO8 and LO9. Worth **15% of the course** (20 marks, converted).

Where the 30 minutes come from (the session stays at 105 minutes):

Block	Minutes
Simulation â€" The Rush Job	**30**
D Opening activity	6
E Prerequisite review	7
F Lecture (compressed to brief, scope, versioning, pricing highlights)	16
G Demonstration	8
H Guided practical	14
I Independent exercise	10
J + L Case study and assignment	5
M + N Knowledge check and recap	7
Close	2
Total	**105**

Instructor setup (ready before learners arrive):

1. **Pack R:** 6â€"10 previously unseen clips re-cut from Pack B/C, under 300 MB, with a manifest (Part 5, Template 0) and consent note (Part 5, Template 0A).
2. **The Rush Brief:** printed one per learner (Part 5 template) â€" a 30â€"45 second promo for a fictional Port Harcourt business: **9:16, 1080Ã—1920, 30 fps, H.264 MP4, 5â€"8 Mbps**; a title; captions inside safe areas; a music bed from the approved free list; a one-line handover note.
3. **The clock:** projected, called out at **15 and 5 minutes**. One computer per learner; only approved music already in the shared folder; files named to the class convention and saved into `CEA-Edit-<Name>/03_Exports`.

4. **Marking:** the Part 4 Â§8.3 / Part 5 rubric printed for the instructor; learners told the rules â€" **no export = 0 for export and handover; any ethics failure = 0 for the simulation.**

Run order: announce the simulation, hand out Pack R and the brief, start the 30-minute clock, collect or file the exports, then continue with Sections Dâ€"O for the rest of the session. If machines are slow or the class is large, book the separate 45-minute Week 3 slot described in Part 4 Â§4 and run the full 45-minute clock there instead â€" the date is published in Session 7.

Marking reminder (/20 â†' 15%): setup and organisation **3**; brief compliance **4**; cut craft and pacing **4**; audio **3**; text in safe areas **2**; export to spec, checked **2**; handover line + versioned name **2**. Late or incomplete: â^'2 per missing requirement.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show two file names side by side:

- **The trap:** `MamaT_final.mp4` , `MamaT_final2.mp4` , `MamaT_finalfinal.mp4` , `MamaT_finalfinal2.mp4`
- **The professional:** `MamaT_Promo_v1.mp4` , `MamaT_Promo_v2.mp4` , `MamaT_Promo_Approved.mp4`

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. Look at these two sets of file names. The first set is what happens when an editor versions files badly â€" 'final,' 'final2,' 'finalfinal.' By the time you reach 'finalfinal2,' nobody â€" including you â€" knows which file is the real one.*
>
> *The second set is the professional convention: version 1, version 2, approved. Clean, honest, findable.*
>
> *Here is the rule for today: **a professional is not just skilled â€" a professional is organised, honest and clear about scope.** Today you learn the habits that turn a skilled editor into a reliable one: reading a brief, handling revisions without endless free rework, versioning files honestly, naming and archiving deliverables, and pricing your work in naira. By the end of this session, you will have a complete client job pack â€" the thing that gets you hired again."*

Expected learner response: Learners will laugh at "finalfinal," say "I have files like that," "I never thought about naming." Accept all answers. Say: "You are not alone â€" every editor has a 'finalfinal' story. Today you learn to avoid it."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"Clients do not just pay for editing â€" they pay for reliability. An editor who delivers the right file, on time, at an agreed price, with honest communication is an editor who gets hired again. That is what you learn today."*

Why this opener works: It uses a problem every learner recognises (the "finalfinal" trap), it makes the professional convention memorable by contrast, and it frames the session as the habits that build a career â€" not just skills.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the six export settings, and which one is the most important for quality?"

- Expected answer: Codec, container, resolution, frame rate, bitrate, aspect ratio. Bitrate is the most important for quality.
- Common gap: learners name the settings but forget which matters most. Clarify: "Bitrate is the one that ruins video when you get it wrong."

Question 2: "What is the professional habit for exporting?"

- Expected answer: Export to specification, then check the file.
- Common gap: learners export without checking. Clarify: "The habit is the check â€" not just the export."

Question 3: "What is the story test, and how do you apply it?"

- Expected answer: The story test is "does this help the story, or only my ego?" Apply it before keeping any effect.
- Common gap: learners apply it to effects but not to client work. Clarify: "The story test applies to client work too â€" does this deliverable serve the client's goal?"

Question 4: "What are safe areas, and why do they matter?"

- Expected answer: Safe areas are the parts of the screen not covered by the platform's interface. Text outside them is hidden.
- Common gap: learners still place text wherever it looks nice. Clarify: "Text in the editor is not text on the platform â€" check the safe area."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You can now edit and export to specification. Today we learn to work like a professional â€" with clients, revisions and files. A professional is organised, honest and clear about scope. Learn these habits, and you will be the editor clients call back."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing the six export settings on the projector before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Reading a brief â€" extracting the real requirements

The idea. A **brief** is a written document that tells you what the client wants. Reading it carefully is the first professional skill.

Plain-English definition. A **brief** is a written description of the job: what to make, for whom, for which platform, by when, and to what standard.

The six things every brief must answer:

Question	Why it matters
What is the deliverable?	A 60-second promo? A 30-second Reel? A highlights video?
Who is the audience?	Customers? Church members? Students?
Where will it be watched?	YouTube? Instagram? TikTok? WhatsApp?
When is the deadline?	A specific date â€" not "as soon as possible."
What is the scope?	How many revision rounds? What is included?
What is the budget?	A price range â€" or an agreement to quote.

How to read a brief (the method):

1. Read the whole brief once â€" do not start editing.
2. Highlight the six answers above.
3. If anything is missing, ask before you start.
4. Summarise the brief in your own words and confirm with the client.

Why this matters. Most client problems come from a brief that was not read â€" or not clarified. A 60-second promo and a 30-second Reel are different jobs. A church video and a business promo are different jobs. If you do not know what the client wants, you cannot deliver it.

Real-life comparison. A brief is like **a customer's order at a restaurant**. If the customer says "rice and chicken," you do not serve them beans and fish. If they say "no pepper," you do not add pepper. The brief is the order â€" read it, confirm it, then cook.

Common misconception. "I can figure it out as I go." No. Guessing is how you deliver the wrong video, waste time, and lose the client. The brief is the contract â€" read it first.

F.2 Scope and revisions â€" the boundary of the job

The idea. Scope is what is included in the job â€" and what is not. **Revisions** are changes the client requests after seeing the first draft. Managing both is the core of professional client work.

Plain-English definitions:

- **Scope** â€" the agreed work: how many videos, how many lengths, how many revision rounds.
- **Revision** â€" a change requested by the client after seeing a draft.

The scope rules (teach these exactly):

1. **Agree the scope before you start.** How many revision rounds? Usually 1â€"2. What is included? Editing, captions, music, colour â€" or only some of these?
2. **Revisions are for agreed changes.** A revision is a change to the brief â€" not a new job. If the client asks for a 30-second Reel when the brief was a 60-second YouTube video, that is a new job â€" quote for it.
3. **Keep a revision log.** For each change, write: what was requested, why, and whether it is within scope.
4. **Charge for out-of-scope work.** If the client asks for more than the agreed rounds, quote for the extra work â€" politely and clearly.

Why this matters. The most common beginner trap is **endless free rework** â€" the client keeps asking for changes, and the editor keeps making them for free. This burns time, kills profit, and teaches the client to expect unlimited work. Clear scope prevents this.

Real-life comparison. Scope is like **a building contract**. If the client agrees to a three-bedroom house, they cannot later ask for a fourth bedroom for free. If they want it, they pay for it. The contract protects both sides.

Common misconception. "I must do whatever the client asks." No. A professional does what was agreed â€" and charges fairly for what was not. Saying no politely is a professional skill.

F.3 Versioning â€" naming files honestly

The idea. Versioning is the system for naming different drafts of the same file, so everyone knows which is the latest and which is approved.

The trap (and why it happens): `final`, `final2`, `finalfinal`, `finalfinal2` â€" because every time the client asks for a change, the editor adds a new name. Soon nobody knows which is the real file.

The professional convention (teach this exactly):

```
ProjectName_Deliverable_v1.mp4
ProjectName_Deliverable_v2.mp4
ProjectName_Deliverable_Approved.mp4
```

- **v1** is the first draft.
- **v2** is the second draft (after the first revision round).
- **Approved** is the final file the client has accepted.

Why this works. The names are chronological and honest. Anyone â€" the client, the editor, a future you â€" can look at the folder and know exactly what each file is.

The archive rule: keep all versions. Do not delete the old ones. The client may ask for a change back to an earlier version â€" and you will need it.

Real-life comparison. Versioning is like **the chapters of a book**. A first draft, a second draft, a final edition â€" each one is named and kept. A writer does not call the second draft "final" and the third "final2."

Common misconception. "I will remember which is the latest." No. In three months, you will not remember. The naming system is the memory.

F.4 Naming and archiving â€" so files can be found

The idea. Naming is giving files meaningful names. **Archiving** is storing the finished project so it can be reopened later.

The naming convention (from Session 1, now applied to deliverables):

```
ClientOrProject_Deliverable_vX_Status
```

Examples: `MamaT_Promo_v1.mp4`, `MamaT_Promo_v2.mp4`, `MamaT_Promo_Approved.mp4`

The archive structure (from Session 1, now applied to the whole project):

```
CEA-Edit-YourName/
â”œâ”€â”€ 01_Footage/          (the raw material â€” keep it)
â”œâ”€â”€ 02_Audio/            (music, SFX, VO â€” keep it)
â”œâ”€â”€ 03_Exports/          (the delivered files â€” keep them)
â”œâ”€â”€ 04_ProjectFiles/     (the CapCut project â€” keep it)
â”œâ”€â”€ 05_Archive/          (old versions â€” keep them)
â””â”€â”€ Docs/                (briefs, revision logs, handover notes â€” keep them)
```

Why archiving matters. In six months, the client may call and ask for a small change â€” a different music track, a shorter version, an updated price. If the project is archived, you can reopen it and make the change in minutes. If it is not, you are starting over â€” or turning down the job.

The backup rule (from Session 1): the archive exists in **two places** â€” the computer and a USB drive (or cloud). One copy is no copy.

Real-life comparison. Archiving is like **keeping your receipts**. You do not think you need them â€” until you do. A professional keeps everything organised, so the future is easy.

Common misconception. "I will organise it later." Later never comes â€” and the client who calls in six months will not care about your excuses. Archive as you go.

F.5 Pricing in naira â€” a method, not a guess

The idea. Pricing is what you charge for a job. A professional prices from a method â€” not from a guess.

Plain-English definition. A **price** is the total naira amount you charge for a defined job, calculated from the time it takes and the scope of the work.

The pricing method (teach these steps):

1. **Estimate the hours.** How long will the job take? Be realistic â€” include editing, revisions, export and communication.
2. **Set an hourly rate.** For a beginner in Port Harcourt, a realistic range is **â‚¦2,000â€“â‚¦5,000 per hour**. As you gain experience and reputation, you charge more.
3. **Calculate the subtotal.** Hours Ã— rate.
4. **Add a scope buffer.** Add 10â€“20% for unexpected changes or extra rounds.
5. **Round to a clean figure.** Present a round number â€” not â‚¦17,350, but â‚¦18,000.
6. **Present a range if unsure.** "This job will cost between â‚¦15,000 and â‚¦20,000, depending on the revisions."

The realistic naira ranges for common jobs (Port Harcourt market, 2026):

Job	Typical price range
30-second social media edit	â‚¦10,000â€“â‚¦20,000
60-second business promo	â‚¦15,000â€“â‚¦35,000
3â€“5 minute event highlight	â‚¦25,000â€“â‚¦60,000
Church service highlights	â‚¦20,000â€“â‚¦40,000
Wedding highlights (short)	â‚¦40,000â€“â‚¦80,000

The rules of professional pricing:

1. **Agree the price before you start.** No surprise invoices.
2. **Take a deposit.** 30â€“50% before you start â€” this protects you and commits the client.
3. **Charge for out-of-scope work.** More than the agreed revision rounds? Quote for it.
4. **Be honest about what is included.** Editing, captions, music, colour â€” or only some? Write it down.

Real-life comparison. Pricing is like **a tailor's quote**. A good tailor measures the fabric, estimates the time, and gives a clear price before starting. A bad tailor says "I will tell you later" â€” and the customer is surprised by the bill.

Common misconception. "I should charge as little as possible to get clients." No. Undercharging attracts clients who do not value your work and burns you out. A fair price for a quality job attracts the right clients.

F.6 The handover note â€” telling the client what they have

The idea. A **handover note** is a short document that tells the client what was delivered, in what format, and what to do with each file.

Plain-English definition. A **handover note** is a one-page summary of the delivery: the files, their formats, and how to use them.

The handover note template:

```
HANDOVER NOTE
Client: [name]
Job: [what was done]
Date: [delivery date]

Delivered files:
1. [filename] â€” [format, e.g., 1080p MP4 for YouTube] â€” [what to do with it]
2. [filename] â€” [format, e.g., 9:16 MP4 for TikTok] â€” [what to do with it]

Notes:
- [any important information â€” music source, captions, etc.]
- [what the client should do if they need changes]

Contact: [your contact information]
```

Why it matters. The handover note is the last impression. It tells the client you are professional, organised and clear. It also prevents the most common post-delivery question: "Which file do I use?"

Real-life comparison. A handover note is like **the instruction manual that comes with a new phone**. The phone works without it â€” but the manual makes everything clearer. A professional includes it.

Common misconception. "The client will figure it out." No. A client who cannot figure out which file to use is a client who calls you in a panic â€” or who uses the wrong file and blames you. The handover note prevents both.

F.7 Summary of the lecture

- A **brief** answers six questions: what, who, where, when, scope, budget.
- **Scope** is the agreed work â€” agree it before you start.
- **Revisions** are agreed changes â€” keep a log; charge for out-of-scope work.
- **Versioning** uses a clean convention: `_v1`, `_v2`, `_Approved` â€” not `_final`, `_final2`.
- **Archiving** keeps the project in two places so it can be reopened.
- **Pricing** is a method: hours Ã— rate, plus a buffer, rounded to a clean figure.
- A **handover note** tells the client what they have and what to do with it.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Client brief] --> B[First draft] --> C[Client feedback] --> D{Changes needed?} -->|Yes| B
    D -->|No| E[Final delivery]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Build a complete client job pack â€” brief summary, revision log, versioned file names, archive structure, naira quote and handover note â€” narrating every decision.

Setup: On the projector, show a sample brief (a 60-second restaurant promo for YouTube). Have a word processor open. Have a folder structure ready.

Step 1 â€” Read and summarise the brief (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "I read the whole brief first. I highlight the six answers: what (60-second promo), who (customers), where (YouTube), when (Friday), scope (one video, two revision rounds), budget (they asked me to quote). I summarise it in my own words."

- Fill in Worksheet 8.1 on the projector.
- **Ask:** "Why summarise in my own words?" â†' To confirm I understood â€" before I start.

Step 2 â€" Quote the price (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I estimate the job will take 4 hours â€" editing, one revision round, export. My beginner rate is â‚¦3,000 per hour. That is â‚¦12,000. I add 15% buffer for unexpected changes â€" â‚¦13,800. I round to â‚¦14,000. I present it as a clear figure."
- Fill in Worksheet 8.3 on the projector.
- **Ask:** "Why a buffer?" â†' Because unexpected changes are normal â€" the buffer protects me.

Step 3 â€" Version the files (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "The client approves the first draft but asks for one change. I make the change and save it as v2 â€" not 'final.' When they approve v2, I save it as Approved. Clean, honest, findable."
- Show the versioned file names on the projector.
- **Ask:** "Why not 'final2'?" â†' Because 'final' is a lie â€" v2 is honest.

Step 4 â€" Archive the project (4 minutes)

- **Say:** "I archive the whole project: footage, audio, exports, project files, docs. In two places â€" the computer and a USB drive. In six months, if the client calls for a change, I can reopen it in minutes."
- Show the folder structure on the projector.
- **Ask:** "Why two places?" â†' One copy is no copy.

Step 5 â€" Write the handover note (3 minutes)

- **Say:** "I write a one-page handover note: what was delivered, in what format, and what to do with each file. The client knows exactly what they have."
- Show the handover note on the projector.
- **Ask:** "Why a handover note?" â†' It is the last impression â€" and it prevents 'which file do I use?'"

Expected result: A complete client job pack â€" brief summary, naira quote, versioned file names, archive structure and handover note.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What are the six things a brief must answer?" â†' What, who, where, when, scope, budget.
- "Why agree the scope before starting?" â†' To prevent endless free rework.
- "What is the versioning convention?" â†' _v1, _v2, _Approved.
- "How do you calculate a price?" â†' Hours Ã— rate, plus buffer, rounded.
- "Why a handover note?" â†' It tells the client what they have and what to do with it.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner builds a **client job pack** from a sample brief.

Starting materials: A printed sample brief (a 30-second product video for Instagram Reels); Worksheets 8.1, 8.2 and 8.3; a word processor or notes app; a folder structure handout.

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. **Read the brief** â€" read the whole thing once. Do not start editing.
2. **Summarise the brief** â€" fill in Worksheet 8.1: what, who, where, when, scope, budget.
3. **Identify the gaps** â€" is anything missing from the brief? Write down the questions you would ask the client.
4. **Quote the price** â€" estimate the hours, set a rate, add a buffer, round to a clean figure. Fill in Worksheet 8.3.
5. **Plan the versioning** â€" write the file names you would use: v1, v2, Approved.
6. **Plan the archive** â€" draw the folder structure you would create.
7. **Complete a revision log template** â€" fill in Worksheet 8.2 with one example change (e.g., "client asked for a different music track â€" within scope, agreed").
8. **Write a handover note** â€" one page: what was delivered, in what format, what to do with each file.

Expected result: A complete client job pack â€" brief summary, naira quote, versioning plan, archive structure, revision log template and handover note.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "What is missing from the brief?" (If they say nothing, ask: "What if the client wanted a different platform?")
- After step 4: "How did you calculate the price?" (If they guess, ask: "What is your hourly rate and how many hours?")

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Brief summary is vague â†' Prompt: "What exactly is the deliverable? A 30-second Reel â€" for what platform?"
- Price is a guess â†' Ask: "How many hours will it take? What is your rate? Show me the calculation."
- Versioning uses "final" â†' Show the trap; ask them to rewrite with the convention.
- No revision log â†' Ask: "If the client asks for a change, how will you remember what was agreed?"
- Handover note is missing â†' Ask: "If the client receives two files, how do they know which to use?"

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Brief read in full
- ☐ Brief summary completed (all six answers)
- ☐ Gaps in the brief identified
- ☐ Naira quote calculated (hours Ã— rate, buffer, rounded)
- ☐ Versioning plan written (v1, v2, Approved)
- ☐ Archive structure drawn
- ☐ Revision log template completed
- ☐ Handover note written (one page)

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Build a client job pack for a **different brief** â€" a church service highlights video â€" making your own decisions and explaining them.

Scenario. A Port Harcourt church asks you to edit a 5-minute highlights video from a 2-hour Sunday service recording. The video will be posted on YouTube. The church wants the key moments â€" the worship, the sermon highlights, the congregation's response â€" with a title, captions and a calm music bed. The deadline is one week. The church has not specified a budget.

Requirements:

1. **Summarise the brief** (Worksheet 8.1) â€" what, who, where, when, scope, budget. Note what is missing.
2. **Write the questions** you would ask the church before starting (at least three).
3. **Quote a price** (Worksheet 8.3) â€" estimate the hours, set a rate, add a buffer, round to a clean figure.
4. **Plan the versioning** â€" the file names you would use.
5. **Write a handover note** â€" one page, for the church.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- Brief summary complete with all six answers.
- Missing information identified; at least three questions written.
- Naira quote calculated with a clear method.
- Versioning plan uses the clean convention.
- Handover note complete and clear.

Hints if stuck:

- Hint 1: A 5-minute highlights video from 2 hours of footage takes longer than you think â€" estimate generously.
- Hint 2: The church has not specified a budget â€" your quote should be a clear figure with a short justification.
- Hint 3: The handover note should tell the church which file to upload to YouTube.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (model solution â€" do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a brief summary identifying the deliverable (5-minute YouTube highlights), the audience (church members and the public), the platform (YouTube), the deadline (one week), the scope (one video, captions, music bed, title â€" revision rounds to be agreed), and the budget (not specified â€" the learner quotes); at least three clarifying questions (How many revision rounds are included? Do you have a preferred music style? Should the video include the full sermon or only highlights?); a naira quote calculated with a method â€" for example, 6 hours Ã— â‚¦3,000 = â‚¦18,000, plus 15% buffer = â‚¦20,700, rounded to â‚¦21,000; a versioning plan using the clean convention (`Church_Service_v1.mp4`, `Church_Service_v2.mp4`, `Church_Service_Approved.mp4`); and a handover note that tells the church which file to upload to YouTube, in what format, and what to do if they need changes.

Learner marking (out of 10):

- Brief summary complete (2)
- Missing information identified; three questions written (2)
- Naira quote calculated with a clear method (3)
- Versioning plan uses the clean convention (1)
- Handover note complete and clear (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Ada* is a freelance editor in Port Harcourt. Her second client â€" a fashion boutique â€" asks for a 30-second Instagram Reel. Ada agrees to do the job but does not agree on a price or a revision scope. She edits the video and delivers it. The client loves it but asks for "just one more change" â€" then another, then another. Ada makes all the changes for free, over two weeks. The client pays the original agreed price â€" which was too low â€" and never calls again. Ada has worked for two weeks, been paid for one, and lost the client.

Relevant facts.

- Ada did not agree on a price or revision scope before starting.
- She made all revisions for free.
- The agreed price was too low for the work involved.
- The client never called again â€" and told two other boutiques that Ada was "difficult."

Decision point. What went wrong â€" and what should Ada have done differently?

Possible approaches.

1. Keep working for free â€" the client is happy.
2. Refuse all future work from this client.
3. Learn the lesson: agree the price and scope before starting, and charge for out-of-scope work.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Ada's problem is not the client â€" it is that she did not agree the price and scope before starting. Had she agreed a clear price (with a buffer) and a clear scope (two revision rounds), the client would have known what to expect â€" and Ada would have been paid fairly for the extra work. The lesson: agree the price and scope before you start â€" every time.

Reasoning / what Ada would do:

- Agree the price before starting: a 30-second Reel, 3 hours Ã— â‚¦3,000 = â‚¦9,000, plus buffer = â‚¦10,000.
- Agree the scope: two revision rounds included; further changes quoted separately.
- Keep a revision log: what was requested, why, whether it is within scope.
- If the client asks for more than two rounds, quote for the extra work â€" politely and clearly.
- The result: a fair price, a clear scope, and a client who knows the rules.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: working for free burns time and teaches the client to expect unlimited work.
- Approach 2: refusing all future work loses a client who could have become a good one.
- Approach 3: agreeing the price and scope upfront is uncomfortable for ten minutes â€" but it protects the whole job and builds a professional relationship.

Professional connection. Ada's story is the most common beginner mistake â€” and the most avoidable. Editors who agree the price and scope before starting get paid fairly, get hired again, and build a reputation. Editors who do not, burn out and lose clients. The difference is one conversation â€” and it is worth thousands of naira.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Not reading the brief before starting

Symptoms: The delivered video is not what the client wanted â€” wrong length, wrong platform, wrong content. **Likely cause:** The brief was not read â€” or not clarified â€ before starting. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you read the whole brief? Did you confirm the six answers?" **Corrective steps:** Stop. Read the brief. Summarise it. Confirm with the client. Then continue. **How to confirm resolved:** The six answers are clear and confirmed. **Prevention:** Read the brief first â€ every time.

K.2 No agreed scope â€ endless free rework

Symptoms: The client keeps asking for changes; the editor keeps making them for free. **Likely cause:** The scope was not agreed before starting. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How many revision rounds were agreed? What was included?" **Corrective steps:** Agree the scope going forward; quote for out-of-scope work politely. **How to confirm resolved:** The scope is clear and agreed. **Prevention:** Agree the scope before you start â€ in writing if possible.

K.3 Bad versioning â€ _final, _final2, _finalfinal

Symptoms: Nobody knows which file is the latest; the client receives the wrong file. **Likely cause:** Files were named with "final" instead of the clean convention. **How to investigate:** Look at the file names â€ are they v1, v2, Approved? **Corrective steps:** Rename the files using the convention; explain the system to the client. **How to confirm resolved:** The names are chronological and honest. **Prevention:** Use the convention from the start â€ every project.

K.4 No archive â€ the project cannot be reopened

Symptoms: The client calls for a change in six months; the project is gone or disorganised. **Likely cause:** The project was not archived â€ or not backed up. **How to investigate:** Can you find the project files, footage and exports? **Corrective steps:** If the archive exists, organise it. If not, learn the lesson for the next project. **How to confirm resolved:** The project can be reopened in minutes. **Prevention:** Archive as you go â€ two places, every project.

K.5 Pricing by guess â€ too low or too high

Symptoms: The price does not reflect the work; the editor loses money or loses the client. **Likely cause:** The price was guessed, not calculated. **How to investigate:** Ask: "How did you arrive at this price? What is your hourly rate and hour estimate?" **Corrective steps:** Calculate the price from hours Ã— rate, plus a buffer, rounded. **How to confirm resolved:** The price is justified by a clear method. **Prevention:** Use the pricing method â€ every job.

K.6 No handover note â€ the client is confused

Symptoms: The client does not know which file to use; they call in a panic. **Likely cause:** No handover note was provided. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you tell the client about the files?" **Corrective steps:** Write a handover note â€ what was delivered, in what format, what to do. **How to confirm resolved:** The client knows exactly what they have. **Prevention:** Write a handover note for every delivery.

K.7 No deposit â€ the client does not pay

Symptoms: The editor completes the work but is not paid. **Likely cause:** No deposit was taken before starting. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Did you take a deposit before starting?" **Corrective steps:** For future jobs, take a 30â€“50% deposit before starting. **How to confirm resolved:** The deposit is agreed and received before work begins. **Prevention:** Take a deposit â€ every job.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the agreed scope, the file names, or the pricing calculation). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Client Job Pack â€" Brief, Revisions, Versions, Quote"

Purpose: To practise the professional habits until they are instinctive, and to build the professionalism skill the capstone depends on.

Realistic scenario. You have been hired by *Mama T's Kitchen* (the fictional Port Harcourt food business from the course) to edit a 60-second brand video for YouTube. You have the footage pack and a written brief. Your job is to produce a complete client job pack â€" the professional document set that proves you can handle a real job.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Read the brief** (provided below) and complete a Brief Summary (Worksheet 8.1).
2. **Identify the gaps** â€" what is missing from the brief? Write at least three questions you would ask the client.
3. **Quote a price** (Worksheet 8.3) â€" estimate the hours, set a rate, add a buffer, round to a clean figure. Justify the quote in two sentences.
4. **Plan the versioning** â€" write the file names you would use for v1, v2 and Approved.
5. **Plan the archive** â€" draw the folder structure you would create for this project.
6. **Complete a Revision Log template** (Worksheet 8.2) with two example changes.
7. **Write a handover note** â€" one page, for Mama T's Kitchen.

The brief (provided):

> *Mama T's Kitchen â€" 60-second brand video for YouTube. The video should introduce the kitchen, show the food, and drive orders. It should be warm, appetising and trustworthy. It should include the owner's interview, a title with the business name, captions, and an end card with the order number. Deadline: one week from approval. Budget: to be discussed.*

Required deliverables:

- Brief Summary (Worksheet 8.1).
- At least three clarifying questions.
- Naira Quote (Worksheet 8.3) with justification.
- Versioning plan (file names).
- Archive structure (folder diagram).
- Revision Log template (Worksheet 8.2) with two examples.
- Handover note (one page).

Submission format: All documents as a single typed file (`Session8_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week3/ClientPack/` .

Deadline: Before Session 9.

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Brief summary complete	3	All six answers identified
Clarifying questions	3	At least three relevant, specific questions
Naira quote with method	4	Hours Ã— rate, buffer, rounded; justified
Versioning plan	2	Clean convention (v1, v2, Approved)
Archive structure	2	Complete folder structure, two places
Revision Log template	2	Two examples, clear format
Handover note	2	One page, clear, complete
Overall professionalism	2	Organised, legible, client-ready

Common mistakes to avoid: not reading the brief; no agreed scope; bad versioning; no archive; pricing by guess; no handover note; no deposit.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: a brief summary identifying the deliverable (60-second YouTube brand video), the audience (customers), the platform (YouTube), the deadline (one week), the scope (one video, owner's interview, title, captions, end card â€" revision rounds to be agreed), and the budget (to be discussed â€" the learner quotes); at least three clarifying questions (How many revision rounds are included? What is the order number for the end card? Do you have a preferred music style?); a naira quote calculated with a method â€" for example, 5 hours Ã— â‚¦3,000 = â‚¦15,000, plus 15% buffer = â‚¦17,250, rounded to â‚¦17,500, justified as "a fair rate for a quality 60-second brand video, including one revision round and export"; a versioning plan using the clean convention (`MamaT_Brand_v1.mp4` , `MamaT_Brand_v2.mp4` , `MamaT_Brand_Approved.mp4`); an archive structure with the full folder system in two places; a Revision Log template with two examples; and a handover note telling Mama T's Kitchen which file to upload to YouTube, in what format, and what to do if they need changes.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the six things every brief must answer?

Q2. Explain. What is scope, and why must you agree it before starting?

Q3. Multiple choice. Which is the correct versioning convention? a) final, final2, finalfinal b) v1, v2, Approved c) new, newer, newest d) draft, draft2, final

Q4. Short answer. What are the steps of the pricing method?

Q5. Scenario. A client asks for a change that is outside the agreed scope. What do you do?

Q6. Short answer. What is a handover note, and why does it matter?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. What (the deliverable), who (the audience), where (the platform), when (the deadline), scope (what is included), budget (the price or a range).

A2. Scope is the agreed work â€" what is included and what is not. You must agree it before starting to prevent endless free rework and to protect both you and the client.

A3. (b) v1, v2, Approved â€" clean, chronological, honest.

A4. (1) Estimate the hours. (2) Set an hourly rate. (3) Calculate the subtotal (hours Ã— rate). (4) Add a scope buffer (10â€"20%). (5) Round to a clean figure. (6) Present the price before starting.

A5. Politely explain that the change is outside the agreed scope and quote for the extra work. If the client agrees, do the work; if not, the original agreement stands. The principle: charge fairly for out-of-scope work â€" saying no politely is a professional skill.

A6. A handover note is a one-page document that tells the client what was delivered, in what format, and what to do with each file. It matters because it is the last impression â€" and it prevents the most common post-delivery question: "Which file do I use?"

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that a professional is not just skilled â€" a professional is organised, honest and clear about scope. You learned to read a brief and extract the six answers: what, who, where, when, scope, budget. You learned to agree the scope before starting, to handle revisions with a log, and to charge fairly for out-of-scope work. You learned to version files honestly with the clean convention â€" v1, v2, Approved â€" instead of final, final2, finalfinal. You learned to name and archive deliverables so they can be found and the project can be reopened. You learned to price in naira from a method â€"

hours Ã— rate, plus a buffer, rounded. And you learned to write a handover note that tells the client what they have and what to do with it.

Five important takeaways:

1. **Read the brief first** â€" extract the six answers before you start.
2. **Agree the scope before starting** â€" it prevents endless free rework.
3. **Version honestly** â€" v1, v2, Approved â€" never final, final2, finalfinal.
4. **Archive everything** â€" two places, so the project can be reopened.
5. **Price from a method** â€" hours Ã— rate, buffer, rounded â€" and take a deposit.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I extract the six answers from a brief?
- Can I agree a scope and handle a revision round?
- Can I version files with the clean convention?
- Can I archive a project so it can be reopened?
- Can I calculate a naira price from a clear method?
- Can I write a handover note?

Connection to the next session. You now have every skill the course teaches: workflow, software, cut craft, audio, colour, text, motion, export and professional practice. Next session is the **capstone**: you will receive the Mama T's Kitchen footage pack and a written brief, and you will edit a complete 60â€"90 second brand video â€" from setup and assembly through cut craft, audio, colour, text, motion and export â€" then present and defend your edit in a viva. This is where everything comes together.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner reads the brief and extracts all six answers before starting.
- Learner agrees the scope and handles a revision with a log.
- Learner versions files with the clean convention.
- Learner archives the project in two places.
- Learner calculates a naira price from a clear method.
- Learner writes a clear handover note.
- Learner takes a deposit and charges for out-of-scope work.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I can figure it out as I go." â†' Read the brief first â€" guessing wastes time and loses clients.
- "I must do whatever the client asks." â†' Agree the scope; charge for out-of-scope work.
- "I will remember which is the latest file." â†' The naming system is the memory.
- "I will organise it later." â†' Archive as you go.
- "I should charge as little as possible." â†' A fair price for quality work attracts the right clients.
- "The client will figure it out." â†' The handover note prevents confusion.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Brief drill:** give a short brief; the learner extracts the six answers in five minutes.
2. **Pricing drill:** give a job description; the learner calculates a price using the method and justifies it.
3. **Versioning drill:** give a set of badly named files; the learner renames them with the convention and explains why.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a brief with the six answers already highlighted; the learner summarises and quotes.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the session as written â€" full client job pack from a sample brief.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** ask the learner to write an original brief for a job they would like to do â€" then produce the full client job pack for it, as if they were both the client and the editor.

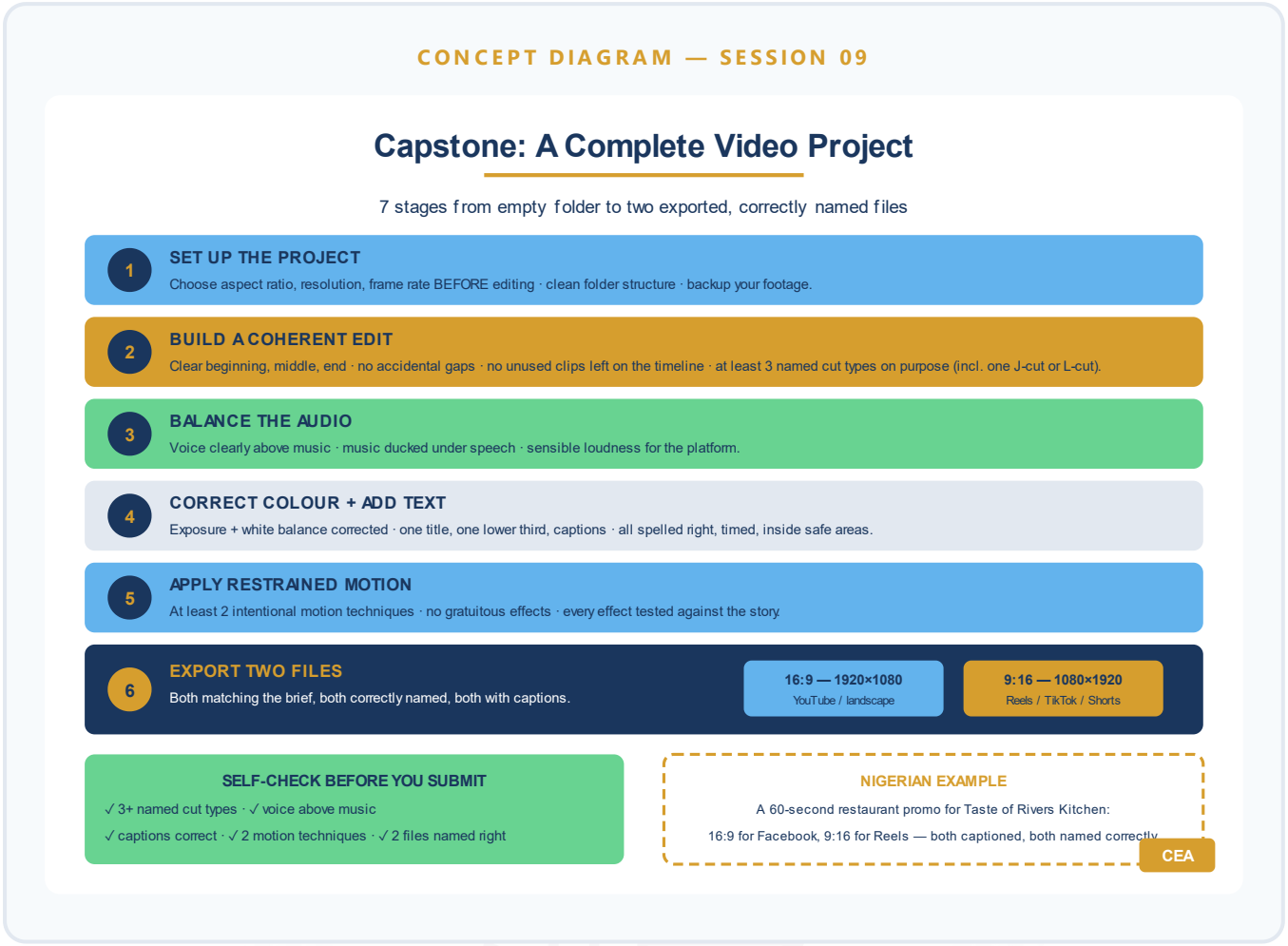
Timing guidance. The priority is **learners building a complete client job pack** (Sections H and the assignment). If the room is slow, shorten the case study (Section J) to a 3-minute mention and limit the guided practical to the brief summary, quote and handover note. Protect the practical time â€" a learner who leaves without a complete job pack has not built the professionalism skill that the capstone and their career depend on.

END OF SESSION 8

Next: Session 9 â€" Capstone: Edit a Complete Video Project.

SESSION 09 OF 9

Capstone Edit a Complete Video Project



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" VIDEO EDITING

SESSION 9 â€" CAPSTONE: EDIT A COMPLETE VIDEO PROJECT

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	9 of 9
Session title	Capstone: Edit a Complete Video Project
Week / Module	Week 3 â€" Module 3: Polish and Deliver
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (capstone â€" drawing on all eight sessions)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"8 â€" learners must have their complete skill set: workflow, software, cut craft, audio, colour, text, motion, export and professional practice. They must have their organised

Item	Detail
	project folder and all previous mini-projects.
Connection to previous work	In Session 8 you learned to work like a professional with clients, revisions and files. Today is the **capstone**: you receive the Mama T's Kitchen footage pack and a written brief, and you edit a complete 60â€"90 second brand video â€" from setup and assembly through cut craft, audio, colour, text, motion and export â€" then present and defend your edit in a viva. This is where everything comes together.
Preparation before class	The **Capstone Pack â€" Mama T's Kitchen** (kitchen prep, food plates, staff at work, customers, exterior, and a short owner interview) copied to the shared class folder and verified; the **written brief** printed for each learner; a projector; a quiet space for the viva presentations; the capstone assessment rubric printed for the instructor; a certificate ceremony planned for the end of the session.

Instructor note on tone: This is the culmination of the course â€" the session where learners prove they can do the whole job. The tone should be celebratory but rigorous. The capstone is not a test to fear; it is a chance to show what you can do. Remind learners of the journey: "From Zero to Expert, Together." The viva is marked on clarity and accuracy, not on speaking style or accent.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Set up a complete project** â€" aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate chosen and stated before editing, with a clean folder structure and backup.
2. **Build a coherent edit** from the supplied footage pack â€" clear beginning, middle and end; no accidental gaps; no unused clips left in the timeline.
3. **Demonstrate deliberate cutting** â€" at least three named cut types used on purpose, including one J-cut or L-cut around dialogue.
4. **Deliver balanced audio** â€" voice clearly above music; music ducked under speech; sensible loudness.
5. **Apply corrected colour and readable text** â€" exposure and white balance corrected; a title, at least one lower third, and captions â€" correctly spelled, timed and inside safe areas.
6. **Apply restrained motion** â€" at least two intentional motion techniques and no gratuitous effects.
7. **Export two correctly named files** matching the brief â€" a 16:9 file (1920Ã—1080) and a 9:16 file (1080Ã×1920), both with captions.
8. **Write a short handover note** â€" what was delivered, in what format, and what the client should do with each file.
9. **Present and defend the edit** in a viva â€" explaining the key decisions clearly and accurately under questioning.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with CapCut installed.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector.
- USB flash drives (16 GB) for each learner to take their capstone home.
- A quiet space for the viva presentations.

Software

- CapCut desktop (free) â€" the tool for the capstone.
- File Explorer â€" for organising and naming files.
- A media player â€" for checking exports.

Sample files

- **Capstone Pack â€" Mama T's Kitchen**: kitchen prep, food plates, staff at work, customers, exterior, and a short owner interview. Total size kept under 1.5 GB.
- **The written brief** â€" printed, one per learner (reproduced in Section F).
- **The footage manifest** â€" a one-page list of every clip.
- **The consent note** â€" confirming everyone appearing agreed to be filmed.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 9.1 â€" "Capstone Requirements Checklist" â€" a tick-list of all ten brief requirements.
- Worksheet 9.2 â€" "Viva Preparation Card" â€" a card for learners to note their key decisions and reasons.

Accounts

- CapCut account (already created in Session 2).

Internet

- Not required. The capstone works fully offline.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any computer with CapCut works. A learner on a phone can do the entire capstone in CapCut mobile.

Instructor note on the viva: The viva is a short spoken defence â€" 3â€"5 minutes per learner. It is marked on clarity and accuracy, not on speaking style or accent. The goal is to confirm the learner can explain their decisions â€" the mark of a professional. Be encouraging; this is a celebration of learning, not an interrogation.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show a **60-second brand video** â€" a polished, professional edit of a food business (the instructor's own capstone example, or a sample). Play it once without commentary.

What the instructor says:

> *"Good morning. That is what you are going to make today. A complete, professional brand video â€" from raw footage to finished, exported, defended.*
>
> *Look around the room. Three weeks ago, some of you had never opened an editing program. Today you are going to do the whole job: setup, assembly, cut craft, audio, colour, text, motion, export and a viva. Every skill you have learned comes together in this one video.*
>
> *This is the capstone â€" the thing that proves you can do the job. It is not a test to fear. It is a chance to show what you can do. And at the end, we celebrate â€" because you have earned it.*
>
> *Remember our philosophy: From Zero to Expert, Together. Today you take the last step."*

Expected learner response: Learners will feel a mix of excitement and nervousness. Some will say "I can do this," others "I am not ready." Accept both. Say: "You are ready â€" you have been building to this for eight sessions. Trust the process."

Then set the frame: Say clearly:

> *"The brief is on your desk. The footage is in the shared folder. You have 105 minutes. Work through the checklist â€" setup first, then the edit, then the export, then the viva. I am here to guide. Let us begin."*

Why this opener works: It shows the finished result (making the goal concrete), it acknowledges the journey (building confidence), and it frames the capstone as a celebration of learning â€" not a test to fear.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What are the ten stages of the post-production workflow?"

- Expected answer: Ingest, organise, log, backup, assembly, rough cut, fine cut, sound, colour, titles/export/delivery/archive.
- Common gap: learners remember the first four and the last two but forget the middle. Clarify: "The middle stages are where the craft lives."

Question 2: "What are the five core editing actions?"

- Expected answer: Place, split, trim, reorder, delete.
- Common gap: learners confuse split and trim. Clarify: "Trim shortens the ends; split cuts in the middle."

Question 3: "What is the rule about audio and picture?"

- Expected answer: "Audiences forgive a soft picture, but they will not watch bad sound."
- Common gap: learners still focus on picture first. Clarify: "The voice carries the message â€" protect it."

Question 4: "What is the professional habit for exporting?"

- Expected answer: Export to specification, then check the file.
- Common gap: learners export without checking. Clarify: "The habit is the check â€" not just the export."

Question 5: "What is the versioning convention?"

- Expected answer: v1, v2, Approved â€" not final, final2, finalfinal.
- Common gap: learners still use "final." Clarify: "The convention is the memory â€" use it every time."

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have every skill. Today you use them all. The brief is your contract â€" read it, follow it, and check every requirement. The viva is your chance to explain your decisions. Let us make a professional video."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 5 extra minutes reviewing the workflow stages on the board before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 The capstone brief â€" the contract

The idea. The capstone is a complete client job. The brief is the contract â€" read it, follow it, and check every requirement.

The Mama T's Kitchen brief (read this to the class):

> ***Client:*** *Mama T's Kitchen â€" a fictional small food business in Port Harcourt.* ***Job:*** *A 60â€"90 second brand video for YouTube and TikTok.* ***Purpose:*** *Introduce the kitchen and drive orders â€" warm, appetising, trustworthy.* ***Must include:***
>
> - *A hook in the first 3 seconds.*
> - *At least one line of the owner's interview with synced audio.*
> - *A title with the business name.*
> - *Lower-third or caption text.*
> - *A music bed mixed under any speech.*
> - *An end card with a call to action (the order number).* ***Must respect:***
> - *Readable captions inside safe areas.*
> - *No misleading claims about the food.*
> - *Only approved free music.* ***Deliverables:***
> - *Two exports â€" a 16:9 file (1920Ã—1080) and a 9:16 file (1080Ã—1920), both with captions, correctly named.*
> - *A short handover note.*
> - *A presentation and viva.*

The ten requirements (the checklist):

1. Correct project setup â€” aspect ratio, resolution and frame rate chosen and stated before editing.
2. A coherent edit â€” clear beginning, middle and end; no accidental gaps; no unused clips.
3. Deliberate cutting â€” at least three named cut types, including one J-cut or L-cut around dialogue.
4. Balanced audio â€” voice clearly above music; music ducked under speech; sensible loudness.
5. Colour â€” exposure and white balance corrected; clips of the same scene matched; a light grade.
6. Text â€” a title, at least one lower third, and captions; correctly spelled, timed and inside safe areas.
7. Restrained motion â€” at least two intentional motion techniques and no gratuitous effects.
8. Two correctly exported files matching the brief, plus properly versioned file names.
9. A short handover note â€” what was delivered, in what format, and what the client should do with each file.
10. A presentation and viva â€” a short spoken defence of the edit.

Why the checklist matters. The capstone is marked against these ten requirements. Every one is a skill you have learned. Work through the checklist in order â€” and tick each one only when it is genuinely done.

Real-life comparison. The brief is like **a building plan**. A builder does not start bricks before the plan is read. The plan protects the builder and the client â€” it is the contract.

Common misconception. "I will figure it out as I go." No. The brief is the contract â€” read it, follow it, check every requirement. That is the professional habit.

F.2 The capstone workflow â€” the whole job in order

The idea. The capstone is the whole workflow from Session 1 to Session 8, applied to one job. Follow the order â€” do not skip stages.

The capstone workflow (the order to follow):

Stage	What you do	Session it comes from
1. Setup	Create the project folder, set aspect ratio/resolution/frame rate, name the project	S1
2. Ingest and organise	Copy the footage, rename, log, back up	S1
3. Assembly	Place clips in story order â€” no music, text or effects	S2
4. Rough cut	Deliberate cuts â€” three named cut types, J-cut/L-cut, B-roll, pacing	S3
5. Audio pass	Levels, ducking, noise reduction, voiceover, beat-sync, loudness	S4
6. Colour and text pass	Correction, matching, light grade, title, lower third, captions, safe areas	S5
7. Motion pass	At least two motion techniques; delete gratuitous effects	S6
8. Export	Two files to specification â€” 16:9 and 9:16 â€” checked	S7
9. Handover	Handover note, versioned file names, archive	S8
10. Viva	Present and defend the edit	S9

Why the order matters. Each stage prepares the next. Setup before assembly. Assembly before cut craft. Cut craft before audio. Audio before colour. Colour before text. Text before motion. Motion before export. Export before handover. Handover before viva. Skipping a stage makes the next one harder.

Real-life comparison. The workflow is like **building a house**: foundation before walls, walls before roof, roof before paint, paint before furniture. You do not put the furniture in before the walls are up.

Common misconception. "I can do the stages in any order." No. The order is the discipline. Follow it â€” and the capstone is manageable.

F.3 The viva â€” presenting and defending your edit

The idea. The **viva** is a short spoken defence of your edit â€” where you explain your key decisions and answer questions. It is the mark of a professional.

Plain-English definition. A **viva** (short for *viva voce*, Latin for "with live voice") is a spoken examination â€” in this case, a 3â€“5 minute presentation where you explain your edit and answer questions.

What the viva assesses:

- Can you explain *why* you made your key decisions?
- Can you name the cut types you used and why?
- Can you explain your audio, colour and text choices?
- Can you answer questions clearly and accurately?

What the viva does NOT assess:

- Your speaking style or accent.
- How confident you sound.
- Whether your video is perfect.

How to prepare for the viva:

1. Watch your finished video once.
2. Note your key decisions: the hook, the cut types, the audio mix, the colour, the text, the motion.
3. Write one sentence of reason for each decision.
4. Practise saying them out loud â€” once is enough.
5. Prepare for likely questions: "Why did you cut here?" "Why this music?" "Why did you delete that clip?"

The viva questions (likely):

- "What is your hook, and why does it work?"
- "Name two cut types you used and why."
- "How did you handle the audio?"
- "What did you correct in the colour?"
- "Why did you delete that clip?"
- "What would you do differently next time?"

Real-life comparison. The viva is like **a job interview for your own work**. You are not being tested on your personality â€” you are being asked to show that you understand what you did and why. A professional can always explain their decisions.

Common misconception. "The viva is about sounding confident." No. The viva is about being clear and accurate. A quiet learner who explains their decisions clearly scores higher than a confident learner who cannot explain them.

F.4 What success looks like

The idea. The capstone is not about perfection â€” it is about demonstrating the complete skill set. Success is a clean, coherent, correctly exported video that meets the brief â€” and a learner who can explain it.

What success looks like:

- The video is complete â€” 60â€“90 seconds, with a clear beginning, middle and end.
- The cuts are deliberate â€” at least three named cut types, including a J-cut or L-cut.
- The audio is balanced â€” voice clear, music ducked, sensible loudness.
- The colour is corrected â€” exposure and white balance fixed, clips matched.
- The text is readable â€” title, lower third, captions, correctly spelled, timed, inside safe areas.
- The motion is restrained â€” at least two techniques, no gratuitous effects.
- The exports are correct â€” two files to specification, checked, correctly named.
- The handover note is clear â€” what was delivered, in what format, what to do.
- The viva is clear â€” the learner explains their decisions accurately.

What does NOT look like success:

- A video with drowned dialogue, unreadable captions or a 720p export when 1080p was asked for.
- A learner who cannot explain why they made their choices.

- A video that does not meet the brief.

Real-life comparison. Success is like **a well-cooked meal** â€” not a Michelin star meal, but a meal that is clean, tasty, served on time, and made with care. A client can use it. That is success.

Common misconception. "The capstone must be perfect." No. The capstone must be *professional* â€” clean, coherent, correctly exported, and honestly made. Perfection is the goal of a career; professionalism is the goal of this course.

F.5 Summary of the lecture

- The **brief** is the contract â€” read it, follow it, check every requirement.
- The **workflow** is the order â€” setup to viva, no skipped stages.
- The **viva** is a spoken defence â€” clarity and accuracy, not confidence.
- **Success** is a clean, coherent, correctly exported video that meets the brief â€” and a learner who can explain it.

Key concept diagram:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Received footage] --> B[Plan edit] --> C[Execute edit] --> D[Export deliverable] --> E[Present & defend]
```

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

Goal: Show the finished capstone â€” a complete 60â€“90 second brand video for Mama T's Kitchen â€” and walk through the key decisions, so learners see what success looks like.

Setup: On the projector, play the instructor's own capstone edit (pre-built before class). Have the brief and checklist on the board.

Step 1 â€” Play the finished video (2 minutes)

- Play the full capstone video without commentary.
- **Say:** "This is what you are going to make. A complete brand video â€” from the Mama T's Kitchen footage pack, to this brief."

Step 2 â€” Walk through the checklist (8 minutes)

- Go through the ten requirements one by one, pointing to where each is met in the video:
  1. **Setup:** "16:9, 1080p, 30 fps â€” chosen before the first cut."
  2. **Coherent edit:** "A clear beginning (the hook), middle (the food and the owner), end (the order card)."
  3. **Deliberate cutting:** "A straight cut to remove a pause, a cut on action as the plate is set down, a J-cut around the owner's interview."
  4. **Balanced audio:** "The owner's voice is clearly above the music; the music ducks under her speech."
  5. **Colour:** "The kitchen clips are corrected â€” exposure and white balance fixed, clips matched."
  6. **Text:** "A title with the business name, a lower third for the owner, captions â€” all inside safe areas."
  7. **Restrained motion:** "A slow zoom on the food, a speed ramp on the serving â€” nothing gratuitous."
  8. **Exports:** "Two files â€” 16:9 for YouTube, 9:16 for TikTok â€” both checked."
  9. **Handover:** "A one-page note telling Mama T's Kitchen which file to use where."
  10. **Viva:** "And I can explain every decision â€” as you will in yours."

Step 3 â€” Show the exports and handover note (3 minutes)

- Show the two exported files (16:9 and 9:16) and the handover note.
- **Say:** "Two files, correctly named, checked against the brief. A handover note that tells the client exactly what they have."

Step 4 â€” The viva (2 minutes)

- **Say:** "In your viva, you will explain your decisions. Here is how: 'My hook is the sizzling food in the first 3 seconds â€” it stops the scroll. I used a J-cut around the owner's interview so her voice leads naturally. I corrected the exposure because the kitchen was too dark.' Clear, accurate, honest. That is the viva."

Expected result: The class has seen a complete capstone â€" the finished video, the checklist met, the exports and handover note, and the viva approach.

Questions to ask during the demo:

- "What is the hook?" (The sizzling food in the first 3 seconds.)
- "Name two cut types." (Straight cut, cut on action, J-cut.)
- "How is the audio balanced?" (Voice above music, music ducked.)
- "What is in the handover note?" (What was delivered, in what format, what to do.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner begins the capstone â€" setup, ingest, organisation and assembly.

Starting materials: The Capstone Pack â€" Mama T's Kitchen in the shared class folder; the written brief; Worksheet 9.1 (Capstone Requirements Checklist).

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. **Read the brief** â€" read the whole thing once. Do not start editing.
2. **Set up the project folder** â€" create `CEA-Edit-YourName` with the full folder structure.
3. **Set up the CapCut project** â€" 16:9, 1080p, 30 fps, named `CEA-YourName_MamaT_Capstone`.
4. **Ingest and organise** â€" copy the footage, rename, log, back up to USB.
5. **Build the assembly** â€" place the clips in story order: hook â†' beginning â†' middle â†' end. No music, text or effects.
6. **Watch the assembly** â€" does the story make sense? Tick requirements 1 and 2 on the checklist.

Expected result: A set-up project with an assembly in story order â€" the foundation for the rest of the capstone.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 1: "What are the ten requirements?" (If they cannot name them, they are not ready to start.)
- After step 6: "Does the story make sense in this order?" (If not, what would you move?)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Footage will not copy â†' Check the USB drive is formatted; check the file count.
- Project will not save â†' Check the name has no special characters.
- Assembly has gaps â†' Check that all clips are placed; no empty space on the timeline.
- Story does not make sense â†' Reorder the clips; the assembly is the time to fix the story.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Brief read in full
- ☐ Project folder created with full structure
- ☐ CapCut project set up (16:9, 1080p, 30 fps, named)
- ☐ Footage ingested, renamed, logged, backed up
- ☐ Assembly built in story order
- ☐ Assembly watched â€" story makes sense
- ☐ Requirements 1 and 2 ticked on the checklist

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Objective: Continue the capstone independently â€" the rough cut, audio pass, colour and text pass, and motion pass â€" working through the checklist.

Starting materials: The learner's assembly from Section H; the Capstone Pack; Worksheet 9.1.

Procedure (learners work independently; instructor walks the room and guides):

1. **Rough cut** â€" deliberate cuts: at least three named cut types, including a J-cut or L-cut around the owner's interview. Cover jumps with B-roll. Adjust pacing.
2. **Audio pass** â€" levels, ducking, noise reduction if needed, a music bed mixed under speech, loudness check.
3. **Colour and text pass** â€" correct exposure and white balance, match clips, add a title, a lower third for the owner, and captions (proofread, timed, inside safe areas).
4. **Motion pass** â€" at least two motion techniques (slow zoom, speed ramp, motion title); delete any gratuitous effects.
5. **Tick requirements 3â€"7** on the checklist â€" only when each is genuinely done.

Expected result: A complete edit â€" rough cut, audio, colour, text and motion â€" with requirements 1â€"7 ticked.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After the rough cut: "Name your three cut types." (If they cannot, the cuts are accidental.)
- After the audio pass: "Is the voice clearly above the music?" (If not, adjust.)
- After the colour and text pass: "Are the captions inside safe areas?" (If not, move them.)

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- J-cut is out of sync â†' Nudge the audio until it feels natural.
- Captions are misspelt â†' Proofread; auto-captions make mistakes.
- Colour looks worse â†' Reset and adjust in smaller steps.
- Too many effects â†' Apply the story test; delete the gratuitous ones.
- Running out of time â†' Prioritise: the edit and exports matter most; the viva can be brief.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Rough cut with three named cut types (including J-cut or L-cut)
- ☐ B-roll covers jumps; pacing adjusted
- ☐ Audio pass complete (levels, ducking, music bed, loudness)
- ☐ Colour corrected (exposure, white balance, matching)
- ☐ Title, lower third and captions added (spelled, timed, safe areas)
- ☐ At least two motion techniques; gratuitous effects deleted
- ☐ Requirements 3â€"7 ticked on the checklist

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chidi* is a CEA Video Editing graduate. Three months after the course, he gets his first real client â€" a Port Harcourt restaurant that wants a 60-second promo for Instagram and TikTok. Chidi remembers the capstone: he reads the brief, agrees the scope and price, sets up the project, builds the edit through the workflow, exports to specification, checks the files, and delivers with a handover note. The client loves the video, pays the full amount, and calls Chidi two weeks later for another job.

Relevant facts.

- Chidi followed the workflow â€" setup to delivery.
- He agreed the scope (two revision rounds) and the price (â‚¦20,000) before starting.
- He exported to specification â€" 9:16 for Instagram, 16:9 for TikTok â€" and checked both files.
- He delivered with a handover note and a versioned file set.
- The client was so happy that they referred Chidi to two other restaurants.

Decision point. What made Chidi successful â€" and what can every learner learn from his story?

Possible approaches.

1. Chidi was naturally talented â€" you either have it or you don't.
2. Chidi got lucky with a good client.
3. Chidi followed the professional process he learned â€" and the process made him successful.

Recommended solution. Approach 3. Chidi's success is not talent or luck â€" it is process. He read the brief, agreed the scope and price, followed the workflow, exported to specification, checked the files, and delivered professionally. Every one of these is

a skill the course teaches. A learner who follows the process will have the same result â€" a happy client, a fair price, and more work.

Reasoning / what Chidi would tell the class:

- "The course taught me the process. I just followed it."
- "The brief is the contract â€" read it first."
- "The workflow is the order â€" do not skip stages."
- "Export to specification, then check the file."
- "The handover note is the last impression â€" make it professional."

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1: talent helps, but process is what makes a career. A talented learner without process is a frustrated freelancer.
- Approach 2: luck helps, but a professional process creates its own luck â€" a happy client refers you.
- Approach 3: the process is learnable, repeatable, and reliable. It is the difference between a hobby and a career.

Professional connection. Chidi's story is the goal of this course. A graduate who can take a client's footage and brief and return a finished, correctly exported, properly named video â€" and explain the decisions â€" is a graduate who can earn. The capstone is the proof. The viva is the confirmation. The certificate is the credential. But the real reward is the career.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live guide. Point learners to the row rather than giving the answer.

K.1 Skipping setup â€" editing before the project is configured

Symptoms: The project has the wrong aspect ratio or frame rate; titles are misplaced. **Likely cause:** The project was not set up before editing started. **How to investigate:** Check the project settings â€" do they match the brief? **Corrective steps:** If the settings are wrong, create a new project with the correct settings and re-import. **How to confirm resolved:** The project settings match the brief before editing. **Prevention:** Setup is step one â€" every time.

K.2 No hook â€" the video starts slowly

Symptoms: The first 3 seconds do not grab attention. **Likely cause:** The video starts with a slow intro or a logo. **How to investigate:** Watch the first 3 seconds â€" would a stranger stop? **Corrective steps:** Start with the strongest moment â€" the sizzling food, a bold question, a surprising image. **How to confirm resolved:** The first 3 seconds make a stranger want to stay. **Prevention:** The hook is the most important 3 seconds â€" protect it.

K.3 Drowned dialogue â€" music louder than voice

Symptoms: The viewer cannot hear the owner's interview. **Likely cause:** The music is louder than the voice; no ducking. **How to investigate:** Listen â€" is the voice clearly above the music? **Corrective steps:** Lower the music; duck it under the speech. **How to confirm resolved:** The voice is clearly audible. **Prevention:** The voice is the boss â€" set levels and duck.

K.4 Unreadable captions â€" misspelt or outside safe areas

Symptoms: Captions are misspelt, mistimed or covered by the platform interface. **Likely cause:** Auto-captions were not proofread; text was placed outside safe areas. **How to investigate:** Read every caption; check the safe-area guide. **Corrective steps:** Proofread; move text inside safe areas. **How to confirm resolved:** Every caption is correct, timed and visible. **Prevention:** Proofread every caption; check safe areas before exporting.

K.5 Gratuitous effects â€" motion that does not earn its place

Symptoms: The video has effects that distract from the story. **Likely cause:** Effects were added without applying the story test. **How to investigate:** For each effect, ask "does this help the story?" **Corrective steps:** Delete every effect that does not earn its place. **How to confirm resolved:** Every effect is intentional. **Prevention:** The story test â€" apply it to every effect.

K.6 Wrong export â€" one file for both platforms

Symptoms: The video has black bars on one platform; the quality is poor. **Likely cause:** One export was used for both platforms. **How to investigate:** Check the exports â€" are there two files, one 16:9 and one 9:16? **Corrective steps:** Export separately for each platform. **How to confirm resolved:** Each platform gets a file that matches its specification. **Prevention:** Export for the platform â€" not for convenience.

K.7 No handover note â€" the client is confused

Symptoms: The client does not know which file to use. **Likely cause:** No handover note was provided. **How to investigate:** Ask: "What did you tell the client about the files?" **Corrective steps:** Write a handover note â€" what was delivered, in what format, what to do. **How to confirm resolved:** The client knows exactly what they have. **Prevention:** Write a handover note for every delivery.

K.8 Cannot explain decisions â€" the viva falls flat

Symptoms: The learner cannot explain why they made their choices. **Likely cause:** The decisions were not deliberate â€" or the learner did not prepare. **How to investigate:** Ask: "Why did you cut here?" "Why this music?" **Corrective steps:** Prepare the viva â€" note the key decisions and reasons; practise once. **How to confirm resolved:** The learner can explain their decisions clearly. **Prevention:** Make deliberate decisions throughout â€" then the viva is just explaining them.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: A "likely cause" becomes "confirmed" only after you check it (e.g., the learner can show you the project settings, the export files, or the handover note). Teach learners to confirm before concluding.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "Capstone Delivery â€" Two Exports, Handover Note and Viva"

Purpose: To complete the capstone â€" the complete, professional delivery of the Mama T's Kitchen brand video â€" and to prepare for the viva.

Realistic scenario. You are delivering the Mama T's Kitchen brand video. The client needs two files (16:9 for YouTube, 9:16 for TikTok), a handover note, and a viva. Your job is to complete the delivery.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Export two files** to specification:
   - `CEA-YourName_MamaT_YouTube_v1.mp4` â€" 1920Ã—1080, 16:9, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps.
   - `CEA-YourName_MamaT_TikTok_v1.mp4` â€" 1080Ã×1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€"8 Mbps.
2. **Check both files** â€" plays, resolution, aspect ratio, quality, file size.
3. **Write a handover note** â€" one page: what was delivered, in what format, what the client should do with each file.
4. **Complete the Capstone Requirements Checklist** (Worksheet 9.1) â€" tick all ten requirements.
5. **Prepare the viva** â€" complete the Viva Preparation Card (Worksheet 9.2): your hook, two cut types, your audio approach, your colour corrections, your text choices, your motion techniques, and what you would do differently next time.
6. **Archive the project** â€" the full folder structure in two places.

Required deliverables:

- Two exported files (YouTube and TikTok), checked and correctly named.
- The handover note (one page).
- The completed Capstone Requirements Checklist.
- The completed Viva Preparation Card.
- The archived project folder.

Submission format: All documents as a single typed file (`Session9_YourName.docx` or `.pdf`) submitted to `/Video-Editing/Week3/Capstone/` , plus the two exported files on your USB drive.

Deadline: Before the viva (in class or by appointment).

Marking rubric (20 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
YouTube export correct and checked	3	1080p, 16:9, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 8â€"12 Mbps
TikTok export correct and checked	3	1080Ã—1920, 9:16, H.264, MP4, 30 fps, 5â€"8 Mbps
Handover note	3	One page, clear, complete
Requirements Checklist	3	All ten requirements ticked with evidence
Viva Preparation Card	3	Key decisions noted with reasons
Archive	2	Full folder structure in two places
Overall professionalism	3	Organised, complete, client-ready

Common mistakes to avoid: skipping setup; no hook; drowned dialogue; unreadable captions; gratuitous effects; one export for both platforms; no handover note; cannot explain decisions.

INSTRUCTOR REFERENCE SOLUTION (do not show learners):

A strong learner solution has: two correctly exported and checked files (16:9 for YouTube, 9:16 for TikTok); a one-page handover note telling Mama T's Kitchen which file to use where; a completed Requirements Checklist with all ten requirements ticked; a Viva Preparation Card noting the key decisions (hook, cut types, audio, colour, text, motion) with reasons; and a fully archived project folder in two places. The learner can explain every decision clearly and accurately in the viva.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key.)

Q1. Short answer. What are the ten stages of the post-production workflow?

Q2. List. What are the ten requirements of the capstone brief?

Q3. Multiple choice. What is the most important quality setting for export? a) Resolution b) Frame rate c) Bitrate d) Aspect ratio

Q4. Explain. What is a viva, and what does it assess?

Q5. Scenario. Your capstone video has drowned dialogue â€" the music is louder than the owner's voice. What do you do, and what is the principle?

Q6. Short answer. What are the five things a handover note should tell the client?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q6)

A1. Ingest, organise, log, backup, assembly, rough cut, fine cut, sound, colour, titles/export/delivery/archive.

A2. (1) Correct project setup, (2) a coherent edit, (3) deliberate cutting (three named cut types including J-cut or L-cut), (4) balanced audio, (5) corrected colour, (6) readable text (title, lower third, captions), (7) restrained motion (two techniques, no gratuitous effects), (8) two correctly exported files with versioned names, (9) a handover note, (10) a presentation and viva.

A3. (c) Bitrate â€" the most important quality setting. Too low ruins the video; too high wastes space.

A4. A viva is a short spoken defence of the edit. It assesses whether the learner can explain their key decisions clearly and accurately â€" not their speaking style or accent.

A5. Lower the music and duck it under the owner's speech. The principle: the voice is the boss â€" it carries the message, and everything else supports it.

A6. (1) What was delivered, (2) in what format, (3) what the client should do with each file, (4) any important notes (music source, captions), (5) what to do if they need changes, (6) the editor's contact information.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you completed the capstone â€" the whole job, from setup to viva. You read the brief, set up the project, built the assembly, did the rough cut with deliberate cuts, mixed the audio, corrected the colour, added readable text, applied restrained motion, exported two files to specification, wrote a handover note and prepared the viva. You have demonstrated every skill the course teaches. You are now a competent entry-level video editor â€" able to take a client's footage and brief and return a finished, correctly exported, properly named video, and explain the decisions behind it.

Five important takeaways:

1. **The brief is the contract** â€" read it, follow it, check every requirement.
2. **The workflow is the order** â€" setup to viva, no skipped stages.
3. **Every skill comes together** â€" workflow, software, cuts, audio, colour, text, motion, export, professionalism.
4. **The viva is the proof** â€" a professional can explain their decisions.
5. **You are ready** â€" for small paid jobs, for further study, for a career.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I set up a project correctly before editing?
- Can I build a coherent edit from raw footage?
- Can I cut deliberately â€" and name my cut types?
- Can I mix audio so the voice is clear?
- Can I correct colour and add readable text?
- Can I export to specification and check the file?
- Can I work like a professional â€" brief, scope, versioning, pricing, handover?
- Can I present and defend my edit?

Connection to the next session. There is no next session â€" this is the end of the course. But it is the beginning of your career. You can deepen your craft through further CEA study, build a portfolio from your capstone and practice edits, and grow from small paid jobs into larger ones. *From Zero to Expert, Together* â€" you are no longer zero. You are an editor.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- Learner sets up the project correctly before editing.
- Learner builds a coherent edit with a clear beginning, middle and end.
- Learner uses at least three named cut types, including a J-cut or L-cut.
- Learner balances the audio â€" voice clear, music ducked.
- Learner corrects the colour and adds readable text inside safe areas.
- Learner applies at least two motion techniques and deletes gratuitous effects.
- Learner exports two files to specification and checks them.
- Learner writes a clear handover note.
- Learner explains their decisions clearly and accurately in the viva.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "The capstone must be perfect." â†' It must be professional â€" clean, coherent, correctly exported, honestly made.
- "The viva is about confidence." â†' It is about clarity and accuracy.
- "I can skip setup." â†' Setup is the foundation â€" every time.
- "One export fits all." â†' Every platform has its own specification.
- "The handover note is optional." â†' It is the last impression â€" make it professional.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Checklist review:** go through the ten requirements one by one; identify which are met and which need work.
2. **Viva practice:** the learner explains their key decisions to a partner â€" clearly and accurately.
3. **Export check:** the learner checks their exported files against the brief and fixes any gaps.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** the instructor provides a partially completed edit; the learner finishes the audio, colour, text and export.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the full capstone as written â€" from setup to viva.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** the learner edits the capstone to a higher standard â€" a more creative hook, more sophisticated cut craft, a more polished grade â€" and presents a longer viva with deeper justification.

Timing guidance. The priority is **learners completing the capstone and presenting in the viva.** If the room is slow, protect the export and viva â€" a learner who leaves without a completed, exported, defended capstone has not demonstrated the full skill set. Celebrate every completion â€" this is the culmination of the course.

END OF SESSION 9

Congratulations â€" you have completed the CEA Video Editing course. You are now a competent entry-level video editor. From Zero to Expert, Together.